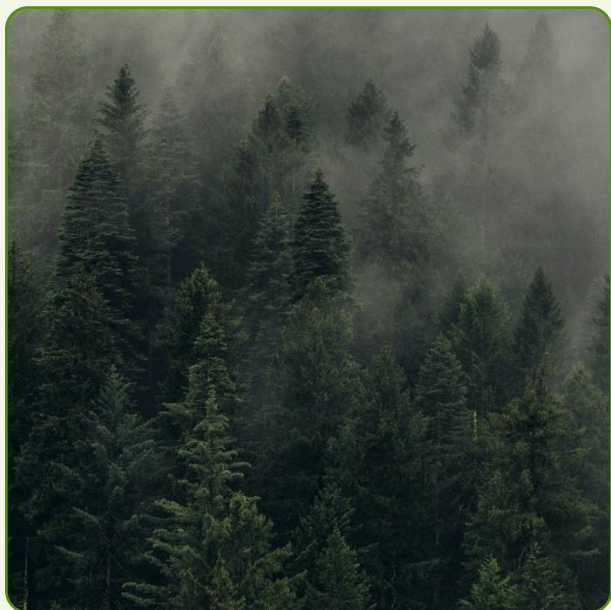




[TITLE LINKED TO  
COVER]  
>CHOOSE<

FSC-STD-XXX-VV-YYYY Description LA

Based on FSC P&C V5-3

[Click to add Publish Date]



---

**Photo credits:**

---

---

**NOTE ON THIS ENGLISH VERSION:**

This is the official version of the FSC National Forest Stewardship Standard that is approved by FSC International, and it is available at [connect.fsc.org](https://connect.fsc.org). Any translation of this version is not an official translation approved by FSC International. If there is any conflict or inconsistency between the approved English version and any translated version, the English version shall prevail.

---

® 2024 Forest Stewardship Council, A.C. All Rights Reserved  
FSC® F000100

You may not distribute, modify, transmit, reuse, reproduce, re-post or use the copyrighted materials from this document for public or commercial purposes, without the express written consent of the publisher. You are hereby authorized to view, download, print and distribute individual pages from this document subject for informational purposes only.

|                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Title:</b>                                      | [Title linked to cover] >choose<                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Document code:</b>                              | FSC-STD-XXX-VV-YYYY Description LA                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Scope:</b>                                      | >choose< (details in section “B.2 Scope” of this standard)                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Status:</b>                                     | >choose<                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Approval body:</b>                              | >choose<                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Dates:</b>                                      | <b>Approval date:</b> [Click to choose a date]<br><b>Publication date:</b> [Publish Date, linked to cover]<br><b>Effective date:</b> [Click to choose a date]                                                               |
| <b>Timeframes:</b>                                 | <b>Transition period<sup>1</sup>:</b> 12 months from the effective date<br><b>Validity period:</b> Until revised, replaced or withdrawn                                                                                     |
| <b>Local contact:</b>                              | Legal full name of the Contact, organizational email                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>FSC Performance and Standards Unit contact:</b> | FSC International Center gGmbH – Performance and Standards Unit<br>Adenauerallee 134<br>53113 Bonn<br>Germany<br><br><b>Phone:</b> +49 -(0)228 -36766 -0<br><b>Fax:</b> +49 -(0)228 -36766 -65<br><b>Email:</b> psu@fsc.org |

### Version control

| Version | Description                                                               | Date                          |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| VX.X    | [e.g. Initial version, approved by xyz at their 45 <sup>th</sup> meeting] | Click or tap to enter a date. |
| VX.X    | [e.g. Further version, approved by xyz at their 45 <sup>th</sup> meeting] | Click or tap to enter a date. |
| VX.X    | [e.g. Further version, approved by xyz at their 45 <sup>th</sup> meeting] | Click or tap to enter a date. |

This standard is subject to the review and revision requirements as described in FSC-STD-60-006 (V1-2) EN.

<sup>1</sup> The transition period is the timeline in which there is a parallel phase-in of the new version and phase-out of the old version of the standard. Six (6) months after the end of the transition period, certificates issued against the old version are considered invalid.

# CONTENTS

|                                                                |           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Contents</b>                                                | <b>4</b>  |
| <b>Foreword</b>                                                | <b>6</b>  |
| 1 The Forest Stewardship Council (FSC)                         | 6         |
| 2 The FSC Principles and Criteria                              | 6         |
| <b>A Preamble</b>                                              | <b>7</b>  |
| A.1 Objective                                                  | 7         |
| A.2 Scope                                                      | 7         |
| A.3 Responsibility for conformity                              | 7         |
| A.4 Note on the use of indicators, annexes and verifiers       | 8         |
| A.5 Interpretations and disputes                               | 9         |
| <b>B Context</b>                                               | <b>10</b> |
| B.1 General description of the forestry sector                 | 10        |
| B.2 Members of the Standards Development Group                 | 10        |
| B.3 Expert advising the Standard Development Group             | 10        |
| B.4 Background information on the standard development         | 10        |
| <b>C References</b>                                            | <b>11</b> |
| <b>D Abbreviations</b>                                         | <b>12</b> |
| <b>E Principles*, criteria* and indicators*</b>                | <b>13</b> |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 1: COMPLIANCE WITH LAWS</i>                      | 13        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 2: WORKERS* RIGHTS AND EMPLOYMENT CONDITIONS</i> | 17        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 3: INDIGENOUS PEOPLES'* RIGHTS</i>               | 22        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 4: COMMUNITY RELATIONS</i>                       | 27        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 5: BENEFITS FROM THE FOREST*</i>                 | 32        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 6: ENVIRONMENTAL VALUES* AND IMPACTS</i>         | 36        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 7: MANAGEMENT PLANNING</i>                       | 46        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 8: MONITORING AND ASSESSMENT</i>                 | 51        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 9: HIGH CONSERVATION VALUES*</i>                 | 54        |
| <i>PRINCIPLE* 10: IMPLEMENTATION OF MANAGEMENT ACTIVITIES</i>  | 58        |

|          |                                                                                                                                                          |           |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>F</b> | <b>Annexes</b>                                                                                                                                           | <b>65</b> |
| Annex A  | Minimum list of <i>applicable laws*</i> , regulations and nationally ratified international treaties, conventions and agreements ( <i>Principle* 1</i> ) | 68        |
| Annex B  | Training requirements for <i>workers*</i> ( <i>Principle* 2</i> )                                                                                        | 72        |
| Annex C  | Conservation Area Network* conceptual diagram ( <i>Principle* 6</i> )                                                                                    | 73        |
| Annex D  | List of <i>rare and threatened species*</i> in the country or region                                                                                     | 74        |
| Annex E  | Elements of the <i>management plan*</i> ( <i>Principle* 7</i> )                                                                                          | 75        |
| Annex F  | Conceptual framework for planning and monitoring ( <i>Principle* 7</i> )                                                                                 | 77        |
| Annex G  | Monitoring requirements ( <i>Principle* 8</i> )                                                                                                          | 79        |
| Annex H  | Instructions for Standards Developers to develop indicators for <i>Intact Forest Landscape* core areas*</i> ( <i>Principle* 9</i> )                      | 82        |
| Annex I  | Strategies for maintaining <i>High Conservation Values*</i> ( <i>Principle* 9</i> )                                                                      | 84        |
| Annex J  | High Conservation Values* framework ( <i>Principle* 9</i> )                                                                                              | 85        |
| Annex K  | International Generic Indicators for the use and risk management of highly hazardous pesticides* 104                                                     |           |
| Annex L  | Glossary of terms                                                                                                                                        | 108       |

## A FOREWORD

(Informative section)

### A.1 The Forest Stewardship Council (FSC)

The Forest Stewardship Council A.C. (FSC) was established in 1993, as a follow-up to the United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (the Earth Summit at Rio de Janeiro, 1992) with the mission to promote environmentally appropriate, socially beneficial, and economically viable management of the world's forests.

FSC provides a system for voluntary accreditation and independent third-party certification. This system allows certificate holders to market their products and services as the result of environmentally appropriate, socially beneficial and economically viable forest management. FSC also sets standards for the development and approval of Forest Stewardship Standards (FSS) and Interim Forest Stewardship Standards (IFSS) which are based on the FSC Principles and Criteria. In addition, FSC sets standards for the accreditation of conformity assessment bodies (also known as certification bodies) that certify conformance with FSC's standards.

Environmentally appropriate forest management ensures that the production of timber, non-timber products\* and ecosystem services\* maintains the forest's biodiversity, productivity, and ecological processes.

Socially beneficial forest management helps both local people and society at large to enjoy long term benefits and also provides strong incentives to local people to sustain the forest resources and adhere to long-term management plans\*.

Economically viable forest management means that forest operations are structured and managed so as to be sufficiently profitable, without generating financial profit at the expense of the forest resource, the ecosystem\*, or affected communities. The tension between the need to generate adequate financial returns and the principles of responsible forest operations can be reduced through efforts to market the full range of forest products and services for their best value.

### A.2 The FSC Principles and Criteria

FSC first published the FSC Principles and Criteria in November 1994 as a performance-based, outcome-orientated, worldwide standard. The Principles and Criteria focus on field performance of forest management rather than on the management systems for delivering that field performance.

There is no hierarchy between the Principles or between Criteria. They share equal status, validity and authority, and apply jointly and severally at the level of the individual Management Unit.

The FSC Principles and Criteria together with the International Generic Indicators (IGI) provide the basis for the development of locally adapted Forest Stewardship Standards (FSS).

# B PREAMBLE

## B.1 Objective

(Informative section)

The objective of this standard is to provide a set of requirements for:

- 1. The Organization to implement responsible forest management within their Management Unit and to demonstrate conformity.
- 2. FSC accredited certification bodies (CBs) to determine conformity against this standard as the basis for granting, maintaining or renewing and renewing forest management certification.

## B.2 Scope

(Normative section)

This standard shall be applied in the following scope:

|                                                                              |                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Geographic region                                                            | Country official name / Region or province name |
| Forest types                                                                 | >choose<                                        |
| Ownership types                                                              | >choose<                                        |
| Scale and intensity categories<br>(According to section 6 of FSC-STD-60-002) | >choose<                                        |
| Forest products<br>(According to FSC-STD-40-004a)                            | >choose< (if applicable: list NTFP)             |

## B.3 Responsibility for conformity

(Normative section)

The requirements in this standard cover all of The Organization’s management activities that are related to the Management Unit, whether within the Management Unit or outside; whether directly undertaken or contracted out.

In terms of geographical space, the requirements in this standard apply generally to the entire geographic space inside the boundary of the Management Unit which is being submitted for (re)certification. However, some of the Criteria and indicators apply beyond the boundary of the Management Unit. This would include those infrastructural facilities that are part of the Management Unit, as defined by the FSC Principles and Criteria.

This standard is to be used in conjunction with international, national and local laws and regulations.

Where there might be situations of conflict between the requirements in this standard and laws, specific FSC procedures will apply.

Responsibility for ensuring conformity with the requirements in this standard lies with the person(s) or entities that is/are the certificate applicant or holder. For the purpose of FSC certification, this person(s) or entities are referred to as ‘The Organization’.

The Organization is responsible for decisions, policies and management activities related to the Management Unit.

The Organization is also responsible for demonstrating that other persons or entities that are permitted or contracted by The Organization to operate in, or for the benefit of the Management Unit, conform with the requirements in this standard.

The Organization is required to take corrective actions in the event of such persons or entities not being in conformity with the requirements in this standard.

**B.4 Note on the use of indicators and other elements in the standard**

(Normative section)

Normative elements in the standard are:

Scope, effective date, validity period, glossary of terms, principles, criteria, indicators, tables and annexes, (as well as other addenda which might be produced in association with this standard) unless indicated otherwise).

Note: With regard to the auditing of Annexes, when an indicator refers to an Annex, the conformity assessment shall cover both the indicator and the corresponding requirements in the Annex, unless the Annex is explicitly categorized as ‘informative’.

Sub-indicators in an Annex contribute to the conformity assessment at the level of criterion in the same way as sub-indicators listed in an indicator within the main body of the standard.

Non-normative elements in the standard that can be used for guidance only, are:

Verifiers, notes, guidelines and examples which are attached to some of the indicators (as well as other guidance/applicability notes which might be produced in association with this standard).

Auditors may use other means for verification where appropriate. The Organization may also use verifiers as a guide to what may be required to demonstrate conformity.

“SLIMF” (small or low-intensity managed forest(s)): The Organizations managing Management Units which qualify as SLIMF shall conform with all indicators in the standard, except where specific SLIMF indicators exist (marked as e.g., “SLIMF 3.5.1”), The Organizations above shall conform with them instead.

| SLIMF eligibility criteria     | Thresholds                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Small Management Units         | Up to 100 hectares                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Low intensity Management Units | <p>The rate of harvesting is less than 20% of the mean annual increment (MAI) within the total production forest area of the unit, AND</p> <p>EITHER the annual harvest from the total production forest area is less than 5000 cubic meters,</p> <p>OR the <i>average</i> annual harvest from the total production forest is less than 5000 m3 / year during</p> |



---

the period of validity of the certificate as verified by harvest reports and surveillance audits.

---

Organizations including NTFPs in their certification scope shall conform with all indicators in the standard. Where specific NTFP indicators exist (marked as e.g., “NTFP 8.5.1”), these Organizations shall conform with them in addition.

### Verbal forms for the expression of provisions

[Adapted from *ISO/IEC Directives Part 2: Rules for the structure and drafting of International Standards*]

---

**“shall”** : indicates requirements strictly to be followed in order to conform with the standard; ‘shall not’ indicates a prohibition.

---

**“should”** : indicates that among several possibilities one is recommended as particularly suitable, without mentioning or excluding others, or that a certain course of action is preferred but not necessarily re-quired. The Organization can meet these requirements in an equivalent way provided this can be demonstrated and justified.

---

**“may”** : indicates a course of action permissible within the limits of the standard; ‘need not’ indicates that a specified course of action is not a requirement.

---

**“can”** : is used for statements of possibility and capability, whether mate-rial, physical or causal.

---

The text of the Principles and the Criteria under section F contain terms that are formatted in italics and marked with an *asterisk\**. These terms are defined in the annex of Glossary of terms. The terms that have been marked with an *asterisk\** and formatted in italics in the indicators’ text, are local terms which have been added to apply to the local circumstances for this standard only. These local terms are defined in the annex of Glossary of terms.

## B.5 Interpretations and disputes

(Normative section)

Interpretation requests regarding the FSC Forest Stewardship Standards are submitted through the National Offices and in case there is no National Office, directly to FSC for processing and approval. Approved interpretations are published in the international FSC website (see: INT-STD-60-006\_01).

Disputes between stakeholders concerning certification requirements are managed by FSC dispute resolution procedure (see: <FSC-PRO-01-008-Processing Complaints in the FSC Certification Scheme Procedure>).

## C CONTEXT

(Informative section)

### C.1 General description of the forestry sector

Click or tap here to enter text.

### C.2 Members of the Standards Development Group

Click or tap here to enter text.

### C.3 Expert advising the Standard Development Group

Click or tap here to enter text.

### C.4 Background information on the standard development

This standard was developed according to the rules and regulations laid out in FSC-STD-60-006 V1-2 in the period from [Click to choose a date] to [Click to choose a date]. One/Two stakeholder consultation(s) was/were conducted. The first consultation was conducted from [Click to choose a date] to [Click to choose a date]. The second consultation was conducted from [Click to choose a date] to [Click to choose a date].

Note: Further information is available from PSU upon request.

## D REFERENCES

(Informative section)

The following referenced documents are indispensable for the application of this standard. For references without a version number, the latest edition of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

---

|                       |                                                                            |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-POL-20-003</b> | <i>FSC Policy on the Excision of Areas from the Scope of Certification</i> |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-POL-30-001</b> | <i>FSC Pesticides Policy</i> |
|-----------------------|------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                                                   |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-POL-30-602</b> | <i>FSC Interpretation on GMOs: Genetically Modified Organisms</i> |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                      |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-STD-20-007</b> | <i>Forest Management Evaluations</i> |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                                             |               |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>FSC-STD-30-005</b> | <i>FSC Standard for Group Entities in Forest Management</i> | <i>Groups</i> |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|

---

|                       |                                                              |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-PRO-01-008</b> | <i>Processing Complaints in the FSC Certification Scheme</i> |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                                                            |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-PRO-30-006</b> | <i>Ecosystem Services Procedure: Impact Demonstration and Market Tools</i> |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                                           |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-DIR-20-007</b> | <i>FSC Directive on FSC Forest Management Evaluations</i> |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-GUI-30-003</b> | <i>FSC Guidelines for the implementation of the right to Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)</i> |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

---

|                       |                                                                           |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC-GUI-60-005</b> | <i>Promoting Gender Equality in National Forest Stewardship Standards</i> |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|

---

**Note:** When applying this standard, consider relevant interpretations by inquiring with local FSC representatives (e.g., National Offices or representatives, or FSC's Performance and Standards Unit, if no national FSC presence exists), or your certification body. International interpretations are available through the FSC Document Centre (<https://fsc.org/en/document-centre>).

# E ABBREVIATIONS

(Informative section)

|             |                                     |
|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>FSC</b>  | Forest Stewardship Council          |
| <b>IFSS</b> | Interim Forest Stewardship Standard |
| <b>NF</b>   | Normative Framework                 |
| <b>FSS</b>  | Forest Stewardship Standard         |
| <b>NRA</b>  | National Risk Assessment            |
| <b>PSU</b>  | Performance and Standards Unit      |
| <b>QMS</b>  | Quality Management System           |

## F PRINCIPLES\*, CRITERIA\* AND INDICATORS\*

(Normative section)

### PRINCIPLE\* 1: COMPLIANCE WITH LAWS

**The Organization\*** shall comply with all applicable *laws\**, regulations and *nationally-ratified\** international treaties, conventions and agreements.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall:

- Identify where *customary rights\** govern use and access, and, where applicable, write additional indicators to ensure that these rights to carry out activities within the scope of the certificate are documented (*Indicator\** 1.1.1.);
- Identify the appropriate process that recognizes and grants *customary rights\** related to use and access and how such recognized *customary rights\** are to be documented (*Indicator\** 1.2.1.);
- Identify where *customary tenures\** to manage and use resources exist at the national level and ensure that these are incorporated into indicators (*Indicator\** 1.2.1.).

*Customary rights\** are further addressed under *Principles\** 3 and 4.

---

**1.1. The Organization\*** shall be a legally defined entity with clear, documented and unchallenged *legal registration\**, with written authorization from the *legally competent\** authority for specific activities.

1.1.1. *Legal registration\** to carry out all activities within the scope of the certificate is documented and unchallenged.

1.1.2. *Legal registration\** is granted by a *legally competent\** authority according to legally prescribed processes.

**1.2. The Organization\*** shall demonstrate that the *legal\** status of the *Management Unit\**, including *tenure\** and *use rights\**, and its boundaries, are clearly defined.

1.2.1. Legal tenure to manage and use resources within the scope of the certificate is documented.

1.2.2. *Legal\* tenure\** is granted by a *legally competent\** authority according to legally prescribed processes.

1.2.3. The boundaries of all *Management Units\** within the scope of the certificate are clearly marked or documented and clearly shown on maps.

- 1.3. **The Organization\*** shall have *legal\** rights to operate in the *Management Unit\**, which fit the *legal\** status of *The Organization\** and of the *Management Unit\**, and shall comply with the associated *legal\** obligations in *applicable national* and *local laws\** and regulations and administrative requirements. The *legal\** rights shall provide for harvest of products and/or supply of *ecosystem services\** from within the *Management Unit\**. *The Organization\** shall pay the legally prescribed charges associated with such rights and obligations.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall complete a list of all *applicable laws\**, *obligatory codes of practice\** and *legal\** and *customary rights\** at the national and, where applicable, sub-national level as outlined in Annex A.

- 
- 1.3.1. All activities undertaken in the *Management Unit\** are carried out in compliance with:
1. *Applicable laws\** and regulations and administrative requirements,
  2. *Legal\** and *customary rights\**; and
  3. *Obligatory codes of practice\**.
- 1.3.2. Payment is made in a *timely manner\** of all applicable legally prescribed charges connected with *forest\** management.
- 1.3.3. Activities covered by the *management plan\** are designed to comply with all *applicable laws\**.

- 1.4. **The Organization\*** shall develop and implement measures, and/or shall engage with regulatory agencies, to systematically protect the *Management Unit\** from unauthorized or illegal resource use, settlement and other illegal activities.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop indicators that apply both when the land is owned by a third party and also when *The Organization\** needs to implement a collaborative strategy with the regulatory body, landowner and/or other stakeholders to prevent, by all *reasonable\** means, illegal activities. This *Criterion\** recognizes that it is not always possible for *The Organization\** to enforce protective measures, for example when *The Organization\** is not the landowner or does not have appropriate *legal\** rights of control (Indicators 1.4.1. and 1.4.2.).

Measures to protect the *Management Unit\** from unauthorized or illegal resource use, settlement and other *illegal\** activities emphasize prevention rather than control 'after the event' and may include:

- *Forest\** roads have gates and/or have controlled access to areas of high *risk\**;
- Temporary roads are physically closed off after harvesting;
- *Forest\** roads are patrolled to detect and prevent illegal access to the *forest\**; and
- Personnel and resources have been assigned to detect and control illegal activities promptly, within their *legal\** rights\*.

- 
- 1.4.1. Measures are implemented to provide *protection\** from unauthorized or illegal harvesting, hunting, fishing, trapping, collecting, settlement and other unauthorized activities.

- 1.4.2. Where *protection\** is the *legal\** responsibility of regulatory bodies, a system is implemented to work with these regulatory bodies to identify, report, control and discourage unauthorized or illegal activities.
- 1.4.3. If illegal or unauthorized activities are detected, measures are implemented to address them.
- 1.5. **The Organization\* shall comply with the *applicable national laws\**, *local laws*, *ratified\** international conventions and *obligatory codes of practice\**, relating to the transportation and trade of forest products within and from the *Management Unit\**, and/or up to the point of first sale.**
  - 1.5.1. Compliance with applicable *national laws\**, *local laws\**, *ratified\** international conventions and *obligatory codes of practice\** relating to the transportation and trade of forest products up to the point of first sale is demonstrated.
  - 1.5.2. Compliance with CITES provisions is demonstrated, including through possession of certificates for harvest and trade in any CITES species.
- 1.6. **The Organization\* shall identify, prevent and resolve *disputes\** over issues of statutory or customary law\*, which can be settled out of court in a *timely manner\**, through engagement with affected stakeholders\*.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall include in their standards that developing a *dispute\** resolution process requires proactive and culturally *appropriate\* engagement\** to identify *disputes\**.

Identifying *Indigenous Peoples\** and *local communities\** with rights is addressed in *Criterion\** 3.1. and *Criterion\** 4.1. Control of resources and *Free Prior and Informed Consent\** is addressed in *Criterion\** 3.2. and *Criterion\** 4.2. Protection of special sites is addressed in *Criterion\** 3.5. and in *Criterion\** 4.7. Protection of *traditional knowledge\** and *intellectual property\** is addressed in *Criterion\** 3.6. and *Criterion\** 4.8.

*Disputes\** could also be about *legal\** and *customary rights\** including *forest\** ownership, challenged title to the land, and challenged ownership of *forest\** concessions or *tenures\** (*Indicator\** 1.6.1.).

Standard Developers shall develop a methodology to implement a *culturally appropriate\* dispute\** resolution process following the requirements of *Criterion\** 7.6.

*Disputes\** appear in *Criterion\** 1.6. related to legal tenure; in *Criterion\** 2.6. related to workers grievances; and in *Criterion\** 4.6. related to local communities and individuals, with regards to the impacts of management activities.

- 1.6.1. A *publicly available\* dispute\** resolution process is in place; developed through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *affected stakeholders\**.
- 1.6.2. *Disputes\** related to issues of *applicable laws\** or *customary law\** that can be settled out of court are responded to in a *timely manner\**, and are either resolved or are in the *dispute\** resolution process.
- 1.6.3. Up to date records of disputes related to issues of *applicable laws\** or customary law, are held including:
  1. Steps taken to resolve *disputes\**;

2. Outcomes of all *dispute\** resolution processes; and
  3. Unresolved *disputes\**, the reasons they are not resolved, and how they will be resolved.
- 1.6.4. Operations cease in areas where *disputes\** exist:
1. Of *substantial magnitude\**; or
  2. Of *substantial duration\**; or
  3. Involving a *significant\** number of interests.

**1.7. *The Organization\** shall publicize a commitment not to offer or receive bribes in money or any other form of corruption, and shall comply with anti-corruption legislation where this exists. In the absence of anti-corruption legislation, *The Organization\** shall implement other anti-corruption measures proportionate to the *scale\** and *intensity\** of management activities and the *risk\** of corruption.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This *Criterion\** recognizes that corruption is generally regarded as illegal but that not all countries have or implement anti-corruption laws and regulations.

Where anti-corruption laws and regulations are ineffective or do not exist, Standard Developers shall include other anti-corruption measures that may include for example, *The Organization\** develops or participates in formal integrity pacts with other organizations in the public and private sectors, such that each participant agrees in well publicized statements not to engage in corruption by offering or receiving bribes, whether in money or in any other forms (*Indicator\** 1.7.4.).

An independent third party with expertise in such matters should then *monitor\** performance related to such statements.

- 
- 1.7.1. A policy is implemented that includes a commitment not to offer or receive bribes of any description.
  - 1.7.2. The policy meets or exceeds related legislation.
  - 1.7.3. The policy is *publicly available\** at no cost.
  - 1.7.4. Bribery, coercion and other acts of corruption do not occur.
  - 1.7.5. Corrective measures are implemented if corruption does occur.

**1.8. *The Organization\** shall demonstrate a *long-term\** commitment to adhere to the FSC *Principles\** and *Criteria\** in the *Management Unit\**, and to related FSC Policies and Standards. A statement of this commitment shall be contained in a *publicly available\** document made freely available.**

- 1.8.1. A written policy, endorsed by an individual with authority to implement the policy, includes a *long-term\** commitment to *forest\** management practices consistent with FSC *Principles\** and *Criteria\** and related Policies and Standards.
- 1.8.2. The policy is *publicly available\** at no cost.



## PRINCIPLE\* 2: WORKERS\* RIGHTS AND EMPLOYMENT CONDITIONS

*The Organization\** shall maintain or enhance the social and economic wellbeing of *workers\**.

2.1. *The Organization\** shall *uphold\** the principles and rights at work as defined in the *ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work\** (1998) based on the eight *ILO Core Labour Conventions\**.



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall give *due consideration\** to the rights and obligations established by national law, while at the same time fulfilling the objectives of the indicators and sub-indicators in this *criterion\**.

- 
- 2.1.1. *The Organization\** shall not use *child\** labour.
- 2.1.1.1. *The Organization\** shall not employ *workers\** below the age of 15, or below the *minimum age\** as stated under national, or local laws or regulations, whichever age is higher, except as specified in 2.1.1.2.
- 2.1.1.2. In countries where the *national law\** or regulations permit the employment of persons between the ages of 13 to 15 years in *light work\** such employment should not interfere with schooling nor, be harmful to their health or development. Notably, where children are subject to compulsory education laws, they shall work only outside of school hours during normal day-time working hours.
- 2.1.1.3. No person under the age of 18 is employed in *hazardous\** or *heavy work\** except for the purpose of training within approved *national laws\** and regulation.
- 2.1.1.4. *The Organization\** shall prohibit *worst forms of child labour\**.
- 2.1.2. *The Organization\** shall eliminate all forms of forced and compulsory labour.
- 2.1.2.1. Employment relationships are voluntary and based on mutual consent, without threat of a penalty.
- 2.1.2.2. There is no evidence of any practices indicative of *forced or compulsory labour\**, including, but not limited to, the following:
- Physical and sexual violence
  - Bonded labour
  - Withholding of wages /including payment of employment fees and or payment of deposit to commence employment
  - Restriction of mobility/movement
  - Retention of passport and identity documents
  - Threats of denunciation to the authorities.
- 2.1.3. *The Organization\** shall ensure that there is no *discrimination\** in employment and occupation.
- 2.1.3.1. *Employment and occupation\** practices are non-discriminatory.
- 2.1.4. *The Organization\** shall respect freedom of association and the right to collective bargaining.
- 2.1.4.1. *Workers\** are able to establish or join *worker organizations\** of their own choosing.

2.1.4.2. *The Organization\** respects the rights of workers to engage in lawful activities related to forming, joining or assisting a *workers' organization\**, or to refrain from doing the same; and will not discriminate or punish workers for exercising these rights.

2.1.4.3. *The Organization\** negotiates with lawfully established *workers' organizations\** and/or duly selected representatives in *good faith\** and with the best efforts to reach a *collective bargaining\** agreement.

2.1.4.4. *Collective bargaining\** agreements are implemented where they exist.

**2.2. *The Organization\** shall promote *gender equality\** in employment practices, training opportunities, awarding of contracts, processes of *engagement\** and management activities.**



**INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:**

Standard Developers shall identify national laws and regulations regarding *gender equality\** in employment practices, training opportunities, awarding of contracts, processes of *engagement\** and management activities. Standard Developers shall identify any gaps between the requirements of this *criterion\** and national regulations and develop indicators that describe actions to be taken by *The Organization\** to fill these gaps. Filling these gaps may in some cases require additional systems to be put in place by *The Organization\** and these may include:

- Providing training opportunities for women in the skills required to advance their careers;
- Providing programs that assist women to secure employment at all levels of *The Organization\**, including mentoring and leadership training;
- Developing alternate payment methods to ensure safety of women workers, such as direct payments for school fees;
- Providing flexible working policies and practices for parents such as flexible hours, job-sharing and home-working around school times;
- Encouraging men to take paternity leave to support their families;
- Providing alternate assignments without wage reduction when pregnancy requires a less physically demanding job assignment; and
- Providing facilities for pregnant and breast-feeding women and day care facilities for pre-school age children.

---

2.2.1. Systems are implemented that promote *gender equality\** and prevent gender *discrimination\** in employment practices, training opportunities, awarding of contracts, processes of *engagement\** and management activities.

2.2.2. Job opportunities are open to both women and men under the same conditions, and women are encouraged to participate actively in all levels of employment.

2.2.3. Work typically carried out by women (nurseries, silviculture, Non Timber Forest Product harvesting, weighing, packing, etc.) is included in training and health & safety programs to the same extent as work typically carried out by men.

2.2.4. Women and men are paid the same wage when they do the same work.

2.2.5. Women are paid directly and using mutually agreed methods (e.g. direct bank transfer, direct payments for school fees, etc.) to ensure they safely receive and retain their wages.

- 2.2.6. Maternity leave is no less than a six-week period after childbirth.
- 2.2.7. Paternity leave is available and there is no penalty for taking it.
- 2.2.8. Meetings, management committees and decision-making forums are organized to include women and men, and to facilitate the active participation of both.
- 2.2.9. Confidential and effective mechanisms exist for reporting and eliminating cases of sexual harassment and *discrimination*\* based on gender, marital status, parenthood or sexual orientation.

**2.3. *The Organization*\* shall implement health and safety practices to protect *workers*\* from occupational safety and health hazards. These practices shall, proportionate to *scale, intensity and risk*\* of management activities, meet or exceed the recommendations of the ILO Code of Practice on Safety and Health in Forestry Work.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall identify in Annex A Section 3.4 national laws and regulations regarding *workers*\* health and safety that meet or exceed the ILO Code of Practice on Safety and Health in Forestry Work and ILO Convention 155, Occupational Safety and Health Convention (1981). Standard Developers shall identify any gaps between the requirements of this *Criterion*\* and national regulations and describe how these gaps are to be addressed by *The Organization*\* (*Indicator*\* 2.3.1.).

- 
- 2.3.1. Health and safety practices are developed and implemented that meet or exceed the ILO Code of Practice on Safety and Health in Forestry Work.
  - 2.3.2. *Workers*\* have personal protective equipment appropriate to their assigned tasks.
  - 2.3.3. Use of personal protective equipment is enforced.
  - 2.3.4. Records are kept on health and safety practices including accident rates and lost time to accidents.
  - 2.3.5. The frequency and severity of accidents are consistently low compared to national *forest*\* industry averages.
  - 2.3.6. The health and safety practices are reviewed and revised as required after major incidents or accidents.

- 2.4. ***The Organization\**** shall pay wages that meet or exceed minimum *forest\** industry standards or other recognized *forest\** industry wage agreements or *living wages\**, where these are higher than the *legal\** minimum wages. When none of these exist, ***The Organization\**** shall through *engagement\** with *workers\** develop mechanisms for determining *living wages\**.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall identify all *forest\** industry standards, other recognized *forest\** industry wage agreements and *living wage\** benchmarks and identify which of these are higher than the *legal\** minimum wages and by how much. Standard Developers shall adapt indicators 2.4.2. and 2.4.3. based on this gap analysis.

Standard Developers may use methods to determine *living wages\** which are under development by ISEAL.

The approach used to define *living wages\** shall be *culturally appropriate\** following the requirements of *Criterion\** 7.6 (*Indicator\** 2.4.3.).

- 
- 2.4.1. Wages paid by *The Organization\** in all circumstances meet or exceed *legal\** minimum wage rates, where such rates exist.
  - 2.4.2. Wages paid meet or exceed:
    - 1) Minimum *forest\** industry standards; or
    - 2) Other recognized *forest\** industry wage agreements; or
    - 3) *Living wages\** that are higher than *legal\** minimum wages.
  - 2.4.3. When no minimum wage levels exist, wages are established through culturally appropriate\* *engagement\** with *workers\** and/or *formal and informal workers organizations\**.
  - 2.4.4. Wages, salaries and contracts are paid on time.

- 2.5. ***The Organization\**** shall demonstrate that *workers\** have job-specific training and supervision to safely and effectively implement the *Management Plan\** and all management activities.

- 2.5.1. *Workers\** have job specific training consistent with Annex B and supervision to safely and effectively contribute to the implementation of the *management plan\** and all management activities.
- 2.5.2. Up to date training records are kept for all relevant *workers\**.

- 2.6. ***The Organization\**** through ***engagement\**** with ***workers\**** shall have mechanisms for resolving grievances and for providing ***fair compensation\**** to ***workers\**** for loss or damage to property, ***occupational diseases\****, or ***occupational injuries\**** sustained while working for ***The Organization\****.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Grievances with *workers\** can often be on the grounds of race, gender or sexual orientation. This means Standard Developers shall develop indicators to ensure that culturally *appropriate\* engagement\** is used to define *dispute\** resolution processes following the requirements of *Criterion\* 7.6 (Indicator\* 2.6.1.)*.

- 
- 2.6.1. A *dispute\** resolution process is in place, developed through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *workers\**.
  - 2.6.2. *Workers\** grievances are identified and responded to and are either resolved or are in the *dispute\** resolution process.
  - 2.6.3. Up-to-date records of *workers\** grievances related to *workers\** loss or damage of property, *occupational diseases\** or injuries are maintained including:
    - 1) Steps taken to resolve grievances;
    - 2) Outcomes of all *dispute\** resolution processes including *fair compensation\**; and
    - 3) Unresolved *disputes\**, the reasons they are not resolved, and how they will be resolved.
  - 2.6.4. *Fair compensation\** is provided to *workers\** for work-related loss or damage of property and *occupational disease\** or injuries.

### PRINCIPLE\* 3: INDIGENOUS PEOPLES\* RIGHTS

**The Organization\*** shall identify and *uphold\** *Indigenous Peoples'* *legal\* and customary rights\** of ownership, use and management of land, *territories\** and resources affected by management activities.

3.1. **The Organization\*** shall identify the *Indigenous Peoples\** that exist within the *Management Unit\** or those that are affected by management activities. **The Organization\*** shall then, through *engagement\** with these *Indigenous Peoples*, identify their rights of *tenure\**, their rights of access to and use of *forest\** resources and *ecosystem services\**, their *customary rights\** and *legal\** rights and obligations, that apply within the *Management Unit\**. **The Organization\*** shall also identify areas where these rights are contested.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This *Criterion\** requires identification of *Indigenous Peoples\** with a fair and legitimate claim to be allowed access to benefits, goods or *ecosystem services\** from the *Management Unit\**. They include those who have affirmed their rights to land, *forests\** and other resources based on long established use, and also those who have not yet done so (due for example, to a lack of awareness or empowerment) (*Indicator\** 3.1.1).

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to ensure that where there is no written text or records to support these claims to rights, *culturally appropriate\** ways for identifying, agreeing to and documenting the rights and obligations of *Indigenous Peoples\** are used.

Standard Developers shall develop a methodology to implement *culturally appropriate\** approaches to identify and document the rights and obligations of *Indigenous Peoples\** following the requirements of *Criterion\** 7.6 (*Indicator\** 3.1.2).

Standard Developers shall develop a *culturally appropriate\** methodology through the *Free, Prior and Informed Consent\** of affected *rights holders\**, to identify and document the rights and obligations of *Indigenous Peoples\**, including *Indigenous cultural landscapes\**, ecological and cultural values and other *legal\** and *customary rights\** as identified under *Criteria\** 3.1., 3.4., 3.5. and 4.1., consistent with the requirements of *Criterion\** 7.6. (*Indicator\** 3.1.2.).

In addition, the rights of isolation should be respected for *Indigenous Peoples\** that do not want to be contacted (e.g. Peru, Brazil) through the development of a respective indicator (*Indicator\** 3.1.2.).

*Indigenous Peoples\** affected by management activities include those neighbouring the *Management Unit\**, and those that are more distant, who may experience negative impacts as a result of activities within the *Management Unit\**.

Mechanisms to address *disputes\** with *Indigenous peoples\** shall follow the requirements in *Criterion\** 1.6 if they are related to legal tenure; and follow the requirements in *Criterion\** 4.6 if they are related to the impacts of management activities (*Indicator\** 3.1.2.).

---

3.1.1. *Indigenous Peoples\** that may be affected by management activities are identified.

3.1.2. Through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with the *Indigenous Peoples\** identified in 3.1.1, the following are documented and/or mapped:

- 1) Their *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *tenure\**;
- 2) Their *legal\** and *customary\** access to, and *use rights\**, of the *forest\** resources and



*ecosystem services\**,

- 3) Their *legal\** and *customary rights\** and obligations that apply;
- 4) The evidence supporting these rights and obligations;
- 5) Areas where rights are contested between *Indigenous Peoples\**, governments and/or others;
- 6) Summary of the means by which the *legal\** and *customary rights\** and contested rights, are addressed by *The Organization\**; and
- 7) The aspirations and goals of *Indigenous Peoples\** related to management activities, *Intact Forest Landscapes\** and *Indigenous cultural landscapes\**.

**3.2. The Organization\* shall recognize and uphold\* the legal\* and customary rights\* of Indigenous Peoples\* to maintain control over management activities within or related to the Management Unit\* to the extent necessary to protect their rights, resources and lands and territories\*. Delegation by Indigenous Peoples of control over management activities to third parties requires Free, Prior and Informed Consent\*.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall consider the applicability of active *engagement\** and co-management at the national and sub-national level (Indicator 3.2.1. and 3.2.4.).

Standard Developers shall ensure that *good faith\** is understood as a term used in ILO Conventions and recognized as an auditable element. (Indicator 3.2.5.)

- 
- 3.2.1. Through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** *Indigenous Peoples\** are informed when, where and how they can comment on and request modification to management activities to the extent necessary to protect their rights, resources, *lands and territories\**.
  - 3.2.2. The *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *Indigenous Peoples\** are not violated by *The Organization\**.
  - 3.2.3. Where evidence exists that *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *Indigenous Peoples\** related to management activities have been violated the situation is corrected, if necessary, through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** and/or through the *dispute\** resolution process as required in *Criteria\** 1.6 or 4.6.
  - 3.2.4. *Free, prior and informed consent\** is granted by *Indigenous Peoples\** prior to management activities that affect their identified rights through a process that includes:
    - 1) Ensuring *Indigenous Peoples\** know their rights and obligations regarding the resource;
    - 2) Informing the *Indigenous Peoples\** of the value of the resource, in economic, social and environmental terms;
    - 3) Informing the *Indigenous Peoples\** of their right to withhold or modify consent to the proposed management activities to the extent necessary to protect their rights, resources, lands and *territories\**; and
    - 4) Informing the *Indigenous Peoples\** of the current and future planned *forest\** management activities.
  - 3.2.5. Where the process of *Free Prior and Informed Consent\** has not yet resulted in an FPIC agreement, *The Organization\** and the affected *Indigenous Peoples\** are engaged in a

mutually agreed FPIC process that is advancing, in *good faith*\* and with which the community is satisfied.

- 3.3. In the event of delegation of control over management activities, a *binding agreement*\* between *The Organization*\* and the *Indigenous Peoples*\* shall be concluded through *Free, Prior and Informed Consent*\*. The agreement shall define its duration, provisions for renegotiation, renewal, termination, economic conditions and other terms and conditions. The agreement shall make provision for monitoring by Indigenous Peoples of *The Organization*\*'s compliance with its terms and conditions.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop indicators taking into consideration that *Indigenous Peoples*\* may choose to ratify *binding agreements*\* in writing or in another format of their choosing according to *culturally appropriate*\* *engagement*\*. *Binding agreements*\* reflect cultural requirements and may also be based on oral and honour systems, to be applied in cases where written agreements are not favoured by *Indigenous Peoples*\*, either for practical reasons or on principle.

Recognizing that *Indigenous Peoples*\* may not want to grant *Free Prior and Informed Consent*\* and/or delegate control for their own reasons, the *Indigenous Peoples*\* may choose to offer their support for management activities in a different way of their choosing (Indicator 3.3.1. and 3.3.2.).

- 
- 3.3.1. Where control over management activities has been granted through *Free Prior and Informed Consent*\* based on *culturally appropriate*\* *engagement*\*, the *binding agreement*\* contains the duration, provisions for renegotiation, renewal, termination, economic conditions and other terms and conditions.
- 3.3.2. Records of *binding agreements*\* are maintained.
- 3.3.3. The *binding agreement*\* contains the provision for monitoring by *Indigenous Peoples*\* of *The Organization*\*'s compliance with its terms and conditions.



**3.4. The Organization\* shall recognize and uphold\* the rights, customs and culture of Indigenous Peoples\* as defined in the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (2007) and ILO Convention 169 (1989).**



**INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:**

Standard Developers shall ensure that United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (2007) and ILO Convention 169 (1989) requirements are included in FSS. This *Criterion\** refers to those articles of the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (2007) and ILO Convention 169 (1989) that cover explicitly the rights, customs and culture and spiritual relationship between *Indigenous Peoples\** and the *Management Unit\**.

This *Criterion\** applies also in countries and jurisdictions that have not endorsed the UN Declaration and/or *ratified\** ILO Convention 169. As a result, compliance with this *Criterion\** may exceed *The Organization's\** legal\* obligations in the country or jurisdiction within which the *Management Unit\** lies.

Where this *Criterion\** is in conflict with laws, separate FSC procedures apply (see FSC-STD-20-007 Forest Management Evaluations). Such 'conflicts' are defined as situations where it is not possible to comply with the *Principles\** and *Criteria\** and a law at the same time (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2). In the case of this *Criterion\**, an example would be that one or more articles of the ILO Convention 169 are in conflict with a specific national law (*Indicator\** 3.4.1.).

---

3.4.1. The rights, customs and culture of *Indigenous Peoples\** as defined in UNDRIP and ILO Convention 169 are not violated by *The Organization\**.

3.4.2. Where evidence that rights, customs and culture of *Indigenous Peoples\**, as defined in UNDRIP and ILO Convention 169, have been violated by *The Organization\**, the situation is documented including steps to *restore\** these rights, customs and culture of *Indigenous Peoples\**, to the satisfaction of the rights holders.

**3.5. The Organization\*, through engagement\* with Indigenous Peoples\*, shall identify sites which are of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance and for which these Indigenous Peoples hold legal\* or customary rights\*. These sites shall be recognized by The Organization\* and their management, and/or protection\* shall be agreed through engagement\* with these Indigenous Peoples.**

3.5.1. Sites of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance for which *Indigenous Peoples\** hold *legal\** or *customary rights\** are identified through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\**.

3.5.2. Measures to protect such sites are agreed, documented and implemented through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *Indigenous Peoples\**. When *Indigenous Peoples\** determine that physical identification of sites in documentation or on maps would threaten the value or *protection\** of the sites, then other means will be used.

3.5.3. Wherever sites of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance are newly observed or discovered, management activities cease immediately in the vicinity until protective measures have been agreed to with the *Indigenous Peoples\**, and as directed by local and *national laws\**.

**3.6. The Organization\* shall uphold\* the right of Indigenous Peoples\* to protect\* and utilize their traditional knowledge\* and shall compensate local communities\* for the utilization of such**

knowledge and their *intellectual property*\*. A *binding agreement*\* as per *Criterion*\* 3.3 shall be concluded between *The Organization*\* and the Indigenous Peoples for such utilization through *Free, Prior and Informed Consent*\* before utilization takes place, and shall be consistent with the *protection*\* of *intellectual property*\* rights.

- 3.6.1. *Traditional knowledge*\* and *intellectual property*\* are protected and are only used when the acknowledged owners of that *traditional knowledge*\* and *intellectual property*\* have provided their *Free, Prior and Informed Consent*\* formalized through a *binding agreement*\*.
- 3.6.2. *Indigenous Peoples*\* are compensated according to the *binding agreement*\* reached through *Free, Prior and Informed Consent*\* for the use of *traditional knowledge*\* and *intellectual property*\*.

## PRINCIPLE\* 4: COMMUNITY RELATIONS

**The Organization\*** shall contribute to maintaining or enhancing the social and economic wellbeing of *local communities\**.

- 4.1. **The Organization\*** shall identify the *local communities\** that exist within the *Management Unit\** and those that are affected by management activities. **The Organization\*** shall then, through engagement\* with these *local communities\**, identify their rights of *tenure\**, their rights of access to and use of *forest\** resources and *ecosystem services\**, their *customary rights\** and *legal\** rights and obligations, that apply within the *Management Unit\**.



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This *Criterion\** requires identification of *local communities\** with a fair and legitimate claim to be allowed access to benefits, goods or *ecosystem services\** from the *Management Unit\**. They include those who have affirmed their rights to land, *forests\** and other resources based on long established use, and also those who have not yet done so (due for example, to a lack of awareness or empowerment).

*Local communities\** affected by management activities include those neighbouring the *Management Unit\**, and those that are more distant, who may experience negative impacts as a result of activities within the *Management Unit\** (*Indicator\** 4.1.1.).

Mechanisms to address *disputes\** with *local communities\** shall follow the requirements in *Criterion\** 1.6 if they are related to legal tenure; and follow the requirements in *Criterion\** 4.6 if they are related to the impacts of management activities (*Indicator\** 4.1.2.).

Changes introduced by Motion 40a/2021 Review the applicability of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC) in Principle 4 imply that *local communities\** that qualify as traditional peoples\* must be identified.

- 
- 4.1.1. *Local communities\** that exist in the *Management Unit\** and those that may be affected by management activities are identified.
- 4.1.2. Through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with the *local communities\** identified in 4.1.1., the following are documented and/or mapped:
- 1) Their *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *tenure\**;
  - 2) Their *legal\** and *customary\** access to, and *use rights\**, of the *forest\** resources and *ecosystem services\**;
  - 3) Their *legal\** and *customary\* rights\** and obligations that apply;
  - 4) The evidence supporting these rights and obligations;
  - 5) Areas where rights are contested between *local communities\**, governments and/or others;
  - 6) Summary of the means by which the *legal\** and *customary rights\**, and contested rights are addressed by *The Organization\**; and
  - 7) The aspirations and goals of *local communities\** related to management activities.

- 4.2. ***The Organization\**** shall recognize and ***uphold\**** the ***legal\**** and ***customary rights\**** of ***local communities\**** to maintain control over management activities within or related to the ***Management Unit\**** to the extent necessary to protect their rights, resources, ***lands and territories\****. Delegation by ***traditional peoples\**** of control over management activities to third parties requires ***Free, Prior and Informed Consent\****.



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall ensure that *good faith\** is understood as a term used in ILO Conventions and recognized as an auditable element. (*Indicator\** 4.2.5.)

- 
- 4.2.1. Through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** *local communities\** are informed of when, where and how they can comment on and request modification to management activities to the extent necessary to protect their rights.
- 4.2.2. *The legal\** and *customary rights\** of *local communities\** to maintain control over management activities are not violated by *The Organization\**.
- 4.2.3. Where evidence exists that *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *local communities\** related to management activities have been violated the situation is corrected, if necessary, through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** and/or through the *dispute\** resolution process in *Criteria\** 1.6 or 4.6.
- 4.2.4. *Free, Prior and Informed Consent\** is granted by *traditional peoples\** prior to management activities that affect their identified rights through a process that includes:
- 1) Ensuring *traditional peoples\** know their rights and obligations regarding the resource;
  - 2) Informing the *traditional peoples\** of the value of the resource, in economic, social and environmental terms;
  - 3) Informing the *traditional peoples\** of their right to withhold or modify consent to the proposed management activities to the extent necessary to protect their rights and resources; and
  - 4) Informing the *traditional peoples\** of the current and future planned *forest\** management activities.
- 4.2.5. Where the process of *Free Prior and Informed Consent\** has not yet resulted in an FPIC agreement, *the Organization\** and the affected *traditional peoples\** are engaged in a mutually agreed FPIC process that is advancing, in *good faith\** and with which the community is satisfied.
- 4.X. **In the event of delegation of control over management activities, a *binding agreement\** between *The Organization\** and the *traditional peoples\** shall be concluded through *Free, Prior, and Informed Consent\**. The agreement shall define its duration, provisions for renegotiation, renewal, termination, economic conditions and other terms and conditions. The agreement shall make provision for monitoring by *traditional peoples\** of *The Organization's\** compliance with its terms and conditions.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS: Standard Developers should not develop indicators for the new Criterion\* 4.X until the corresponding International Generic Indicators have been developed.

4.3. **The Organization\*** shall provide *reasonable\** opportunities for employment, training and other services to *local communities\**, contractors and suppliers proportionate to *scale\** and *intensity\** of its management activities.

4.3.1. *Reasonable\** opportunities are communicated and provided to *local communities\**, local contractors and local suppliers for:

- 1) Employment,
- 2) Training, and
- 3) Other services.

4.4. **The Organization\*** shall implement additional activities, through *engagement\** with *local communities\**, that contribute to their social and economic development, proportionate to the *scale\**, *intensity\** and socio-economic impact of its management activities.

4.4.1. Opportunities for local social and economic development are identified through *culturally appropriate \** *engagement\** with *local communities\** and other relevant organizations.

4.4.2. Projects and additional activities are implemented and/or supported that contribute to local social and economic benefit and are proportionate to the socio-economic impact of management activities.

4.5. **The Organization\***, through *engagement\** with *local communities\**, shall take action to identify, avoid and mitigate *significant\** negative social, environmental and economic impacts of its management activities on affected communities. The action taken shall be proportionate to the *scale*, *intensity and risk\** of those activities and negative impacts.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This *Criterion\** does not prohibit *The Organization\** from providing services to *local communities\** and thereby competing with services provided by local businesses, for example transport services or company stores that are open not only to *workers\** but also to local people.

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to define the degree to which *The Organization\** has a responsibility to contribute to mitigating the resulting negative social and economic impacts on affected communities (*Indicator\** 4.5.1).

---

4.5.1 Through *culturally appropriate\** *engagement\** with *local communities\**, measures are implemented to identify, avoid and mitigate *significant\** negative social, environmental and economic impacts of management activities.

4.6. **The Organization\***, through *engagement\** with *local communities\**, shall have mechanisms for resolving grievances and providing *fair compensation\** to *local communities\** and individuals with regard to the impacts of management activities of *The Organization\**.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop a methodology to implement a *culturally appropriate\** *dispute\** resolution process following the requirements of *Criterion\** 7.6.

---

4.6.1. A *publicly available\** *dispute\** resolution process is in place, developed through *culturally appropriate\** *engagement\** with *local communities\**.

- 4.6.2. Grievances related to the impacts of management activities are responded to in a *timely manner\**, and are either resolved or are in the *dispute\** resolution process.
- 4.6.3. An up to date record of grievances related to the impacts of management activities is held including:
  - 1) Steps taken to resolve grievances;
  - 2) Outcomes of all *dispute\** resolution processes including fair *compensation\** to *local communities\** and individuals; and
  - 3) Unresolved *disputes\**, the reasons they are not resolved, and how they will be resolved.
- 4.6.4. Operations cease in areas while *disputes\** exist of:
  - 1) *Substantial magnitude\**;
  - 2) *Substantial duration\**; or
  - 3) Involving a *significant\** number of interests.
- 4.7. ***The Organization\**, through *engagement\** with *local communities\**, shall identify sites which are of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance, and for which these *local communities\** hold *legal\** or *customary rights\**. These sites shall be recognized by *The Organization\**, and their management and/or *protection\** shall be agreed through *engagement\** with these *local communities\**.**
  - 4.7.1. Sites of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance for which *local communities\** hold *legal\** or *customary rights\** are identified through culturally appropriate\* *engagement\** and are recognized by *The Organization\**.
  - 4.7.2. Measures to protect such sites are agreed, documented and implemented through *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *local communities\**. When *local communities\** determine that physical identification of sites in documentation or on maps would threaten the value or *protection\** of the sites, then other means will be used.
  - 4.7.3. Whenever sites of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance are newly observed or discovered, management activities cease immediately in the vicinity until protective measures have been agreed to with the *local communities\**, and as directed by local and *national laws\**.

- 4.8. ***The Organization\**** shall ***uphold\**** the right of ***traditional peoples\**** to ***protect\**** and utilize their ***traditional knowledge\**** and shall compensate ***traditional peoples\**** for the utilization of such knowledge and their ***intellectual property\****. A ***binding agreement\**** as per ***Criterion\**** 3.3 shall be concluded between ***The Organization\**** and the ***traditional peoples\**** for such utilization through ***Free, Prior and Informed Consent\**** before utilization takes place, and shall be consistent with the ***protection\**** of ***intellectual property\**** rights.
- 4.8.1. *Traditional knowledge\** and *intellectual property\** of *traditional peoples\** are protected and are only used when the owners of that *traditional knowledge\** and *intellectual property\** have provided their *Free, Prior and Informed Consent\** formalized through a *binding agreement\**.
- 4.8.2. *Traditional peoples\** are compensated according to the *binding agreement\** reached through *Free, Prior and Informed Consent\** for the use of *traditional knowledge\** and *intellectual property\**.



## PRINCIPLE\* 5: BENEFITS FROM THE FOREST\*

*The Organization\** shall efficiently manage the range of multiple products and services of the *Management Unit\** to maintain or enhance *long-term\* economic viability\** and the range of social and environmental benefits.

- 5.1. *The Organization\** shall identify, produce, or enable the production of, diversified benefits and/or products, based on the range of resources and *ecosystem services\** existing in the *Management Unit\** in order to strengthen and diversify the local economy proportionate to the *scale\** and *intensity\** of management activities.



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

A clarification of the use of the term *management objectives\** in this standard is included under *Criterion\* 7.1* (Indicator 5.1.2.).

Standard Developers should consider that the primary *management objectives\** of *The Organization\** may be *conservation\** or *protection\** (Indicator 5.1.2.).

- 
- 5.1.1. The range of resources and *ecosystem services\** that could strengthen and diversify the local economy are identified.
  - 5.1.2. Consistent with *management objectives\**, the identified benefits and products are produced by *The Organization\** and/or made available for others to produce, to strengthen and diversify the local economy.
  - 5.1.3. When *The Organization\** uses FSC Ecosystem Services Claims, *The Organization\** shall comply with applicable requirements in FSC-PRO-30-006.



**5.2. The Organization\* shall normally harvest products and services from the Management Unit\* at or below a level which can be permanently sustained.**



**INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:**

Standard Developers shall provide clear direction to smallholders on how to complete the analysis to calculate the *timber harvesting level\**, where little or no prior analysis has been completed and/or where data is weak or does not exist (Indicators 5.2.1. and 5.2.2.). In addition, Standard Developers shall determine the appropriate spatial and temporal *scale\** regarding *forest\** productivity.

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to ensure that the rate of harvest for large, regionally dispersed *Management Units\** does not allow concentrating the annual harvest in one sub-unit or any one species in a way that compromises *The Organization's\** ability to meet all other aspects of the standard.

Standard Developers shall identify the *Best Available Information\** for each Indicator where *Best Available Information\** is a requirement (Criteria\* 5.2., 6.1., 6.4., 6.5., 6.10., 9.1., 9.2.). The lists provided in the Instructions for Standard Developers at *Criterion\** level provide examples of data to look for (*Criterion\** 5.2.) or sources of *Best Available Information\** (Criteria\* 6.1 and Principle\* 9).

Standard Developers shall specify the *Best Available Information\** that *The Organization\** shall use for Indicators 5.2.1. and 5.2.4. Examples include:

Up-to-date growth and yield information;

Up-to-date inventory data;

Volume and area reductions caused by mortality as well as natural disturbances such as fire, insects and disease; and

Volume and area reductions to account for adherence to all other requirements in this standard including *Intact Forest Landscapes\* Core Areas\**.

*The Organization\** may cut more than one year's volume within one year, provided that all other requirements of this standard are met and provided that harvest rates do not exceed the allowable cut when averaged over ten years. The ten year timeframe is the default, and deviations must be justified at the national level. Standard Developers shall determine at the national level what is the appropriate defined period, based on rotation ages of *forests\** and existing planning cycles (Indicator 5.2.3.).

Standard Developers may identify catastrophic natural disturbances (such as windthrow, fire, and pest epidemics) or *forest\** restoration *objectives\** that may warrant a temporary and non-routine annual harvest rate in excess of allowable cut levels (Indicator 5.2.3.).

Standard Developers shall identify *non-timber forest products\** in the national and regional context that may be threatened by management activities to ensure that their harvest does not threaten *environmental values\** (Indicator 5.2.4.).

Controlling and managing hunting, fishing and collecting is addressed in *Criterion\** 6.6. Controlling illegal hunting, fishing and collecting is addressed in *Criterion\** 1.4.

- 
- 5.2.1. *Timber harvesting levels\** are based on an analysis of current *Best Available Information\** on growth and yield; inventory of the *forest\**; mortality rates; and maintenance of *ecosystem functions\**.
- 5.2.2. Based on the *timber harvesting level\** analysis, a maximum allowable annual cut for timber is determined that does not exceed the harvest level that can be permanently sustained including by ensuring that harvest rates do not exceed growth.

- 5.2.3. Actual annual harvest levels for timber are recorded and the harvest over a defined period does not exceed the allowable cut determined in 5.2.2 for the same defined period.
- 5.2.4. For extraction of commercially harvested services and *non-timber forest products\** under *The Organization's\** control a sustainable harvest level is calculated and adhered to. Sustainable harvest levels are based on *Best Available Information\**.

**5.3. *The Organization\** shall demonstrate that the positive and negative externalities\* of operations are included in the management plan\*.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Social and environmental costs and benefits of management activities are often not accounted for and are known as *externalities\**. *Externalities\** may result in costs because of the need to prevent, mitigate, *restore\** or compensate negative impacts as required in these *Principles\** and *Criteria\**.

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to ensure that financial planning and cost accounting is done by *The Organization\** for the *Management Unit\**. Refer to *Criterion\** 5.5 below.

- 5.3.1. Costs related to preventing, mitigating or compensating for negative social and environment impacts of management activities are quantified and documented in the *management plan\**.
- 5.3.2. Benefits related to positive social and environment impacts of management activities are identified and included in the *management plan\**.

**5.4. *The Organization\** shall use local processing, local services, and local value adding to meet the requirements of *The Organization\** where these are available, proportionate to scale, intensity and risk\*. If these are not locally available, *The Organization\** shall make reasonable\* attempts to help establish these services.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall define what 'local' means in the context of this *Criterion\**. The intention of this *Criterion\** is for *The Organization\** to promote further socio-economic benefits through economic opportunities beyond the direct employment by *The Organization\**. The desired outcome is that *The Organization\** stimulates the local economy through the purchase of relevant local services and products, or supports the creation of relevant new local services and supply of relevant local products. In areas where local service providers are already in place, the preference is to support these businesses before hiring other service providers who are not local.

- 5.4.1. Where cost, quality and capacity of non-local and local options are at least equivalent, local goods, services, processing and value-added facilities are used.
- 5.4.2. *Reasonable\** attempts are made to establish and encourage capacity where local goods, services, processing and value-added facilities are not available.

**5.5. *The Organization\** shall demonstrate through its planning and expenditures proportionate to scale, intensity and risk\*, its commitment to long-term\* economic viability\*.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Expenditures referred to in this *Criterion\** include, for example, costs related to:

- Safeguards against ‘mining’ (over-exploitation) of the resources or ‘creaming’ (excessive selective harvesting) of the *Management Unit’s*\* most valuable species, according to *Criterion*\* 5.2.; and
- Preventing, mitigating or compensating for negative *externalities*\* as required in the *Principles and Criteria*\* (see *Criterion*\* 5.3.).

---

5.5.1. Sufficient funds are allocated to implement the *management plan*\* in order to meet this standard and to ensure *long-term\* economic viability*\*.

5.5.2. Expenditures and investments are made to implement the *management plan*\* in order to meet this standard and to ensure *long-term\* economic viability*\*.

## PRINCIPLE\* 6: ENVIRONMENTAL VALUES\* AND IMPACTS

**The Organization\* shall maintain, conserve\* and/or restore\* ecosystem services\* and environmental values\* of the Management Unit\*, and shall avoid, repair or mitigate negative environmental impacts.**



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall ensure that the flow of the *indicators\** from *Criterion\** 6.1. to 6.3. is maintained as follows:

- 6.1 Assessment of *environmental values\**.
- 6.2 *Environmental impact assessment\** of management activities on *environmental values\**.
- 6.3 Identify and implement effective actions to prevent negative impacts of management activities on the *environmental values\**.

Standard Developers shall explicitly make references to the list of rare and threatened species\* in the country or region (Annex D) in the text of indicators\* under Principle\* 6, where applicable.

---

**6.1. The Organization\* shall assess *environmental values\** in the Management Unit\* and those values outside the Management Unit\* potentially affected by management activities. This assessment shall be undertaken with a level of detail, scale and frequency that is proportionate to the *scale, intensity and risk\** of management activities, and is sufficient for the purpose of deciding the necessary *conservation\** measures, and for detecting and monitoring possible negative impacts of those activities.**



### INSTRUCTION FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall specify the *Best Available Information\** that The Organization\* shall use for *Indicator\** 6.1.1. Examples include:

- *Representative Sample Areas\** showing *environmental values\** in their *natural condition\**;
- Field surveys;
- Databases relevant to the *environmental values\**;
- Consultation with local and regional experts;
- *Culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *Indigenous Peoples\**, *local communities\** and *affected stakeholders\** and *interested stakeholders\**.

---

6.1.1. *Best Available Information\** is used to identify *environmental values\** within, and, where potentially affected by management activities, outside of the *Management Unit\**.

6.1.2. Assessments of *environmental values\** are conducted with a level of detail and frequency so that:

- 1) Impacts of management activities on the identified *environmental values\** can be assessed as per *Criterion\** 6.2;
- 2) *Risks\** to *environmental values\** can be identified as per *Criterion\** 6.2;
- 3) Necessary *conservation\** measures to protect values can be identified as per *Criterion\** 6.3; and,

- 4) Monitoring of impacts or environmental changes can be conducted as per *Principle\** 8.

**6.2. Prior to the start of site-disturbing activities, *The Organization\** shall *identify* and assess the *scale, intensity and risk\** of potential impacts of management activities on the identified *environmental values\**.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall specify the level of detail of *environmental impact assessments\** to be undertaken, subject to *scale, intensity and risk\** of management activities on *environmental values\**.

- 
- 6.2.1. An *environmental impact assessment\** identifies potential present and future impacts of management activities on *environmental values\**, from the stand level to the landscape level.
- 6.2.2. The *environmental impact assessment\** identifies and assesses the impacts of the management activities prior to the start of site-disturbing activities.

- 6.3. ***The Organization\**** shall identify and implement effective actions to prevent negative impacts of management activities on the *environmental values\**, and to mitigate and repair those that occur, proportionate to the *scale, intensity and risk\** of these impacts.



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

The projected future growth in demand for energy derived from *forest\** biomass may be accompanied by scrutiny on the *forest\** management requirements to maintain carbon sequestration and storage. *Indicators\** 6.3.1 – 6.3.3 require the prevention, mitigation and repair of impacts on *environmental values\**, which include carbon sequestration and storage. Standard Developers should consider whether national socio-economic and environmental circumstances require specific *indicators\** related to this *environmental value\**.

- 
- 6.3.1. Management activities are planned and implemented to prevent negative impacts and to protect *environmental values\**.
  - 6.3.2. Management activities prevent negative impacts to *environmental values\**.
  - 6.3.3. Where negative impacts to *environmental values\** occur, measures are adopted to prevent further damage, and negative impacts are mitigated and/or repaired.

- 6.4. **The Organization\*** shall protect *rare species\** and *threatened species\** and their *habitats\** in the *Management Unit\** through *conservation zones\**, *protection areas\**, *connectivity\** and/or (where necessary) other direct measures for their survival and viability. These measures shall be proportionate to the *scale, intensity and risk\** of management activities and to the *conservation\** status and ecological requirements of the *rare and threatened species\**. The *Organization\** shall take into account the geographic range and ecological requirements of *rare and threatened species\** beyond the boundary of the *Management Unit\**, when determining the measures to be taken inside the *Management Unit\**.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop indicators that introduce *conservation\** measures for particular groups of *rare and threatened species\** into national standards. The primary focus is on the *protection\** of *habitats\**, populations, and individuals affected by activities in the *Management Unit\**. However, where relevant, Standard Developers shall develop indicators at the national level directing *The Organization\** to coordinate with *landscape\** level *conservation\** efforts. This instruction is to complement the already mandatory Annex to national standards listing endangered species as per FSC-STD-60-002 Clause 3.5 (c).

Standard Developers shall specify the *Best Available Information\** that *The Organization\** shall use for Indicator 6.4.1.

- 
- 6.4.1. *Best Available Information\** is used to identify *rare and threatened species\**, and their *habitats\**, including CITES species (where applicable) and those listed on national, regional and local lists of *rare and threatened species\** that are present or likely to be present within and adjacent to the *Management Unit\**.
  - 6.4.2. Potential impacts of management activities on *rare and threatened species\** and their *conservation\** status and *habitats\** are identified and management activities are modified to avoid negative impacts.
  - 6.4.3. The *rare and threatened species\** and their *habitats\** are protected, including through the provision of *conservation zones\**, *protection areas\**, *connectivity\**, and other direct means for their survival and viability, such as species' recovery programs.
  - 6.4.4. Hunting, fishing, trapping and collection of *rare or threatened species\** is prevented.

- 6.5. **The Organization\*** shall identify and protect representative sample areas of native *ecosystems\** and/or *restore\** them to more *natural conditions\**. Where *representative sample areas\** do not exist or are insufficient, *The Organization\** shall *restore\** a proportion of the *Management Unit\** to more *natural conditions\**. The size of the areas and the measures taken for their protection or restoration, including within plantations, shall be proportionate to the *conservation\** status and value of the *ecosystems\** at the *landscape\** level, and the *scale, intensity and risk\** of management activities. (C6.4 and 10.5 P&C V4 and Motion 7:2014).



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall identify the methods for identifying *Representative Sample Areas\**.

*Representative Sample Areas\** perform multiple functions, including:



- Representing the *environmental values\** that exist in native *ecosystems\** and thus serve as a reference for *environmental values\** and *ecosystem services\** within the *Management Unit\**. In order to use *Representative Sample Areas\** as references for all of the *ecosystems\** that could potentially be present in the *Management Unit\**, for the purposes of 6.1.1., it may be necessary to identify *Representative Sample Areas\** outside of the *Management Unit\**. This may be the case when dealing with *Management Units\** comprised mainly of plantations.
- Informing *forest\** management, including regeneration, within the *Management Unit\** in order to maintain or enhance *environmental values\**.
- Forming part of the *Conservation Areas Network\** within the *Management Unit\**. In order to protect and conserve *environmental values\**, it may be necessary to designate and *restore\** *Representative Sample Areas\** within the *Management Unit\**. *Protection Areas\**, *Conservation zones\**, *Representative Sample Areas\** and *High Conservation Value Areas\**, may overlap spatially where they meet the same criteria to form the *Conservation Area Network\**.

Please refer to Annex C for additional information on how *Conservation Area Networks\** shall be defined.

The *Conservation Area Network\** shall be large enough to allow natural processes to take place in the absence of any direct human interference. Where *Intact Forest Landscapes\** occur, they should contribute to the *Conservation Area Network\**. Since 2011, the FSC Policy and Standards Committee, on behalf of the FSC Board of Directors, have consistently applied a minimum threshold of 10% of the *Management Unit\** to all FSC National Standards through the national standards approval process. This threshold is written in FSC Forest Stewardship Standards: structure, content and suggested *indicators\** FSC-GUI-60-004 V1-0 at *Criterion\** 6.2. This document has been the key reference for Standard Development Groups since it was approved in 2011.

- 
- 6.5.1. *Best Available Information\** is used to identify *native ecosystems\** that exist, or would exist under *natural conditions\**, within the *Management Unit \**.
  - 6.5.2. *Representative Sample Areas\** of *native ecosystems\** are protected, where they exist.
  - 6.5.3. Where *Representative Sample Areas\** do not exist, or where existing sample areas inadequately represent *native ecosystems\**, or are otherwise insufficient, a proportion of the *Management Unit\** is *restored\** to more *natural conditions\**.
  - 6.5.4. The size of the *Representative Sample Areas\** and/or *restoration\** areas is proportionate to the *conservation\** status and value of the *ecosystems\** at the *landscape\** level, the size of the *Management Unit\** and the *intensity\** of *forest\** management.
  - 6.5.5. *Representative Sample Areas\** in combination with other components of the *conservation areas network\** comprise a minimum 10% area of the *Management Unit*.
- 6.6. ***The Organization\** shall effectively maintain the continued existence of naturally occurring *native species\** and *genotypes\**, and prevent losses of *biological diversity\**, especially through *habitat\** management in the *Management Unit\**. *The Organization\** shall demonstrate that effective measures are in place to manage and control hunting, fishing, trapping and collecting.**





## INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall specify management thresholds for *habitat features\** in national standards. Thresholds for *habitat features\** that should be considered include:

- Timber harvest and *silvicultural\** methods that maintain and *restore\** *natural forest\** diversity, composition and structure;
- Thresholds and guidelines for retention of trees throughout harvest areas as individual trees or in patches or groups of live trees and snags, including trees representative of the naturally dominant species for the site;
- Thresholds and guidelines for retention and recruitment of woody debris, and other vegetation representative of the natural stand;
- Thresholds and guidelines for regulation of opening sizes and rotation lengths for even-aged operations to ensure a range of stand ages that maintain all natural *habitat\** types, prevent fragmentation and prevent cumulative watershed impacts; and
- Configuration of harvesting to ensure *connectivity\**.

- 
- 6.6.1. Management activities maintain the plant communities and *habitat features\** found within *native ecosystems\** in which the *Management Unit\** is located.
  - 6.6.2. Where past management has eliminated plant communities or *habitat features\**, management activities aimed at re-establishing such *habitats\** are implemented.
  - 6.6.3. Management maintains, enhances, or *restores\** *habitat features\** associated with *native ecosystems\**, to support the diversity of naturally occurring species and their genetic diversity.
  - 6.6.4. Effective measures are taken to manage and control hunting, fishing, trapping and collecting activities to ensure that naturally occurring *native species\**, their diversity within species and their natural distribution are maintained.



## INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

In regions where hunting is *threatening species\** diversity the following *indicators\** shall be included in FSS:

- 6.6.X. Mechanisms for wildlife *protection\** are in place: Applicable national and/or international regulations on *protection\**, hunting and trade in animal species or parts (trophies) shall be known and complied with;
- 6.6.X. An internal regulation banning and punishing the transportation of and trade in bush meat and firearms in the facilities and vehicles of *The Organization\**;
- 6.6.X. A system of regular and punctual controls to ensure hunting policies are respected is implemented;
- 6.6.X. Effective mitigation measures are in place to ensure that *workers\** do not increase hunting trapping or collecting of bush meat or wild fish.

---

**6.7. *The Organization\** shall *protect\** or *restore\** natural water courses, *water bodies\**, *riparian zones\** and their *connectivity\**. The *Organization\** shall avoid negative impacts on water quality and quantity and mitigate and remedy those that occur.**



## INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall identify *protection\** measures that include the following, and may include existing regulations and/or best practices where they provide sufficient *protection\**:

- Buffer zones and other measures to protect natural *water courses\** and *water bodies\**, their *connectivity\**, in-stream *habitat\**, and fish, invertebrates, and other aquatic species;
- Measures to protect native vegetation in *riparian zones\** of *water courses\** and *water bodies\**, including feeding, breeding, or cover *habitat\** for terrestrial and aquatic species, and needed inputs of wood and leaf litter into aquatic areas;
- Measures to prevent negative changes in water quantity and quality, including through maintaining stream shading sufficient to protect against temperature changes beyond natural limits;
- Measures to maintain natural hydrological patterns and stream flows;
- Measures to prevent impacts from road location, construction, maintenance and use;
- Measures to prevent sedimentation of water bodies and soil erosion from harvesting, roads, and other activities; and
- Measures to prevent negative impacts from chemicals or *fertilizers\**.

---

6.7.1. *Protection\** measures are implemented to protect natural *water courses\**, *water bodies\**, *riparian zones\** and their *connectivity\**, including water quantity and water quality.

6.7.2. Where implemented *protection\** measures do not protect *water courses\**, *water bodies\**, *riparian zones\** and their *connectivity\**, water quantity or water quality from impacts of *forest\** management, *restoration\** activities are implemented.

6.7.3. Where natural *water courses*, *water bodies\**, *riparian zones\** and their *connectivity\**, water quantity or water quality have been damaged by past activities on land and water by *The Organization\**, *restoration\** activities are implemented.

6.7.4. Where continued degradation exists to *water courses\**, *water bodies\**, water quantity and water quality caused by previous managers and the activities of third parties, measures are implemented that prevent or mitigate this degradation.

**6.8. *The Organization\** shall manage the *landscape\** in the *Management Unit\** to maintain and/or restore\* a varying mosaic of species, sizes, ages, spatial scales\* and regeneration cycles appropriate for the *landscape values\** in that region, and for enhancing environmental and economic resilience\*.**

6.8.1. A varying mosaic of species, sizes, ages, spatial scales\*, and regeneration cycles is maintained appropriate to the *landscape\**.

6.8.2. The mosaic of species, sizes, ages, spatial scales\*, and regeneration cycles is *restored\** where it has not been maintained appropriate to the *landscape\**.

**6.9. *The Organization\** shall not convert natural forest\* or High Conservation Value Areas\* to plantations\* or to non-forest land-use\*, nor transform plantations\* on sites directly converted from natural forest\* to nonforest land-use\*, except when the conversion\*:**

**a) Affects a very limited portion\* of the *Management Unit\**, and**

- b) Will produce clear, substantial, *additional\**, secure long-term *conservation\** and social benefits in the *Management Unit\**, and
- c) Does not damage or threaten *High Conservation Values\**, nor any sites or resources necessary to maintain or enhance those *High Conservation Values\**.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This *Criterion\** is applicable for a *Management Unit\** which is already certified, while *Criteria\** 6.10 and 6.11 address the eligibility of a *Management Unit\** for FSC certification.

“Directly converted from *natural forest\**” is intended to convey that if the *plantation\** was *natural forest\** immediately prior to being converted to *plantation\**, then it may not be transformed to non-forest uses except when the transformation meets the conditions a), b) and c). However, if the *plantation\** was non-forest immediately prior to its establishment, then it may be turned back to non-forest uses. *Conversions\** and transformations must be consistent with *Criterion\** 1.8 and demonstrate a *long-term\** commitment to the FSC *Principles\** and *Criteria\** and to related FSC Policies and Standards.

In the context of this *Criterion\**, the term “threaten” means any kind of harm, or threat of such harm being generated.

- 
- 6.9.1 There is no *conversion\** of *natural forest\** or *High Conservation Value Areas\** to *plantations\**, or to *non-forest land-use\**, nor transformation of *plantations\** on sites directly converted from *natural forest\** to *non-forest land-use\**, except when it:
- 1) Affects a *very limited portion\** of the *Management Unit\**, and
  - 2) Will produce clear, substantial, *additional\**, secure, long-term *conservation\** and social benefits in the *Management Unit\**, and
  - 3) Does not damage or threaten *High Conservation Values\**, nor any sites or resources necessary to maintain or enhance those *High Conservation Values\**.

6.10. **Management Units\*** containing plantations\* that were established on areas converted from natural forest\* between 1 December 1994 and 31 December 2020 shall not qualify for certification, except where:

a) The conversion affected a *very limited portion\** of the *Management Unit\** and is producing clear, substantial, *additional\**, secure long-term *conservation\** benefits in the *Management Unit\**, or

b) *The Organization\** which was *directly\** or *indirectly\** involved in the conversion demonstrates *restitution\** of all *social harms\** and *proportionate\** *remedy\** of *environmental harms\** as specified in the applicable FSC Remedy Framework, or

c) *The Organization\** which was not involved in the conversion but has acquired *Management Units\** where conversion has taken place demonstrates *restitution\** of *priority social harms\** and *partial remedy\** of *environmental harms\** as specified in the applicable FSC Remedy Framework.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This Criterion\* provides a pathway to FSC certification for plantations\* that were established by conversion of natural forests\* between 1 December 1994 and 31 December 2020, based on the remedy\* of environmental and social harms\* according to FSC-PRO-01-007 FSC Remedy Framework and FSC-POL-01-007 Policy to Address Conversion.

The applicable definitions for direct\* and indirect involvement\* for this Criterion\* are adopted from FSC-POL-01-004 V2-0 Policy for the Association of Organizations with FSC.

Conformance with FSC-PRO-01-007 FSC Remedy Framework does not apply to small-scale smallholders\* seeking certification of a Management Unit\* of less than 50 hectares in which conversion occurred between 1 December 1994 and 31 December 2020, regardless of whether they were involved in the conversion or subsequently acquired the Management Unit\*. These 50 hectares may be defined to a smaller area in a national standard development process.

---

6.10.1 Based on *Best Available Information\**, accurate data is compiled on all conversions between 1 December 1994 and 31 December 2020 within the *Management Unit\**

6.10.2 Areas converted from *natural forest\** to *plantation\** between 1 December 1994 and 31 December 2020 are not certified, except where:

1) The conversion affected a *very limited portion\** of the *Management Unit\** and is producing clear, substantial, *additional\**, secure long-term\* *conservation\** benefits in the *Management Unit\**, or

2) *The Organization\** which was *directly\** or *indirectly\** involved in the conversion demonstrates *restitution\** of all *social harms\** and *proportionate\** *remedy\** of *environmental harms\** as specified in the applicable FSC Remedy Framework, or

3) *The Organization\** which was not involved in conversion but has acquired *Management Units\** where conversion has taken place demonstrates *restitution\** of *priority social harms\** and *partial remedy\** of *environmental harms\** as specified in the applicable FSC Remedy Framework, or

4) *The Organization\** qualifies as a *small-scale smallholder\**.

**6.11** *Management Units\** shall not qualify for certification if they contain *natural forests\** or *High Conservation Value Areas\** converted after 31 December 2020, except where the *conversion\**:

- a) Affected a *very limited portion\** of the *Management Unit\**, and
- b) Is producing clear, substantial, *additional\**, secure *long-term\* conservation\** and social benefits in the *Management Unit\**, and
- c) Did not threaten *High Conservation Values\**, nor any sites or resources necessary to maintain or enhance those *High Conservation Values\**.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

This is a new Criterion\* aiming to halt conversion\* of natural forests\* and of HCV areas\* after December 2020.

FSC defines what constitutes natural forest\* and the threshold for when degradation\* constitutes conversion\* (conversion threshold\*). Standard developers may adapt this at the national or regional level, based on guidance and instructions developed by FSC. The conversion threshold\* defined by FSC shall be considered as a minimum threshold.

The sum of the converted “very limited portion\*” areas within the Management Unit\* referred to in Criteria\* 6.9, 6.10 and 6.11 shall not exceed the 5% threshold, nor the specified maximum area in hectares.

- 
- 6.11.1 Based on *Best Available Information\**, accurate data is compiled on all *conversions\** of *natural forests\** and *High Conservation Value Areas\** after 31 December 2020 within the *Management Unit\**.
  - 6.11.2 Areas where *natural forests\** or *High Conservation Value Areas\** have been converted after 31 December 2020 are not certified, except where the *conversion\**:
    - 1) Affected a *very limited portion\** of the *Management Unit\**, and
    - 2) is producing clear, substantial, *additional\**, secure *long-term\* conservation\** and social benefits in the *Management Unit\**, and
    - 3) did not threaten *High Conservation Values\**, nor any sites or resources necessary to maintain or enhance those *High Conservation Values\**.

## PRINCIPLE\* 7: MANAGEMENT PLANNING

*The Organization\** shall have a *management plan\** consistent with its policies and *objectives\** and proportionate to *scale, intensity and risks\** of its management activities. The *management plan\** shall be implemented and kept up to date based on monitoring information in order to promote *adaptive management\**. The associated planning and procedural documentation shall be sufficient to guide staff, inform *affected stakeholders\** and *interested stakeholders\** and to justify management decisions.

7.1. *The Organization\** shall, proportionate to *scale, intensity and risk\** of its management activities, set policies (visions and values) and *objectives\** for management, which are environmentally sound, socially beneficial and economically viable. Summaries of these policies and *objectives\** shall be incorporated into the *management plan\**, and publicized.



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

The term *management objectives\**, as used in this standard, refers to specific management goals, practices, outcomes, and approaches established to achieve the requirements of this standard. Standard Developers shall develop *indicators\** to ensure that *The Organization\** establishes specific *management objectives\** that correspond to specific management goals, practices, outcomes, and approaches required by this standard. *The Organization\** may also establish overarching, aspirational *objectives\** for managing the *forest\** providing these do not contradict the requirements of this standard.

- 
- 7.1.1. Policies (vision and values) that contribute to meeting the requirements of this standard are defined.
  - 7.1.2. Specific, operational *management objectives\** that address the requirements of this standard are defined.
  - 7.1.3. Summaries of the defined policies and *management objectives\** are included in the *management plan\** and publicized.

- 7.2. **The Organization\*** shall have and implement a *management plan\** for the *Management Unit\** which is fully consistent with the policies and *management objectives\** as established according to *Criterion\** 7.1. The *management plan\** shall describe the natural resources that exist in the *Management Unit\** and explain how the plan will meet the FSC certification requirements. The *management plan\** shall cover *forest\** management planning and social management planning proportionate to *scale\**, *intensity\** and *risk\** of the planned activities.



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop *indicators\** to ensure that the duration of the *management plan\** is consistent with *Criterion\** 1.8 and demonstrate a *long-term\** commitment to the FSC *Principles\** and *Criteria\** and to related FSC Policies and Standards.

- 
- 7.2.1. The *management plan\** includes management actions, procedures, strategies and measures to achieve the *management objectives\**.
- 7.2.2. The management plan\* addresses the elements listed in Annex E, and is implemented.



**7.3. The *management plan*\* shall include *verifiable targets*\* by which progress towards each of the prescribed *management objectives*\* can be assessed.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Examples of *verifiable targets*\* to be established include:

- Site productivity, yield of all products harvested;
- Composition and observed changes in the flora and fauna;
- Water quality and quantity;
- Soil erosion, compaction, fertility and carbon content;
- Wildlife populations, *biodiversity*\* and status of *High Conservation Values*\*;
- Sensitive cultural and environmental resources;
- Stakeholder satisfaction with *engagement*\*;
- Benefits of management operations provided to *local communities*\*;
- Number of *occupational accidents*\*;
- Area of *Intact Forest Landscape*\* *protected*\* as *Core Areas*\* and
- Overall *economic viability*\* of the *Management Unit*\*.

---

7.3.1. *Verifiable targets*\*, and the frequency that they are assessed, are established for monitoring the progress towards each *management objective*\*.

**7.4. The *Organization*\* shall update and revise periodically the management planning and procedural documentation to incorporate the results of monitoring and evaluation, stakeholder *engagement*\* or new scientific and technical information, as well as to respond to changing environmental, social and economic circumstances.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Under the FSC definition, the *management plan*\* is a collection of documents, reports, records and maps that describe, justify and regulate management activities. As such the frequency of revision to these varied documents and maps depends on the source of information as listed in 7.4.1. as well as the type of planning document as summarized in Annex F. Annex F is intended to explain the scope of the planning framework and is not meant to be prescriptive. In general, information received from stakeholder *engagement*\*, new scientific and technical information and changing environmental, social, or economic circumstances should result in more frequent revisions to the relevant management planning document or map.

---

7.4.1. *The management plan*\* is revised and updated periodically consistent with Annex F to incorporate:

- 1) Monitoring results, including results of certification audits;
- 2) Evaluation results;
- 3) Stakeholder *engagement*\* results;
- 4) New scientific and technical information, and



5) Changing environmental, social, or economic circumstances.

**7.5. The Organization\* shall make publicly available\* a summary of the management plan\* free of charge. Excluding confidential information\*, other relevant components of the management plan\* shall be made available to affected stakeholders\* on request, and at cost of reproduction and handling.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

The intent of this *Criterion\** is to strike a balance between minimizing the administrative burden for *The Organization\** in producing a summary of the *management plan\** with ensuring that comprehensive information is provided. The entire *management plan\** can be provided if this reduces the administration burden. Examples of *confidential information\** include data and content:

- Related to investment decisions;
- About *intellectual property\** rights;
- Which is client confidential;
- Which is, by law, confidential;
- Whose dissemination could put at *risk\** the *protection\** of wildlife species and *habitats\**; and
- About sites which are of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance to *Indigenous Peoples\** or *local communities\** (see *Criteria\** 3.5 and 4.7) as requested by these groups.

---

7.5.1. A summary of the *management plan\** in a format comprehensible to stakeholders including maps and excluding *confidential information\** is made *publicly available\** at no cost.

7.5.2. Relevant components of the *management plan\**, excluding *confidential information\**, are available to *affected stakeholders\** on request at the actual costs of reproduction and handling.

**7.6. The Organization\* shall, proportionate to scale, intensity and risk\* of management activities, proactively and transparently engage affected stakeholders\* in its management planning and monitoring processes, and shall engage interested stakeholders\* on request.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

*Culturally appropriate\** processes consider cultural differences, such as preferences for direct or indirect negotiation; attitudes toward competition, cooperation, and conflict; the desire to preserve relationships among complainants; authority, social rank, and status; ways of understanding and interpreting the world; concepts of time management; attitudes toward third parties; and the broader social and institutional environment.

Standard Developers shall develop *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** processes for the *Criteria\** specified in *Indicator\** 7.6.1., following the requirements of *Indicator\** 7.6.2., with variations according to the target group if deemed necessary.

- 7.6.1. *Culturally appropriate\* engagement\** is used to ensure that *affected stakeholders\** are proactively and transparently engaged in the following processes:
- 1) *Dispute\** resolution processes (*Criterion\** 1.6, *Criterion\** 2.6, *Criterion\** 4.6);
  - 2) Definition of *Living wages\** (*Criterion\** 2.4);
  - 3) Identification of rights (*Criterion\** 3.1, *Criterion\** 4.1), *Indigenous cultural landscapes\** (*Criterion\** 3.1) sites (*Criterion\** 3.5, *Criterion\** 4.7) and impacts (*Criterion\** 4.5);
  - 4) *Local communities\** socio-economic development activities (*Criterion\** 4.4); and
  - 5) *High Conservation Values\** assessment, management and monitoring (*Criterion\** 9.1, *Criterion\** 9.2, *Criterion\** 9.4).
- 7.6.2. *Culturally appropriate\* engagement\** is used to:
- 1) Determine appropriate representatives and contact points (including where appropriate, local institutions, organizations and authorities);
  - 2) Determine mutually agreed communication channels allowing for information to flow in both directions;
  - 3) Ensure all actors (women, youth, elderly, minorities) are represented and engaged equitably;
  - 4) Ensure all meetings, all points discussed and all agreements reached are recorded;
  - 5) Ensure the content of meeting records is approved; and
  - 6) Ensure the results of all *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** activities are shared with those involved.
- 7.6.3. *Affected rights holders\* and affected stakeholders\** are provided with an opportunity for *culturally appropriate\* engagement\** in monitoring and planning processes of management activities that affect their interests.
- 7.6.4. On request, *interested stakeholders\** are provided with an opportunity for *engagement\** in monitoring and planning processes of management activities that affect their interests.

## PRINCIPLE\* 8: MONITORING AND ASSESSMENT

**The Organization\*** shall demonstrate that, progress towards achieving the *management objectives\**, the impacts of management activities and the condition of the *Management Unit\**, are monitored and evaluated proportionate to the *scale, intensity and risk\** of management activities, in order to implement *adaptive management\**.

**8.1. The Organization\*** shall monitor the implementation of its *Management Plan\**, including its policies and *management objectives\**, its progress with the activities planned, and the achievement of its *verifiable targets\**.

8.1.1. Procedures are documented and executed for monitoring the implementation of the *management plan\** including its policies and *management objectives\** and achievement of *verifiable targets\**.

**8.2. The Organization\*** shall monitor and evaluate the environmental and social impacts of the activities carried out in the *Management Unit\**, and changes in its environmental condition.



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

The *Criterion\** requires that three distinct categories shall be monitored: environmental impacts of management activities, addressed in *Principle\** 10; social impacts of activities, addressed in *Principles\** 1-5, as well as the *engagement\** addressed in *Principle\** 9; and changes in environmental conditions, addressed in *Principles\** 5, 6 and 9. Please refer to Annex G for specific monitoring requirements (*Indicators\** 8.2.1 and 8.2.2).

---

8.2.1. The social and environmental impacts of management activities are monitored consistent with Annex G.

8.2.2. Changes in environmental conditions are monitored consistent with Annex G.

**8.3. The Organization\*** shall analyze the results of monitoring and evaluation and feed the outcomes of this analysis back into the planning process.

8.3.1. *Adaptive management\** procedures are implemented so that monitoring results feed into periodic updates to the planning process and the resulting *management plan\**.

8.3.2. If monitoring results show non-conformities with the FSC Standard then *management objectives\**, *verifiable targets\** and/or management activities are revised.

- 8.4. ***The Organization\** shall make *publicly available\** a summary of the results of monitoring free of charge, excluding *confidential information\**.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

The intent of this *Criterion\** is to strike a balance between minimizing the administrative burden for *The Organization\** in producing a summary of the results of monitoring with ensuring that comprehensive information is provided. The entire results of monitoring can be provided if this reduces the administration burden. Examples of *confidential information\** are provided in the Instruction under *Criterion\** 7.5.

- 
- 8.4.1. A summary of the monitoring results consistent with Annex G, in a format comprehensible to stakeholders including maps and excluding *confidential information\** is made *publicly available\** at no cost.
- 8.5. ***The Organization\** shall have and implement a tracking and tracing system proportionate to scale, intensity and risk\* of its management activities, for demonstrating the source and volume in proportion to projected output for each year, of all products from the *Management Unit\** that are marketed as FSC certified.**
- 8.5.1. A system is implemented to track and trace all products that are marketed as FSC certified. As part of that:
- 1) *Transaction verification\** is supported by providing *FSC transaction\** data, as requested by the certification body;
  - 2) *Fibre testing\** is supported by surrendering samples and specimens of materials and information about species composition for verification, as requested by the certification body.
- 8.5.2. Information about all products sold is compiled and documented, including:
- 1) Common and scientific species name;
  - 2) Product name or description;
  - 3) Volume (or quantity) of product;
  - 4) Information to trace the material to the source of origin logging block;
  - 5) Logging date;
  - 6) If basic processing activities take place in the forest, the date and volume produced; and
  - 7) Whether or not the material was sold as FSC certified.
- 8.5.3. Sales invoices or similar documentation are kept for a minimum of five years for all products sold with an FSC claim, which identify at a minimum, the following information:
- 1) Name and address of purchaser;
  - 2) The date of sale;
  - 3) Common and scientific species name;
  - 4) Product description;
  - 5) The volume (or quantity) sold;
  - 6) Certificate code; and

7) The FSC Claim “FSC 100%” identifying products sold as FSC certified.

## PRINCIPLE\* 9: HIGH CONSERVATION VALUES\*

The *Organization\** shall maintain and/or enhance the *High Conservation Values\** in the *Management Unit\** through applying the *precautionary approach\**.

### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop a National *High Conservation Value\** (HCV) Framework, which is a tool for the identification, management and monitoring of *High Conservation Values\** in the country.

When developing this National HCV Framework, Standard Developers shall consider:

- ‘Common Guidance for the identification of High Conservation Values’, developed by the HCV Resource Network (available on the [FSC Website](#));
- FSC step-by-step guide for SLIMFs (available on the [FSC Website](#));
- Relevant databases and maps;
- Global Forest Watch *Intact Forest Landscapes\** maps (2015) [www.globalforestwatch.org](http://www.globalforestwatch.org), or other maps based on a more recent and accurate *Intact Forest Landscapes\** inventory using a refined methodology;
- *Culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *affected rights holders\**, *affected\** and *interested stakeholders\**, and relevant local and regional experts;
- FSC-GUI-30-003 *FSC Guidelines for the Implementation of the Right to Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)*;
- FSC-GUI-60-002 *Guideline for Standard Developers for Addressing Risk of Unacceptable Activities in regard to Scale and Intensity*;
- Annexes H, I and J below; and
- Other available sources.

Standard Developers shall clarify in the Forest Stewardship Standard, how the HCV Framework shall be used by *The Organization\**, when identifying the *High Conservation Values\** in the *Management Unit\** and when developing management strategies to protect these *High Conservation Values\**.

Standard Developers shall develop *indicators\** that apply the principle of *Precautionary Approach\**, which considers *High Conservation Values\** to be *critical\**, fundamental, *significant\** or valuable, and therefore any threat to a *High Conservation Value\** is considered to be a threat of severe or irreversible damage.

Standard Developers shall also apply the principle of *Precautionary Approach\** to the development of the National HCV Framework.

Standard Developers shall explicitly make references to the national *High Conservation Values\** framework (Annex J) in the text of *indicators\** under *Principle\* 9*, where applicable.

9.1. *The Organization\**, through *engagement\** with *affected stakeholders\**, *interested stakeholders\** and other means and sources, shall assess and record the presence and status of the following *High Conservation Values\** in the *Management Unit\**, proportionate to the *scale, intensity and risk\** of impacts of management activities, and likelihood of the occurrence of the *High Conservation Values\**:

HCV 1 – Species diversity. Concentrations of *biological diversity\** including endemic species, and *rare\*, threatened\** or endangered species, that are *significant\** at global, regional or national levels.

HCV 2 – *Landscape\*-level ecosystems\** and mosaics. *Intact Forest Landscapes\** and large *landscape\*-level ecosystems\** and *ecosystem\** mosaics that are *significant\** at global, regional or national levels, and that contain viable populations of the great majority of the naturally occurring species in natural patterns of distribution and abundance.

HCV 3 – *Ecosystems\** and *habitats\**. *Rare\*, threatened\*, or endangered ecosystems\*, habitats\* or refugia\**.

HCV 4 – *Critical\* ecosystem services\**. Basic *ecosystem services\** in *critical\** situations, including *protection\** of water catchments and control of erosion of vulnerable soils and slopes.

HCV 5 – Community needs. Sites and resources fundamental for satisfying the basic necessities of *local communities\* or Indigenous Peoples\** (for livelihoods, health, nutrition, water, etc.), identified through *engagement\** with these communities or *Indigenous Peoples\**.

HCV 6 – Cultural values. Sites, resources, *habitats\** and *landscapes\** of global or national cultural, archaeological or historical significance, and/or of *critical\** cultural, ecological, economic or religious/sacred importance for the traditional cultures of *local communities\* or Indigenous Peoples\**, identified through *engagement\** with these *local communities\* or Indigenous Peoples\**.



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall specify the *Best Available Information\** that *The Organization\** shall use when identifying *High Conservation Values\** (*Indicator\* 9.1.1.*) including:

- *High Conservation Values\** surveys and *Intact Forest Landscapes\** assessments of the *Management Unit\**;
- Relevant databases and maps;
- Global Forest Watch *Intact Forest Landscapes\** maps (2015) [www.globalforestwatch.org](http://www.globalforestwatch.org), or other maps based on a more recent and accurate *Intact Forest Landscapes\** inventory using a refined methodology;
- *Culturally appropriate\* engagement\** with *affected rights holders\**, *affected\** and interested *stakeholders\**, and relevant local and regional experts;
- FSC-GUI-30-003 *FSC Guidelines for the Implementation of the Right to Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)*;
- FSC-GUI-60-002 *Guideline for Standard Developers for Addressing Risk of Unacceptable Activities in regard to Scale and Intensity*;
- Other available sources; and
- Review of the results by knowledgeable expert(s) independent of *The Organization\**.



Standard Developers shall develop *indicators\** for the assessment of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** consistent with Annex H.

- 
- 9.1.1. An assessment is completed using *Best Available Information\** that records the location and status of *High Conservation Values\** Categories 1-6, as defined in *Criterion\** 9.1; the *High Conservation Value Areas\** they rely upon, and their condition.
  - 9.1.2. This assessment includes identification of *Intact Forest Landscapes\**, as of January 1, 2017.
  - 9.1.3. The assessment uses results from culturally appropriate\* engagement\* with *affected rights holders\** and *affected\** and *interested stakeholders\** with an interest in the conservation\* of the *High Conservation Values\**.

**9.2. The Organization\* shall develop effective strategies that maintain and/or enhance the identified *High Conservation Values\**, through engagement\* with affected stakeholders\*, interested stakeholders\* and experts.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

For Those countries / regions with *Intact Forest Landscapes\** Standard Developers shall develop *indicators\** that protect\* 80% of the total area of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** within the *Management Unit\** as *core areas\**, consistent with Annex H section B. Standards Developers may develop a threshold different than 80%, through processes consistent with Annex H section A.

- 
- 9.2.1. Threats to *High Conservation Values\** are identified using *Best Available Information\**.
  - 9.2.2. Management strategies and actions are developed to maintain and/or enhance the identified *High Conservation Values\** and to maintain associated *High Conservation Value Areas\** prior to implementing potentially harmful management activities.
  - 9.2.3. *Affected rights holders\**, *affected\** and *interested stakeholders\** and experts are engaged in the development of management strategies and actions to maintain and/or enhance the identified *High Conservation Values\**.
  - 9.2.4. Management strategies are developed to protect\* *core areas\**.
  - 9.2.5. The vast *majority\** of each *Intact Forest Landscape\** is designated as *core area\**.
  - 9.2.6. The strategies developed are effective to maintain and/or enhance the *High Conservation Values\**.
  - 9.2.7. Management strategies allow limited *industrial activity\** within *core areas\** only if all effects of *industrial activity\** including *fragmentation\**:
    - 1) Are restricted to a *very limited portion of the core area\**;
    - 2) Do not reduce the *core area\** below 50,000 ha, and
    - 3) Will produce clear, substantial, additional, *long-term\** conservation\* and social benefits.



- 9.3. **The Organization\*** shall implement strategies and actions that maintain and/or enhance the identified **High Conservation Values\***. These strategies and actions shall implement the **precautionary approach\*** and be proportionate to the **scale, intensity and risk\*** of management activities.
- 9.3.1. The **High Conservation Values\*** and the **High Conservation Value Areas\*** on which they depend are maintained and/or enhanced, including by implementing the strategies developed.
- 9.3.2. The strategies and actions prevent damage and avoid risks to **High Conservation Values\***, even when the scientific information is incomplete or inconclusive, and when the vulnerability and sensitivity of **High Conservation Values\*** are uncertain.
- 9.3.3. **Core areas\*** are **protected\*** consistent with **Criterion\*** 9.2.
- 9.3.4. Limited **industrial activity \*** in **core areas\*** is consistent with **Indicator\*** 9.2.7.
- 9.3.5. Activities that harm **High Conservation Values\*** cease immediately and actions are taken to **restore\*** and protect the **High Conservation Values\***.
- 9.4. **The Organization\*** shall demonstrate that periodic monitoring is carried out to assess changes in the status of **High Conservation Values\***, and shall adapt its management strategies to ensure their effective **protection\***. The monitoring shall be proportionate to the **scale, intensity and risk\*** of management activities, and shall include **engagement\*** with **affected stakeholders\*, interested stakeholders\*** and experts.
- 9.4.1. A program of periodic monitoring assesses:
- 1) Implementation of strategies;
  - 2) The status of **High Conservation Values\***, including **High Conservation Value Areas\*** on which they depend; and
  - 3) The effectiveness of the management strategies and actions for the **protection\*** of **High Conservation Values\***, to fully maintain and/or enhance—the **High Conservation Values\***.9.4.2. The monitoring program includes **engagement\*** with **affected\*** rights holders, affected and **interested stakeholders\*** and experts.
- 9.4.3. The monitoring program has sufficient scope, detail and frequency to detect changes in **High Conservation Values\***, relative to the initial assessment and status identified for each **High Conservation Value\***.
- 9.4.4. Management strategies and actions are adapted when monitoring or other new information show that these strategies and actions are insufficient to ensure the maintenance and/or enhancement of **High Conservation Values\***.

## PRINCIPLE\* 10: IMPLEMENTATION OF MANAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

Management activities conducted by or for *The Organization\** for the *Management Unit\** shall be selected and implemented consistent with *The Organization\**'s economic, environmental and social policies and *objectives\** and in compliance with the *Principles\** and *Criteria\** collectively.

10.1. After harvest or in accordance with the *management plan\**, *The Organization\** shall, by natural or artificial regeneration methods, regenerate vegetation cover in a timely fashion to pre-harvesting or more *natural conditions\**.



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

The *pre-harvest\** condition can be either *plantation\** or *natural forest\**. Standard Developers shall consider the following when developing *indicators\**:

- For an existing *plantation\**, the species harvested may be the same as the one(s) used to regenerate. However, there may be solid ecological, social and economic reasons for changing the species. The chosen species must be ecologically well adapted to the site and the *management objectives\** consistent with *Criterion\** 10.2.
- For alien species, use is restricted by the preference for native species at *Criterion\** 10.2. and control and mitigation measures for invasive impacts at *Criterion\** 10.3.
- For *natural forests\**, one consideration for regeneration is to determine if the *pre-harvest\** condition was the result of previous harvesting and *silvicultural\** activities, or natural events that have left the area in a degraded condition. The *objective\** should be to improve degraded areas, once harvested, to more *natural conditions\**.
- For *natural forests\**, an important *objective\** is to ensure a relatively natural abundance of species for both population and size range, across the space of the *Management Unit\**. This may be demonstrated by following the concept of 'range of natural variation', since forests do not remain static over time. This approach allows *The Organization\** some flexibility on a stand level or harvest area level as long as the species diversity across the *Management Unit\** is within the range of natural variation, including within managed stands, while allowing native species the possibility of migration resulting from climate change.
- The period required for regeneration is typically shorter for areas to be planted (artificial regeneration) than areas assigned or selected for natural regeneration. However, this *Criterion\** does not give preference to planting as a way to shorten the period for regeneration, because in certain cases natural regeneration approaches are more suitable for achieving *The Organization\**'s *objectives\**, while in other cases planting programs are more suitable.
- Regeneration practices must not violate the requirements under *Principle\** 6. Consistent with *Criteria\** 6.9. and 6.10., these practices cannot lead to conversion, losses of genetic and species diversity measured at the *Management Unit\** level, or damage to other *environmental values\**.

---

10.1.1. Harvested sites are regenerated in a *timely manner\** that:

- 1) Protects affected *environmental values\**; and
- 2) Is suitable to recover overall *pre-harvest\** or *natural forest\** composition and structure.

10.1.2. *Regeneration activities\** are implemented in a manner that:

- 1) For harvest of existing *plantations\**, regenerate to the vegetation cover that existed prior to the harvest or to more *natural conditions\** using ecologically well-adapted species;
- 2) For harvest of *natural forests\**, regenerate to *pre-harvest\** or to more *natural conditions\**; or
- 3) For harvest of degraded *natural forests\**, regenerate to more *natural conditions\**.

**10.2. The Organization\* shall use species for regeneration that are ecologically well adapted to the site and to the management objectives\*. The Organization\* shall use native species\* and local genotypes\* for regeneration, unless there is clear and convincing justification for using others.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

If the use of non-local *genotypes\** of *native species\** or the use of non-native species is agreed to at the national level, then Standard Developers shall develop a rationale for allowing their use (*Indicator\* 10.2.1.*).

This rationale may include:

- Growth rates not meeting *management objectives\**;
- Yields not being viable for the local species;
- *Native species\** and/or local *genotypes\** becoming extinct;
- *Native species\** and/or local *genotypes\** not being resistant to disease and pests;
- Site stresses, such as water;
- Afforestation of degraded agriculture and range lands;
- Climate change adaptation; or
- Capacity to stock carbon.

---

10.2.1. *Species\** chosen for regeneration are ecologically well adapted to the site, are *native species\** and are of local provenance, unless clear and convincing justification is provided for using non-local *genotypes\** or non-*native species\**.

10.2.2. Species chosen for regeneration are consistent with the regeneration objectives\* and with the management objectives\*.

**10.3. The Organization\* shall only use alien species\* when knowledge and/or experience have shown that any invasive impacts can be controlled and effective mitigation measures are in place.**

10.3.1. *Alien species\** are used only when direct experience and/or the results of scientific research demonstrate that invasive impacts can be controlled.

10.3.2. *Alien species\** are used only when effective mitigation measures are in place to control their spread outside the area in which they are established.

10.3.3. The spread of *invasive species\** introduced by *The Organization\** is controlled.

10.3.4. Management activities are implemented, preferably in cooperation with separate regulatory bodies where these exist, with an aim to control the invasive impacts of *alien species\** that were not introduced by *The Organization\**.

**10.4. The Organization\* shall not use *genetically modified organisms\** in the Management Unit\*.**

10.4.1. Genetically modified organisms\* are not used.

**10.5. The Organization\* shall use *silvicultural\** practices that are ecologically appropriate for the vegetation, species, sites and *management objectives\**.**

10.5.1. *Silvicultural\** practices are implemented that are ecologically appropriate for the vegetation, species, sites and *management objectives\**.

**10.6. The Organization\* shall minimize or avoid the use of *fertilizers\**. When *fertilizers\** are used, The Organization\* shall demonstrate that use is equally or more ecologically and economically beneficial than use of *silvicultural\** systems that do not require fertilizers, and prevent, mitigate, and/or repair damage to *environmental values\**, including soils.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to ensure that where *fertilizers\** are used, buffer zones that exclude the use of *fertilizers\** around rare plant communities, *riparian zones\**, *water courses\** and *water bodies\** are included in FSS (*Indicator\** 10.6.4.).

---

10.6.1. The use of *fertilizers\** is minimized or avoided.

10.6.2. When *fertilizers\** are used, their ecological and economic benefits are equal to or higher than those of *silvicultural\** systems that do not require *fertilizers\**.

10.6.3. When *fertilizers\** are used, their types, rates, frequencies and site of application are documented.

10.6.4. When *fertilizers\** are used, *environmental values\** are protected, including through implementation of measures to prevent damage.

10.6.5. Damage to *environmental values\** resulting from *fertilizer\** use is mitigated or repaired.

- 10.7. The Organization\* shall use integrated pest management and *silviculture\** systems which avoid, or aim at eliminating, the use of chemical *pesticides\**. The Organization\* shall not use any chemical *pesticides\** prohibited by FSC policy. When *pesticides\** are used, The Organization\* shall prevent, mitigate, and/or repair damage to *environmental values\** and human health.**



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall include the relevant aspects of the 'FSC Guide to integrated pest, disease and weed management in FSC certified forests and plantations' (2009) and associated policies, guidelines, advice notes and other FSC normative documents for the development of indicators (Indicator 10.7.1.).

Standard Developers shall either reference or include the relevant aspects of the ILO document "Safety in the use of chemicals at work" (Geneva, ILO, 1993) or any national interpretation of this document in Forest Stewardship Standards (*Indicator\* 10.7.4.*).

Standards Developers shall identify which are the *restricted highly hazardous pesticides\** and *highly restricted highly hazardous pesticides\** used or likely to be used in the country and follow Annex K "International Generic Indicators for the use and risk management of *highly hazardous pesticides\**".

- 
- 10.7.1 Integrated pest management, including selection of *silviculture\** systems, is used to avoid, or aim to eliminate, the frequency, extent and amount of chemical *pesticide\** applications, and result in non-use or overall reductions in applications.
  - 10.7.2 Prior to using chemical pesticides\*, the requirements of the Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\* framework for Organizations\* (FSC-POL-30-001 V3-0 FSC Pesticides Policy clause 4.12) are met.
  - 10.7.3 Affected rights holders\* and affected\* and interested stakeholders\* are provided with an opportunity for engagement\* in the development of the Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\* in a culturally appropriate\* manner.
  - 10.7.4 The Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\* is reviewed and, if necessary, revised within the certificate cycle.
  - 10.7.5 A decision process and rationale are in place to select the pest, weed or disease control option that demonstrates least social and environmental damages, more effectiveness and equal or greater social and environmental benefits.
  - 10.7.6 Records of pesticide\* usage are maintained, including trade name, active ingredient\*, quantity of active ingredient\* used, period of use, number and frequency of applications, location and area of use and reason for use.
  - 10.7.7 The use of pesticides\* complies with the ILO document "Safety in the use of chemicals at work" regarding requirements for the transport, storage, handling, application and emergency procedures for cleanup following accidental spillages.
  - 10.7.8 If pesticides\* are used, application methods minimize quantities used, while achieving effective results, and provide effective protection\* to surrounding landscapes\*.
  - 10.7.9 Damage to *environmental values\** and human health from *pesticide\** use is prevented and mitigated or repaired where damage occurs.
  - 10.7.10 When *pesticides\** are used:

- 4) The selected *pesticide\**, application method, timing and pattern of use offers the least risk to humans and non-target species; and
- 2) Objective evidence demonstrates that the *pesticide\** is the only effective, practical and cost effective way to control the pest.

**10.8. The Organization\* shall minimize, monitor\* and strictly control the use of biological control agents\* in accordance with internationally accepted scientific protocols\*. When biological control agents\* are used, The Organization\* shall prevent, mitigate, and/or repair damage to environmental values\*.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall either reference or include the relevant aspects of *internationally accepted scientific protocols\** associated with *biological control agents\** including the FAO Code of Conduct for the Import and Release of Exotic Biological Control and any national regulations, where these exist (*Indicator\** 10.8.2).

- 
- 10.8.1. The use of *biological control agents\** is minimized, *monitored\** and controlled.
  - 10.8.2. Use of *biological control agents\** complies with *internationally accepted scientific protocols\**.
  - 10.8.3. The use of *biological control agents\** is recorded including type, quantity, period, location and reason for use.
  - 10.8.4. Damage to *environmental values\** caused by the use of *biological control agents\** is prevented and mitigated or repaired where damage occurs.

**10.9. The Organization\* shall assess risks\* and implement activities that reduce potential negative impacts from Natural Hazards\* proportionate to scale, intensity, and risk\*.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers should identify the frequency, distribution and severity of *natural hazards\** that occur regionally and nationally (*Indicator\** 10.9.1.).

In addition, Standard Developers should identify both those *risks\** that can be increased by management activities (*Indicator* 10.9.3.) and potential means to mitigate the increased *risk\** (*Indicator\** 10.9.4.).

Recognizing that *natural hazards\** also include natural disturbances such as wind and fire, mitigation of the impact of *natural hazards\** should focus in these cases on ensuring resilience as opposed to attempting to control or prevent the *natural hazards\** (*Indicators\** 10.9.2. and 10.9.4.).

- 
- 10.9.1. Potential negative impacts of *natural hazards\** on *infrastructure\**, *forest\** resources and communities in the *Management Unit\** are assessed.
  - 10.9.2. Management activities mitigate these impacts.
  - 10.9.3. The *risk\** for management activities to increase the frequency, distribution or severity of *natural hazards\** is identified for those *hazards\** that may be influenced by management.
  - 10.9.4. Management activities are modified and/or measures are developed and implemented that reduce the identified *risks\**.



**10.10. The Organization\* shall manage *infrastructural development\**, transport activities and *silviculture\** so that water resources and soils are protected, and disturbance of and damage to *rare and threatened species\**, *habitats\**, *ecosystems\** and *landscape values\** are prevented, mitigated and/or repaired.**

10.10.1. Development, maintenance and use of *infrastructure\**, as well as transport activities, are managed to protect *environmental values\** identified in *Criterion\** 6.1.

10.10.2. *Silviculture\** activities are managed to ensure protection of the *environmental values\** identified in *Criterion\** 6.1.

10.10.3 Disturbance or damages to *water courses\**, *water bodies\**, soils, *rare and threatened species\**, *habitats\**, *ecosystems\** and *landscape values\** are prevented, mitigated and repaired in a *timely manner\**, and management activities modified to prevent further damage.

**10.11. The Organization\* shall manage activities associated with harvesting and extraction of timber and *non-timber forest products\** so that *environmental values\** are conserved, merchantable waste is reduced, and damage to other products and services is avoided.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers should either reference or include the relevant aspects of these documents where they apply at the national level (*Indicators\** 10.11.1. and 10.11.4.):

- The FAO Model Code of Forest Harvesting Practice;
- Reduced Impact Logging Documents.

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to prevent *high grading\** (*Indicator\** 10.11.2.).

---

10.11.1. Harvesting and extraction practices for timber and *non-timber forest products\** are implemented in a manner that conserves *environmental values\** as identified in *Criterion\** 6.1 and *High Conservation Values\** identified in *Criteria\** 9.1 and 9.2.

10.11.2. Harvesting practices optimize the use of *forest\** products and merchantable materials.

10.11.3. Sufficient amounts of dead and decaying biomass and *forest\** structure are retained to conserve *environmental values\**.

10.11.4. Harvesting practices avoid damage to standing residual trees, residual woody debris on the ground and other *environmental values\**.

**10.12. The Organization\* shall dispose of *waste materials\** in an environmentally appropriate manner.**



#### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall either reference national regulations that address the disposal of *waste materials\** in an environmentally appropriate manner, or, where national regulations are insufficient or do not exist, develop additional *indicators\**.

---

10.12.1. Collection, clean up, transportation and disposal of all *waste materials\** is done in an environmentally appropriate way that conserves *environmental values\** as identified in *Criterion\** 6.1.





## G ANNEXES

(Normative section)



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

In FSC-STD-60-004 International Generic Indicators, Section E (Sub-Section 1) contains instructions on the nine Annexes for the Standard Developers to assist them with meeting specific requirements of the standard.

Their compulsory nature is reflected at the beginning of each Annex and summarized in the following table, expressed according to ISO 'verbal forms for the expression of provisions' as 'shall', 'should', etc. (adapted from FSC-STD-60-004 V2-1 EN):

| Annex in template | Title                                                                                                                                                | Application for Standard Developers                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Annex A           | <b>Minimum list of <i>applicable laws*</i>, regulations and nationally ratified international treaties, conventions and agreements (Principle 1)</b> | Standard Developers shall complete a list of all <i>applicable laws*</i> , obligatory codes of practice and legal and customary rights at the national and, where applicable, sub-national level as outlined in Annex A. This list shall be included in the FSS.                                                               |
| Annex B           | <b>Training requirements for <i>workers*</i> (Principle 2)</b>                                                                                       | Standard Developers shall ensure that training requirements are included in FSS, proportionate to <i>scale, intensity and risk*</i> and consistent with existing national and sub-national training requirements. Standard Developers may also incorporate the relevant elements of this Annex into the indicators of the FSS. |
| Annex C           | <b><i>Conservation Area Network*</i> conceptual diagram (Principle 6)</b>                                                                            | Standard Developers shall use this diagram to inform the development of appropriate guidance at the national and regional level for the creation of <i>Conservation Area Networks*</i> .                                                                                                                                       |
| Annex D           | <b>List of <i>rare and threatened species*</i> in the country or region</b>                                                                          | Standard Developers shall list the sources where the updated list of <i>rare and threatened species*</i> in the country or region can be consulted by the general public.                                                                                                                                                      |

|         |                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Annex E | <b>Elements of the management plan* (Principle 7)</b>                                                                            | Standard Developers shall ensure that the relevant elements of this Annex are included in the requirements for the content of <i>management plan*s</i> , subject to <i>scale, intensity and risk*</i> and consistent with national and regional management planning frameworks.                                        |
| Annex F | <b>Conceptual framework for planning and monitoring (Principle 7)</b>                                                            | Standard Developers may use this diagram to inform the periodicity for revision of the various management planning and monitoring documents                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Annex G | <b>Monitoring requirements (Principle 8)</b>                                                                                     | Standard Developers shall ensure that the relevant elements of this Annex are included in the requirements for the content of monitoring plans, consistent with existing national and sub-national monitoring approaches and subject to <i>scale intensity and risk*</i> .                                             |
| Annex H | <b>Instructions for Standards Developers to develop indicators for <i>Intact Forest Landscape* core areas*</i> (Principle 9)</b> | <p>For countries with <i>Intact Forest Landscapes*</i> Standards Developers shall use the following instructions for establishing:</p> <p>The threshold for <i>vast majority* of Intact Forest Landscapes* as core areas*</i>; and</p> <p>Indicators for assessing and protecting <i>Intact Forest Landscapes*</i></p> |
| Annex I | <b>Strategies for maintaining <i>High Conservation Values*</i> (Principle 9)</b>                                                 | Standard Developers shall consider this Annex to inform the development of management strategies to maintain <i>High Conservation Values*</i> .                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Annex J | <b><i>High Conservation Values*</i> framework (Principle 9)</b>                                                                  | <p>Standard Developers shall use the</p> <p>“Guidance for Standard Development Groups: Developing National High Conservation Value Frameworks” (FSC-GUI-60-009 V1-0 EN) and the “Template for National High Conservation Value</p>                                                                                     |

---

Frameworks” (FSC-GUI-60-009a V1-0 EN) as the basis for the national *High conservation Values\** framework.

---

**Annex K** International Generic Indicators for the use of *highly hazardous pesticides\** (Principle 10)

In countries where highly hazardous pesticides are used or likely to be used, Standard Developers shall refer to this Annex to develop national indicators for the use and risk management of highly hazardous pesticides

---

Annex L

### Glossary of terms

Standard Developers are to make sure that all the terms in the glossary are consistent in wording and are consistently marked with italics and asterisks throughout the standard sections covering the indicators and the annexes.

Also when adapting the IGIs to the national conditions, Standard Developers are to consider the terms in the glossary, either to adopt the terms or to replace them with new glossary terms.

---

## Annex A Minimum list of *applicable laws\**, regulations and nationally ratified international treaties, conventions and agreements (*Principle\* 1*)

The following is the minimum list of *applicable laws\**, regulations and nationally ratified international treaties, conventions and agreements, in FSC-STD-60-004 (International Generic Indicators). This is not an exhaustive list. If additional legislation exists, CHs shall also comply with it.

| 1. <i>Legal*</i> rights to harvest             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.1. Land <i>tenure*</i> and management rights | Legislation covering land <i>tenure*</i> rights, including <i>customary rights*</i> as well as management rights, that includes the use of <i>legal*</i> methods to obtain <i>tenure*</i> rights and management rights. It also covers <i>legal*</i> business registration and tax registration, including relevant legally required licenses.                                                                                                  |
| 1.2. Concession licenses                       | Legislation regulating procedures for issuing <i>forest*</i> concession licenses, including the use of <i>legal*</i> methods to obtain concession licenses. Bribery, corruption and nepotism are particularly well-known issues that are connected with concession licenses.                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 3. Management and harvesting planning          | Any national or sub-national <i>legal*</i> requirements for Management Planning, including conducting <i>forest*</i> inventories, having a <i>forest* management plan*</i> and related planning and monitoring, impact assessments, consultation with other entities, as well as approval of these by <i>legally competent*</i> authorities.                                                                                                    |
| 1.4. Harvesting permits                        | National or sub-national laws and regulations regulating procedures for issuing harvesting permits, licenses or other <i>legal*</i> documents required for specific harvesting operations. This includes the use of <i>legal*</i> methods to obtain the permits. Corruption is a well-known issue that is connected with the issuing of harvesting permits.                                                                                     |
| 2. Taxes and fees                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1.1. Payment of royalties and harvesting fees  | Legislation covering payment of all legally required <i>forest*</i> harvesting specific fees such as royalties, stumpage fees and other volume-based fees. This includes payments of the fees based on the correct classification of quantities, qualities and species. Incorrect classification of <i>forest*</i> products is a well-known issue that is often combined with bribery of officials in charge of controlling the classification. |
| 2. Value added taxes and other sales taxes     | Legislation covering different types of sales taxes which apply to the material being sold, including the sale of material as growing <i>forest*</i> (standing stock sales).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 2.3. Income and profit taxes                   | Legislation covering income and profit taxes related to profit derived from the sale of <i>forest*</i> products and harvesting activities. This category is                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

---

also related to income from the sale of timber and does not include other taxes generally applicable for companies and is not related to salary payments.

### 3. Timber harvesting activities

#### 1. Timber harvesting regulations

Any *legal*\* requirements for harvesting techniques and technology including selective cutting, shelter wood regenerations, clear felling, transport of timber from the felling site, seasonal limitations, etc. Typically this includes regulations on the size of felling areas, *minimum age*\* and/or diameter for felling activities, and elements that shall be preserved during felling, etc. Establishment of skidding or hauling trails, road construction, drainage systems and bridges, etc., shall also be considered as well as the planning and monitoring of harvesting activities. Any legally binding codes for harvesting practices shall be considered.

#### 2. Protected sites and species

International, national, and sub national treaties, laws, and regulations related to protected areas, allowable *forest*\* uses and activities, and/or rare, threatened, or endangered species, including their *habitats*\* and potential *habitats*\*.

#### 3. Environmental requirements

National and sub national laws and regulations related to the identification and/or *protection*\* of *environmental values*\* including but not limited to those relating to or affected by harvesting, acceptable levels for soil damage, establishment of buffer zones (e.g., along water courses, open areas and breeding sites), maintenance of retention trees on the felling site, seasonal limitations of harvesting time, environmental requirements for *forest*\* machineries, use of *pesticides*\* and other chemicals, biodiversity *conservation*\*, air quality, *protection*\* and *restoration*\* of water quality, operation of recreational equipment, development of non-forestry *infrastructure*\*, mineral exploration and extraction, etc.

#### 3.4. Health and safety

Legally required personal *protection*\* equipment for persons involved in harvesting activities, implementation of safe felling and transport practices, establishment of *protection*\* zones around harvesting sites, safety requirements for machinery used, and legally required safety requirements in relation to chemical usage. The health and safety requirements that shall be considered relevant to operations in the *forest*\* (not office work, or other activities less related to actual *forest*\* operations).

#### 3.5. Legal\* employment

*Legal*\* requirements for employment of personnel involved in harvesting activities including requirements for contracts and working permits, requirements for obligatory insurance, requirements for competence certificates and other training requirements, and payment of social and income taxes withheld by the employer. Also covered are the observance of minimum working age and *minimum age*\* for personnel

---

involved in *hazardous work\**, legislation against forced and compulsory labor, and *discrimination\** and freedom of association.

#### 4. Third parties' rights

##### 4.1. Customary rights\*

Legislation covering *customary rights\** relevant to *forest\** harvesting activities, including requirements covering the sharing of benefits and indigenous rights.

##### 2. Free Prior and Informed Consent\*

Legislation covering "free prior and informed consent" in connection with the transfer of *forest\** management rights and *customary rights\** to *The Organization\** in charge of the harvesting operation.

##### 3. Indigenous Peoples'\* rights

Legislation that regulates the rights of *Indigenous Peoples\** as far as it is related to forestry activities. Possible aspects to consider are land *tenure\**, and rights to use certain *forest\** related resources and practice traditional activities, which may involve *forest\** lands.

#### 5. Trade and transport

**NOTE:** This section covers requirements for *forest\** management operations as well as processing and trade.

##### 1. Classification of species, quantities, qualities

Legislation regulating how harvested material is classified in terms of species, volumes and qualities in connection with trade and transport. Incorrect classification of harvested material is a well-known method to reduce or avoid payment of legally prescribed taxes and fees.

##### 5.2. Trade and transport

All required trading and transport permits shall exist as well as legally required transport documents which accompany the transport of wood from *forest\** operations.

##### 3. Offshore trading and transfer pricing

Legislation regulating offshore trading. Offshore trading with related companies placed in tax havens, combined with artificial transfer prices is a well-known way to avoid payment of legally prescribed taxes and fees to the country of harvest and is considered to be an important source of funds that can be used for payment of bribery to the *forest\** operations and personnel involved in the harvesting operation. Many countries have established legislation covering transfer pricing and offshore trading. It should be noted that only transfer pricing and offshore trading, as far as it is legally prohibited in the country, can be included here.

##### 5.4. Custom regulations

Custom legislation covering areas such as export/import licenses and product classification (codes, quantities, qualities and species).

---

---

## 5.5. CITES

CITES permits (the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora, also known as the Washington Convention).

## 6. Due diligence / due care

### 1. Due diligence / due care procedures

Legislation requiring due diligence/due care procedures, including, e.g., due diligence/due care systems, declaration obligations, and/or the keeping of trade related documents, etc.

## 7. Ecosystem Services

Legislation covering *ecosystem services*\* rights, including *customary rights*\* as well as management rights that include the use of *legal*\* methods to make claims and obtain benefits and management rights related to *ecosystem services*\*. National and subnational laws and regulations related to the identification, protection and payment for *ecosystem services*\*. Also includes *legal*\* business registration and tax registration, including relevant *legal*\* required licenses for the exploitation, payment, and claims related to *ecosystem services*\* (including tourism).

---



## Annex B Training requirements for workers\* (Principle\* 2)



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall ensure that the following training requirements are included in FSS, proportionate to *scale, intensity and risk\** and consistent with existing national and sub-national training requirements.

Standard Developers may also incorporate the relevant elements of this Annex into the indicators of the FSS.

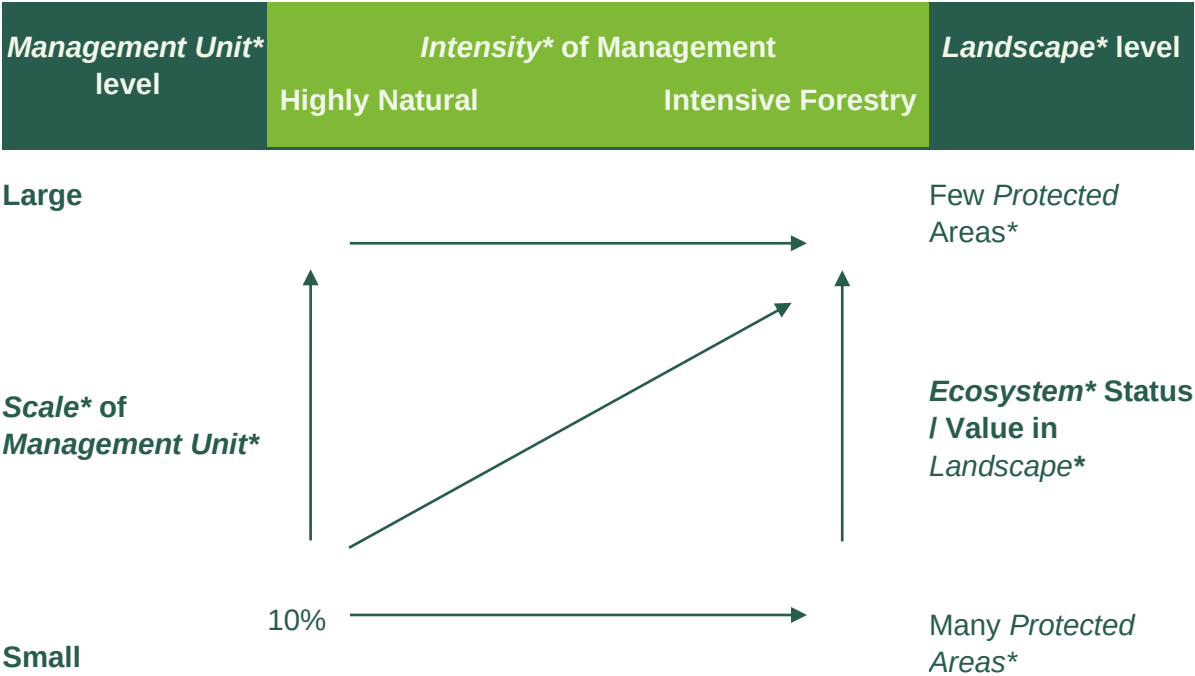
The list of training requirements in this Annex is intended for those *workers\** with specific job responsibilities related to the implementation of the FSS.

---

*Workers\** shall be able to:

1. Implement *forest\** activities to comply with applicable *legal\** requirements (*Criterion\** 1.5);
2. Understand the content, meaning and applicability of the eight *ILO Core Labour Conventions\** (*Criterion\** 2.1);
3. Recognize and report on instances of sexual harassment and gender *discrimination\** (*Criterion\** 2.2);
4. Safely handle and dispose of hazardous substances to ensure that use does not pose health *risks\** (*Criterion\** 2.3);
5. Carry out their responsibilities for particularly dangerous jobs or jobs entailing a special responsibility (*Criterion\** 2.5);
6. Identify where *Indigenous Peoples\** have *legal\** and *customary rights\** related to management activities (*Criterion\** 3.2);
7. Identify and implement applicable elements of UNDRIP and ILO Convention 169 (*Criterion\** 3.4);
8. Identify sites of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance to *Indigenous Peoples\** and implement the necessary measures to protect them before the start of *forest\** management activities to avoid negative impacts (*Criterion\** 3.5 and *Criterion\** 4.7);
9. Identify where *local communities\** have *legal\** and *customary rights\** related to management activities (*Criterion\** 4.2);
10. Carry out social, economic and *environmental impact assessments\** and develop appropriate mitigation measures (*Criterion\** 4.5);
11. Implement activities related to the maintenance and/or enhancement of *ecosystem services\**, when FSC Ecosystem Services Claims are used (*Criterion\** 5.1);
12. Handle, apply and store *pesticides\** (*Criterion\** 10.7); and
13. Implement procedures for cleaning up spills of *waste materials\** (*Criterion\** 10.12).

Annex C Conservation Area Network\* conceptual diagram (Principle\* 6)



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall use this diagram to inform the development of appropriate guidance at the national and regional level for the creation of *Conservation Area Networks\**.

The diagram shows how the area of the *Management Unit\** included in the *Conservation Area Network\** is generally expected to increase from the 10% minimum as the size, *intensity\** of management, and/or the status and value of *ecosystems\** at the *landscape\** level each increase. The arrows and their direction represent these increases.

The far right column titled '*Ecosystems\** Status/Value in *Landscape\**' signifies the extent to which *native ecosystems\** are protected at the *landscape\** level and the relative requirements for further *protection\** in the *Management Unit\**.

The far left column titled '*Scale\** of *Management Unit\**' shows that as the *Management Unit\** area increases, the *Management Unit\** will itself be at the *landscape\** level and so will be expected to have a *Conservation Area Network\** containing functional examples of all of the naturally occurring *ecosystems\** for that *landscape\**.

## Annex D List of *rare and threatened species*\* in the country or region



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall consider this Annex when developing indicators for *Principle*\* 8, *Principle*\* 9 and *Principle*\* 10 besides *Principle*\* 6.

---

(here to add the content)

## Annex E Elements of the *management plan*\* (Principle\* 7)



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall include in FSS a list that includes the relevant elements of the *management plan*\* as listed below. This list shall be consistent with existing national and sub-national management planning frameworks.

Standard Developers may also develop different lists for different types of Organizations, proportionate to the *scale, intensity\* and risk\** of the management activities.

1. The results of assessments, including:
  - i. Natural resources and *environmental values\**, as identified in *Principle\* 6* and *Principle\* 9*;
  - ii. Social, economic and cultural resources and condition, as identified in *Principle\* 6*, *Principle\* 2* to *Principle\* 5* and *Principle\* 9*;
  - iii. Intact Forest Landscapes\* and core areas\*, as identified in *Principle\* 9*;
  - iv. Indigenous cultural landscapes\*, as identified with affected rights holders\* in *Principle\* 3* & *Principle\* 9*;
  - v. Major social and environmental risks in the area, as identified in *Principle 6*, *Principle\* 2* to *Principle\* 5* and *Principle\* 9*; and
  - vi. The maintenance and/or enhancement of *ecosystem services\** for which promotional claims are made as identified in *Criterion\* 5.1*.
2. Programs and activities regarding:
  - i. *Workers\*\** rights, occupational health and safety, *gender equality\**, as identified in *Principle\* 2*;
  - ii. *Indigenous Peoples\**, community relations, local economic and social development, as identified in *Principle\* 3*, *Principle\* 4* and *Principle\* 5*;
  - iii. *Stakeholder engagement\** and the resolution of disputes\* and grievances, as identified in *Principle\* 1*, *Principle\* 2* and *Principle\* 7*;
  - iv. Planned management activities and timelines, *silvicultural\** systems used, typical harvesting methods and equipment, as identified in *Principle\* 10*;
  - v. The rationale for harvesting rates of timber and other natural resources, as identified in *Principle\* 5*.
3. Measures to *conserve\** and/or *restore\**:
  - i. Rare and threatened species\* and habitats\*;
  - ii. Water bodies\* and riparian zones\*;
  - iii. *Landscape\* connectivity\**, including wildlife corridors;
  - iv. *Ecosystem services\** when FSC ecosystem services claims are used as identified in *Criterion\* 5.1*;
  - v. Representative Sample Areas\*, as identified in *Principle\* 6*; and
  - vi. High Conservation Values\*, as identified in *Principle\* 9*.
4. Measures to assess, prevent, and mitigate negative impacts of management activities on:
  - i. Environmental values\*, as identified in *Principle\* 6* and *Principle\* 9*;

- ii. *Ecosystem services\** when FSC ecosystem services claims are used as identified in *Criterion\** 5.1;
  - iii. Social Values and *Indigenous cultural landscapes\**, as identified in *Principle\** 2 to *Principle\** 5 and *Principle\** 9; and
  - iv. Intact Forest Landscapes\* and core areas\*, as identified in Principle\* 9.
5. A description of the monitoring program, as identified in *Principle\** 8, including:
- i. Growth and yield, as identified in *Principle\** 5;
  - ii. *Ecosystem services\** when FSC ecosystem services claims are used as identified in *Criterion\** 5.1;
  - iii. Environmental values\*, as identified in Principle\* 6;
  - iv. Operational impacts, as identified in *Principle\** 10;
  - v. High Conservation Values\*, as identified in Principle\* 9;
  - vi. Monitoring systems based on stakeholder *engagement\** planned or in place, as identified in *Principle\** 2 to *Principle\** 5 and *Principle\** 7;
  - vii. Maps describing the natural resources and land use zoning on the *Management Unit\**;
  - viii. Description of the methodology to assess and *monitor\** any development and land use options allowed in *Intact Forest Landscapes\** and *core areas\** including their effectiveness in implementing the *precautionary approach\**;
  - ix. Description of the methodology to assess and *monitor\** any development and land use options allowed in *Indigenous cultural landscapes\** including their effectiveness in implementing the *precautionary approach\**; and
  - x. Global Forest Watch map, or more accurate national or regional map, describing the natural resources and land use zoning on the *Management Unit\**, including the *Intact Forest Landscapes\** *core areas\**.

## Annex F Conceptual framework for planning and monitoring (*Principle\* 7*)



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers may use this diagram to inform the periodicity for revision of the various management planning and monitoring documents. The frequency of revision should be based on existing planning cycles and the source and significance of the information received from monitoring, evaluation and *engagement\**.

| Sample Management Plan* Document                  | Management Plan* Revision Periodicity | Element Being Monitored<br><br>(Partial List) | Monitoring Periodicity         | Who Monitors This Element?                        | FSC Principle* / Criterion* |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| (Note: These will vary with SIR and jurisdiction) |                                       |                                               |                                | (Note: These will vary with SIR and jurisdiction) |                             |
| Site Plan<br>(Harvest Plan)                       | Annual                                | Creek crossings                               | When in the field and annually | Operational staff                                 | P10                         |
|                                                   |                                       | Roads                                         | When in the field and annually | Operational staff                                 | P10                         |
|                                                   |                                       | Retention patches                             | Annually sample                | Operational staff                                 | P6, P10                     |
|                                                   |                                       | Rare Threatened and Endangered species        | Annually                       | Consulting Biologist                              | P6                          |
|                                                   |                                       | Annual harvest levels                         | Annually                       | Woodlands Manager                                 | C5.2                        |
|                                                   |                                       | Insect disease outbreaks                      | Annually, sample               | Consulting Biologist / Ministry of Forests        |                             |
| Budgeting                                         | Annual                                | Expenditures                                  | Annually                       | Chief Financial Officer                           | P5                          |

|                                                   |          |                                                   |                                                   |                                         |                |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------|
|                                                   |          | Contribution to local economy                     | Quarterly                                         | General Manager                         | P5             |
| <b>Engagement* Plan</b>                           | Annual   | Employment statistics                             | Annually                                          | General Manager                         | P3, P4         |
|                                                   |          | Social Agreements                                 | Annually, or as agreed in <i>Engagement*</i> Plan | Social Coordinator                      | P3, P4         |
|                                                   |          | Grievances                                        | Ongoing                                           | Human Resources Manager                 | P2, P3, P4     |
| <b>5-Year management plan*</b>                    | 5 years  | Wildlife populations                              | To be determined                                  | Ministry of Environment                 | P6             |
|                                                   |          | Coarse Woody Debris                               | Annually                                          | Ministry of Forests                     | P10            |
|                                                   |          | Free growing / regeneration                       | Annually, sample                                  |                                         |                |
| <b>Sustainable Forestry management plan*</b>      | 10 years | Age class distribution<br>Size class distribution | Ten years                                         | Ministry of Environment                 | P6             |
|                                                   |          | 10 year Allowable Annual Cut                      | Annually, ten years                               | Ministry of Forests / Woodlands manager | C5.2           |
| <b>Ecosystem Services* Certification Document</b> | 5 years  | Prior to validation and verification              | Prior to validation and verification              | General Manager                         | FSC-PRO-30-006 |

## Annex G Monitoring requirements (*Principle\* 8*)



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS: Monitoring is scheduled in the management planning cycles, so that monitoring results can be used in decision-making at an early stage of the planning of a new cycle. Refer to *Principle\* 7*, Annex F.

Standard Developers shall develop indicators to ensure that monitoring procedures are consistent and replicable over time, suitable for quantifying changes over time, and suitable for identifying *risks\** and unacceptable impacts. Monitoring shall include the changes of the conditions of the *Management Unit\**, with and without interventions. This implies that baseline data exists.

In addition to the monitoring conducted for *Criteria\* 8.1* and *8.2*, Standard Developers shall include in FSS a list that includes the relevant elements of the monitoring requirements as listed below. This list shall be consistent with existing national and sub-national monitoring frameworks.

Standard Developers may also develop different lists for different types of Organizations, proportionate to the *scale, intensity and risk\** of the management activities.

1. Monitoring in 8.2.1 is sufficient to identify and describe the environmental impacts of management activities, including where applicable:
  - i. The results of regeneration activities (*Criterion\* 10.1*);
  - ii. The use of ecologically well adapted species for regeneration (*Criterion\* 10.2*);
  - iii. Invasiveness or other adverse impacts associated with any *alien species\** within and outside the *Management Unit\** (*Criterion\* 10.3*);
  - iv. The use of *genetically modified organisms\** to confirm that they are not being used (*Criterion\* 10.4*);
  - v. The results of *silvicultural\** activities (*Criterion\* 10.5*);
  - vi. Adverse impacts to environmental values\* from fertilizers\* (*Criterion\* 10.6*);
  - vii. Adverse impacts from the use of *pesticides\** (*Criterion\* 10.7*);
  - viii. Adverse impacts from the use of *biological control agents\** (*Criterion\* 10.8*);
  - ix. The impacts from *natural hazards\** (*Criterion\* 10.9*);
  - x. The impacts of infrastructural development, transport activities and *silviculture\** to *rare and threatened species\**, *habitats\**, *ecosystems\**, *landscape values\**, water and soils (*Criterion\* 10.10*);
  - xi. The impacts of harvesting and extraction of timber on *non-timber forest products\**, *environmental values\**, merchantable wood waste and other products and services (*Criterion\* 10.11*); and
  - xii. Environmentally appropriate disposal of *waste materials\** (*Criterion\* 10.12*).
2. Monitoring in 8.2.1 is sufficient to identify and describe social impacts of management activities, including where applicable:
  - ii. Evidence of illegal or unauthorized activities (*Criterion\* 1.4*);



- iii. Compliance with *applicable laws\**, *local laws\**, *ratified\** international conventions and *obligatory codes of practice\** (*Criterion\** 1.5);
- iv. Resolution of *disputes\** and grievances (*Criterion\** 1.6, *Criterion\** 2.6, *Criterion\** 4.6);
- v. Programs and activities regarding *workers\** rights (*Criterion\** 2.1);
- vi. *Gender equality\**, sexual harassment and gender *discrimination\** (*Criterion\** 2.2);
- vii. Programs and activities regarding occupational health and safety (*Criterion\** 2.3);
- viii. Payment of wages (*Criterion\** 2.4);
- ix. *Workers\** training (*Criterion\** 2.5);
- x. Where *pesticides\** are used, the health of *workers\** exposed to *pesticides\** (*Criterion\** 2.5 and *Criterion\** 10.7);
- xi. The identification of Indigenous Peoples\* and local communities\* and their legal\* and customary rights\* (*Criterion\** 3.1 and *Criterion\** 4.1);
- xii. Full implementation of the terms in *binding agreements\** (*Criterion\** 3.2 and *Criterion\** 4.2);
- xiii. *Indigenous Peoples\** and community relations (*Criterion\** 3.2, *Criterion\** 3.3 and *Criterion\** 4.2);
- xiv. *Protection\** of sites of special cultural, ecological, economic, religious or spiritual significance to *Indigenous Peoples\** and *local communities\** (*Criterion\** 3.5 and *Criterion\** 4.7);
- xv. The persistence of *Indigenous cultural landscapes\** and associated values of significance to *Indigenous Peoples\** (*Criterion\** 3.1, *Criterion\** 3.5);
- xvi. The use of traditional knowledge\* and intellectual property\* (*Criterion\** 3.6 and *Criterion\** 4.8);
- xvii. Local economic and social development (*Criterion\** 4.2, *Criterion\** 4.3, *Criterion\** 4.4, *Criterion\** 4.5);
- xviii. The production of diversified benefits and/or products (*Criterion\** 5.1);
- xix. The maintenance and/or enhancement of *ecosystem services\** (*Criterion\** 5.1);
- xx. Activities to maintain or enhance *ecosystem services\** (*Criterion\** 5.1);
- xxi. Actual compared to projected annual harvests of timber and *non-timber forest products\** (*Criterion\** 5.2);
- xxii. The use of local processing, local services and local value added manufacturing (*Criterion\** 5.4);
- xxiii. Long term\* economic viability\* (*Criterion\** 5.5); and
- xxiv. High Conservation Values\* 5 and 6 identified in *Criterion\** 9.1.

3. Monitoring procedures in 8.2.2 are sufficient to identify and describe changes in environmental conditions including where applicable:
  - i. The maintenance and/or enhancement of *ecosystem services\** (*Criterion\** 5.2) (when *The Organization\** uses FSC ecosystem services claims);
  - ii. *Environmental values\** and *ecosystem functions\** including carbon sequestration and storage (*Criterion\** 6.1); including the effectiveness of actions identified and implemented to prevent, mitigate and repair negative impacts to *environmental values\** (*Criterion\** 6.3);
  - iii. *Rare and threatened species\**, and the effectiveness of actions implemented to protect them and their *habitats\** (*Criterion\** 6.4);

- iv. *Representative Sample Areas\** and the effectiveness of actions implemented to *conserve\** and/or *restore\** them (*Criterion\** 6.5);
- v. Naturally occurring *native species\** and *biological diversity\** and the effectiveness of actions implemented to *conserve\** and/or *restore\** them (*Criterion\** 6.6);
- vi. Water courses, *water bodies\**, water quantity and water quality and the effectiveness of actions implemented to *conserve\** and/or *restore\** them (*Criterion\** 6.7);
- vii. *Landscape values\** and the effectiveness of actions implemented to maintain and/or *restore\** them (*Criterion\** 6.8);
- viii. Conversion of *natural forest\** to *plantations\** or conversion to non-forest\* (*Criterion\** 6.9);
- ix. The status of *plantations\** established after 1994 (*Criterion\** 6.10); and
- x. *High Conservation Values\** 1 to 4 identified in *Criterion\** 9.1 and the effectiveness of actions implemented to maintain and/or enhance them.

## Annex H Instructions for Standards Developers to develop indicators for *Intact Forest Landscape\* core areas\* (Principle\* 9)*



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

For countries with *Intact Forest Landscapes\** Standards Developers shall use the following instructions for establishing:

- A. The threshold for *vast majority\** of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** as *core areas\**; and
- B. Indicators for assessing and protecting *Intact Forest Landscapes\**.

---

#### **A. Threshold for vast majority\***

The definition of *vast majority\** is 80% of the total area of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** within the *Management Unit\** as of January 1, 2017. The *vast majority\** also meets or exceeds the definition of *Intact Forest Landscape\**.

The threshold for *vast majority\** may be established below 80% providing it achieves the greatest amount of *conservation\** gains based on national or *eco-regional\** considerations and still meets or exceeds the definition of *Intact Forest Landscape\**.

Thresholds above 80% shall be considered in nations and/or eco-regions where *Intact Forest Landscapes\** are relatively rare and/or *fragmented\**, and/or where large amounts of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** have been lost since 2000.

In developing nationally or *eco-regionally\** specific thresholds of *vast majority\** Standards Developers shall consider the following:

1. Evidence to demonstrate the relative abundance of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** and the level of *risk\** of degradation to *Intact Forest Landscapes\** from human activities, including:
  - a. Relative scarcity of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** nationally or *eco-regionally\**. The more scarce *Intact Forest Landscapes*, then the higher the threshold for *vast majority\**;
  - b. The degree to which national or *eco-regional\** *Intact Forest Landscapes\** have been degraded by human activities since 2000 and are therefore, scarce, rare or *fragmented\**. The quicker the degradation of *Intact Forest Landscapes*, then the higher the threshold for *vast majority\**;
  - c. The types of human activities that have resulted in the degradation of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** since 2000. The more damaging the human activities to the intactness of *Intact Forest Landscapes\**, then the higher the threshold for *vast majority\**;
  - d. The *risk\** of damage to *Intact Forest Landscapes\** from human activities. The greater the risk to *Intact Forest Landscapes\**, then the higher the threshold for *vast majority\**;
  - e. Amount and relative permanence of *protection\** of *Intact Forest Landscape\* core areas\** comparing different intensities of *industrial activity\**. *Protection\** should maintain or enhance the integrity and other ecological attributes of *Intact Forest Landscape\* core areas\**. The more permanent the *protection\** of *Intact Forest Landscapes\**, then the lower the threshold for *vast majority\**;
  - f. The nature and distribution of ecological values within and adjacent to *Intact Forest Landscapes\**. The greater the concentration of these values within and adjacent to *Intact Forest Landscapes*, then the higher the threshold for *vast majority\**;
  - g. The nature and distribution of cultural values and *legal and customary rights\** within and adjacent to *Intact Forest Landscapes\**; and

- h. The outcomes of culturally appropriate\* engagement\* with affected rights holders\* affected\* and interested stakeholders\*;

## **B. Developing Indicators for Assessing and Protecting Intact Forest Landscapes\***

Standard Developers shall consider the following information when developing indicators for *Criteria\** 9.1 and 9.2.

The outcome shall be nationally or *eco-regionally\** appropriate requirements to identify, assess and protect the *vast majority\** of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** as *core areas\**.

*Core areas\** are intended to be *protected\** from activities that impact their intactness including commercial logging, mining, and the construction of roads, dams, and other *infrastructure\**.

1. The Indicators developed for the identification and designation of *core areas\** shall:
  - a. Respect the right to *Free Prior and Informed Consent\** of *affected rights holders\** (*Criterion\** 3.1 and 4.1);
  - b. Ensure the *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *affected rights holders\** to use the *core areas\** are *upheld\**;
  - c. Ensure that *core areas\** contain the most ecologically valuable, contiguous, and intact portions of the *Intact Forest Landscapes\**;
  - d. Ensure the shape of *core areas\** is designed to maximize their interior habitats.
  - e. Ensure that *core areas\** contain habitat for *rare, threatened and endangered\** species and other wildlife that depend on large contiguous areas of unaltered *forest\**;
  - f. Ensure that *core areas\** maintain or restore *connectivity\** between *core areas\** both within and adjacent to the *Management Unit\**; and
  - g. Ensure that *core areas\** are not smaller than 50,000 ha.
2. The Indicators developed for the *protection\** of *core areas\** shall ensure:
  - a. The *legal\** and *customary rights\** of *affected rights holders\** to use the *core areas\** are *upheld\**;
  - b. *Indigenous Peoples\**, traditional peoples and forest dependent communities are given priority to design and implement alternative management and *conservation\** activities compatible with *protection\** of *core areas\**;
  - c. Prevention of illegal logging, windthrow, degradation, and other edge effect impacts within *core areas\**;
  - d. Management of road construction and the *intensity\** of other activities adjacent to *core areas\** to prevent illegal logging, windthrow, degradation, and other edge effect impacts within *core areas\**; and
  - e. Identification of appropriate buffer zone widths adjacent to *core areas\** where road construction and other activities are managed to prevent edge effect impacts within the *core areas\**.
3. The Indicators developed for the *protection\** of *core areas\** shall ensure intactness of *core areas\**, considering activities that impact intactness, including commercial logging, mining, and the construction of roads, dams, and other infrastructure. Examples of management that *protects\** the intactness of *core areas\** include *conservation zones\** as well as areas that may or not have *legal\** *protection\** such as set asides, reserves, deferrals, community reserves, and Indigenous protected areas.
4. The Indicators developed for *Intact Forest Landscapes\** shall clarify that the portions of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** not designated as *Core Areas\** shall be managed to protect and/or maintain *High Conservation Values\** Category 2.

## Annex I Strategies for maintaining *High Conservation Values*\* (Principle\* 9)



### INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:

Standard Developers shall consider the following strategies to inform the development of indicators to maintain *High Conservation Values*\*.

---

Strategies for maintaining *High Conservation Values*\* may not necessarily preclude harvesting. However, the only way to maintain some *High Conservation Values*\* will be through *protection*\* of the *High Conservation Value Area*\* that supports them.

HCV 1 – Protection zones, harvest prescriptions, and/or other strategies to protect threatened, endangered, endemic species, or other concentrations of *biological diversity*\* and the ecological communities and *habitats*\* upon which they depend, sufficient to prevent reductions in the extent, integrity, quality, and viability of the *habitats*\* and species occurrences. Where enhancement is identified as the *objective*\*, measures to develop, expand, and/or *restore*\* *habitats*\* for such species are in place.

HCV 2 – Strategies that fully maintain the extent and intactness of the *forest*\* *ecosystems*\* and the viability of their biodiversity concentrations, including plant and animal indicator species, keystone species, and/or guilds associated with large intact natural *forest*\* *ecosystems*\*. Examples include *protection*\* zones and set-aside areas, with any commercial activity in areas that are not set-aside being limited to *low-intensity*\* operations that fully maintain *forest*\* structure, composition, regeneration, and disturbance patterns at all times. Where enhancement is identified as the *objective*\*, measures to *restore*\* and reconnect *forest*\* *ecosystems*\*, their intactness, and *habitats*\* that support natural *biological diversity*\* are in place.

HCV 3 – Strategies that fully maintain the extent and integrity of *rare or threatened ecosystems*\*, *habitats*\*, or *refugia*\*. Where enhancement is identified as the *objective*\*, measures to *restore*\* and/or develop rare or threatened *ecosystems*\*, *habitats*\*, or *refugia*\* are in place.

HCV 4 – Strategies to protect any water catchments of importance to *local communities*\* located within or downstream of the *Management Unit*\*, and areas within the unit that are particularly unstable or susceptible to erosion. Examples may include *protection*\* zones, harvest prescriptions, chemical use restrictions, and/or prescriptions for road construction and maintenance, to protect water catchments and upstream and upslope areas. Where enhancement is identified as the *objective*\*, measures to *restore*\* water quality and quantity are in place. Where identified HCV 4 ecosystem services\* include climate regulation, strategies to maintain or enhance carbon sequestration and storage are in place.

HCV 5 – Strategies to protect the community's and/or *Indigenous Peoples*\* needs in relation to the *Management Unit*\* are developed in cooperation with representatives and members of *local communities*\* and *Indigenous Peoples*\*.

HCV 6 – Strategies to protect the cultural values are developed in cooperation with representatives and members of *local communities*\* and *Indigenous Peoples*\*.

## Annex J High Conservation Values\* framework (Principle\* 9)



**INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS:** The objective of this High Conservation Value (HCV) Framework is to provide nationally specific interpretations of HCVs and *Best Available Information\** for addressing HCVs.

This National HCV Framework is to be used by accredited Certification bodies and certificate holders.

The National HCV Interpretations and *Best Available Information\** provided in this Framework are not necessarily exhaustive; additional examples of HCV occurrences may exist and shall be identified at the forest management unit scale.

The National or Regional Interpretations of the HCV categories and elements apply to all certificate holders, wherever occurrences of those HCVs may exist. Conversely, the Best Available Information for addressing those National/Regional HCV Interpretations may vary, depending on whether the certificate holder is a SLIMF or non-SLIMF, as indicated in the Framework.

Specific sections of this Framework are also applicable to National and Centralized National Risk Assessments for Controlled Wood, and to Certification Bodies and Certificate Holders seeking certification under FSC-STD-30-010 and FSC-STD-40-005. The applicable sections are: The National or Regional HCV Interpretations and *Best Available Information* for each HCV category; and the *Best Available Information* for Assessments for each HCV category.

### Overarching Best Available Information

The following tables show the types of overarching Best Available Information (BAI) that is applicable for assessments, strategies, and monitoring for all HCVs or specific categories of HCVs. The BAI applies to all Organizations that are not SLIMF. For SLIMFs, the BAI applies where indicated. The purpose of listing overarching BAI here is to avoid having to list it repetitively in the following sections. BAI that is more specific to individual HCV Interpretations is included in the following sections.

| <i>Best Available Information*</i> for Identifying and Assessing National or Regional HCV Interpretations |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | SLIMF |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| <b>All HCV Categories,<br/>All Elements</b>                                                               | Data, facts, documents, expert opinions, and results of field surveys or consultations with stakeholders that are most credible, accurate, complete, and/or pertinent and that can be obtained through reasonable* effort and cost, subject to the scale* and intensity* of the management activities and the Precautionary Approach*.<br><br>High Conservation Value* surveys of the Management Unit*; relevant databases and maps; culturally appropriate* engagement*with Indigenous Peoples, affected rights holders*, affected* and interested stakeholders*, and relevant local and regional experts; FSC Guidelines for the Implementation of Free, Prior and Informed Consent (2021); review of the results by knowledgeable expert(s) independent of The Organization*. | X     |
| <b>HCV 2, Element 1,<br/>IFLs</b>                                                                         | Global Forest Watch Intact Forest Landscapes* maps (2017) <a href="http://www.globalforestwatch.org">www.globalforestwatch.org</a> , or other maps based on a more recent and accurate Intact Forest Landscapes* inventory using a refined methodology.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | X     |



|                                                                                         |                                                                                                  |   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| <b>HCV 5, Element 1, and HCV 6, Element 2, Values fundamental to local communities</b>  | Culturally appropriate engagement with local communities is the primary BAI for these elements.  | X |
| <b>HCV 5, Element 2, and HCV 6, Element 3, Values fundamental to Indigenous Peoples</b> | Culturally appropriate engagement with Indigenous Peoples is the primary BAI for these elements. | X |

### **Best Available Information\* for Developing Management Strategies for National or Regional HCV Interpretations** SLIMF

|                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| <b>All HCV Categories, All Elements</b>                                                 | <p>Identification of threats, using: Data, facts, documents, expert opinions, and results of field surveys or consultations with stakeholders that are most credible, accurate, complete, and/or pertinent and that can be obtained through reasonable* effort and cost, subject to the scale* and intensity* of the management activities and the Precautionary Approach*.</p> <p>Engagement*with Indigenous Peoples, affected rights holders*, affected* and interested stakeholders*, and experts.</p> | X |
| <b>HCV 5, Element 1, and HCV 6, Element 2, Values fundamental to local communities</b>  | Culturally appropriate engagement with local communities is the primary BAI for these elements. The “fundamentality” and “critical... importance” of the resources should also be determined through engagement.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | X |
| <b>HCV 5, Element 2, and HCV 6, Element 3, Values fundamental to Indigenous Peoples</b> | Culturally appropriate engagement with Indigenous Peoples is the primary BAI for these elements. The “fundamentality” and “critical... importance” of the resources should also be determined through engagement.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | X |

### **Best Available Information\* for Monitoring National or Regional HCV Interpretations** SLIMF

|                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |   |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| <b>All HCV Categories, All Elements</b> | BAI includes: Engagement with rights-holders, consistent with Criteria 3.5, 4.5 and 4.7; culturally appropriate engagement with Indigenous Peoples and affected and interested stakeholders; information on engaging with representatives of the Indigenous Peoples and/or local communities; monitoring conducted by the Indigenous Peoples and/or local communities; and engagement with experts. | X |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|

---

---

**HCV 1 – Species diversity. Concentrations of *biological diversity*\* including endemic species, and *rare*\*, *threatened*\* or endangered species, that are *significant*\* at global, regional or national levels.**

All information in the following sections applies to all Organizations. The exception is BAI that is not shown as applicable to SLIMFs; however, the Interpretations, Strategies, and Assessment and Monitoring methods still apply. See also the Overarching BAI listed above.

**A. National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 1, for HCV Identification**

| National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 1:                                                                                                                | Best Available Information* (BAI) for identifying occurrences of the Interpretations: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Element 1: Concentrations of <i>biological diversity</i> * that are <i>significant</i> * at global, regional, or national levels:                             |                                                                                       |                                  |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                              | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                              | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Element 2: Concentrations of endemic species that are <i>significant</i> * at global, regional, or national levels:                                           |                                                                                       |                                  |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                              | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                              | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Element 3: Concentrations of <i>rare</i> *, <i>threatened</i> *, or endangered species that are <i>significant</i> * at global, regional, or national levels: |                                                                                       |                                  |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                              | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |



|                                  |                                  |                                  |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text. | Click or tap here to enter text. | Click or tap here to enter text. |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|

## B. Assessments for HCV 1

| National or Regional methodologies for assessing occurrences of the HCV 1 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for assessing occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                           | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                           | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |

## C. Strategies for Maintaining and Enhancing HCV 1

| National or Regional strategies for maintaining and/or enhancing the HCV 1 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for management strategies: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |

## D. Monitoring for HCV 1

| National or Regional methodologies for monitoring occurrences of the HCV 1 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for monitoring occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                                     | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                                     | Click or tap here to enter text. |

**HCV 2 – *Landscape*\*-level *ecosystems*\* and mosaics.** Intact forest landscapes and large *landscape*\*-level *ecosystems*\* and *ecosystem*\* mosaics that are *significant*\* at global, regional or national levels, and that contain viable populations of the great majority of the naturally occurring species in natural patterns of distribution and abundance.

All information in the following sections applies to all Organizations. The exception is BAI that is not shown as applicable to SLIMFs; however, the Interpretations, Strategies, and Assessment and Monitoring methods still apply. See also the Overarching BAI listed above.

**A. National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 2, for HCV Identification**

| National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 2:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Best Available Information* (BAI) for identifying occurrences of the Interpretations: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Element 1: Intact forest landscapes*:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                       |                                  |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Element 2: <i>Large landscape</i> *-level <i>ecosystems</i> * that are <i>significant</i> * at global, regional or national levels, and that contain viable populations of the great majority of the naturally occurring species in natural patterns of distribution and abundance: |                                                                                       |                                  |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Click or tap here to enter text.                                                      | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Element 3: <i>Ecosystem</i> * mosaics that are <i>significant</i> * at global, regional or national levels, and that contain viable populations of the great majority of the naturally occurring species in natural patterns of distribution and abundance:                         |                                                                                       |                                  |

|                                  |                                  |                                  |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text. | Click or tap here to enter text. | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text. | Click or tap here to enter text. | Click or tap here to enter text. |

## B. Assessments for HCV 2

| National or Regional methodologies for assessing occurrences of the HCV 2 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for assessing occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                           | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                           | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |

## C. Strategies for Maintaining and Enhancing HCV 2

| National or Regional strategies for maintaining and/or enhancing the HCV 2 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for management strategies: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                                    | Click or tap here to enter text. |

D. Monitoring for HCV 2

| National or Regional methodologies for monitoring occurrences of the HCV 2 Interpretations: | Best Available Information* (BAI) for monitoring occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF?       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                              | Click or tap here to enter text. |
| Click or tap here to enter text.                                                            | Click or tap here to enter text.                              | Click or tap here to enter text. |

**HCV 3 – Ecosystems\* and habitats\*. Rare\*, threatened\*, or endangered ecosystems\*, habitats\* or refugia\*.**

All information in the following sections applies to all Organizations. The exception is BAI that is not shown as applicable to SLIMFs; however, the Interpretations, Strategies, and Assessment and Monitoring methods still apply. See also the Overarching BAI listed above.

**A. National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 3, for HCV Identification**

| National or Regional Interpretations of<br>HCV 3:         | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI)<br>for identifying occurrences of the<br>Interpretations: | BAI<br>also<br>applies<br>to<br>SLIMF? |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Element 1: Rare*, threatened*, or endangered ecosystems*: |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
| Element 2: Rare*, threatened*, or endangered habitats*:   |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
| Element 3: Refugia*:                                      |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |
|                                                           |                                                                                                    |                                        |

**B. Assessments for HCV 3**

| National or Regional methodologies for assessing occurrences of the HCV 3 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for assessing occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|                                                                                            |                                                                     |                            |

**C. Strategies for Maintaining and Enhancing HCV 3**

| National or Regional strategies for maintaining and/or enhancing the HCV 3 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for management strategies: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|                                                                                             |                                                                     |                            |

**D. Monitoring for HCV 3**

| National or Regional methodologies for monitoring occurrences of the HCV 3 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for monitoring occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|                                                                                             |                                                                      |                            |





**HCV 4 – Critical\* ecosystem services\*. Basic ecosystem services\* in critical\* situations, including protection\* of water catchments and control of erosion of vulnerable soils and slopes.**

All information in the following sections applies to all Organizations. The exception is BAI that is not shown as applicable to SLIMFs; however, the Interpretations, Strategies, and Assessment and Monitoring methods still apply. See also the Overarching BAI listed above.

**A. National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 4, for HCV Identification**

| National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 4: | Best Available Information* (BAI) for identifying occurrences of the Interpretations: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

Element 1: Water catchments in critical\* situations:

---

---

---

Element 2: Control of erosion of vulnerable soils and slopes in critical\* situations:

---

---

---

Element 3: Other ecosystem services\* in critical\* situations:

---

---

---

**B. Assessments for HCV 4**

|                                                                                            |                                                                     |                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional methodologies for assessing occurrences of the HCV 4 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for assessing occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

**C. Strategies for Maintaining and Enhancing HCV 4**

|                                                                                             |                                                                     |                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional strategies for maintaining and/or enhancing the HCV 4 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for management strategies: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

**D. Monitoring for HCV 4**

|                                                                                             |                                                                      |                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional methodologies for monitoring occurrences of the HCV 4 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> (BAI) for monitoring occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|



**HCV 5 – Community needs. Sites and resources fundamental for satisfying the basic necessities of *local communities\** or *Indigenous Peoples\** (for livelihoods, health, nutrition, water, etc.), identified through *engagement\** with these communities or Indigenous Peoples.**

All information in the following sections applies to all Organizations. The exception is BAI that is not shown as applicable to SLIMFs; however, the Interpretations, Strategies, and Assessment and Monitoring methods still apply. See also the Overarching BAI listed above.

**A. National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 5, for HCV Identification**

| National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 5: | Best Available Information* (BAI) for identifying occurrences of the Interpretations: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

Element 1: Sites and resources fundamental for satisfying the basic necessities of *local communities\** (for livelihoods, health, nutrition, water, etc.):

Element 2: Sites and resources fundamental for satisfying the basic necessities of *Indigenous Peoples\** (for livelihoods, health, nutrition, water, etc.):

**B. Assessments for HCV 5**

| National or Regional methodologies for assessing occurrences of the HCV 5 Interpretations: | Best Available Information* (BAI) for assessing occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

C. Strategies for Maintaining and Enhancing HCV 5

|                                                                                             |                                                              |                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional strategies for maintaining and/or enhancing the HCV 5 Interpretations: | Best Available Information* (BAI) for management strategies: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

D. Monitoring for HCV 5

|                                                                                             |                                                               |                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional methodologies for monitoring occurrences of the HCV 5 Interpretations: | Best Available Information* (BAI) for monitoring occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

**HCV 6 – Cultural values. Sites, resources, *habitats*\* and *landscapes*\* of global or national cultural, archaeological or historical significance, and/or of *critical*\* cultural, ecological, economic or religious/sacred importance for the traditional cultures of *local communities*\* or Indigenous Peoples, identified through *engagement*\* with these *local communities*\* or Indigenous Peoples.**

All information in the following sections applies to all Organizations. The exception is BAI that is not shown as applicable to SLIMFs; however, the Interpretations, Strategies, and Assessment and Monitoring methods still apply. See also the Overarching BAI listed above.

**A. National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 6, for HCV Identification**

| National or Regional Interpretations of HCV 6:                                                                                                                                                                        | Best Available Information* for identifying occurrences of the Interpretations: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Element 1: Sites, resources, <i>habitats</i> * and <i>landscapes</i> * of global or national cultural, archaeological or historical significance:                                                                     |                                                                                 |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                 |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                 |                            |
| Element 2: Sites, resources, <i>habitats</i> * and <i>landscapes</i> * of <i>critical</i> * cultural, ecological, economic or religious/sacred importance for the traditional cultures of <i>local communities</i> *: |                                                                                 |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                 |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                 |                            |
| Element 3: Sites, resources, <i>habitats</i> * and <i>landscapes</i> * of <i>critical</i> * cultural, ecological, economic or religious/sacred importance for the traditional cultures of Indigenous Peoples:         |                                                                                 |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                 |                            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                 |                            |

**B. Assessments for HCV 6**

|                                                                                            |                                                               |                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional methodologies for assessing occurrences of the HCV 6 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> for assessing occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

**C. Strategies for Maintaining and Enhancing HCV 6**

|                                                                                             |                                                               |                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional strategies for maintaining and/or enhancing the HCV 6 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> for management strategies: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

**D. Monitoring for HCV 6**

|                                                                                             |                                                                |                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| National or Regional methodologies for monitoring occurrences of the HCV 6 Interpretations: | <i>Best Available Information*</i> for monitoring occurrences: | BAI also applies to SLIMF? |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|

## Examples of Relevant Stakeholders and Experts

*(This is a list of stakeholder and expert organizations likely to be relevant to HCV assessments, strategies, and/or monitoring, either in general, or for particular HCV categories or elements. The list is not exhaustive, may need to change over time, and can be updated by standards developers. Where additional stakeholders and experts are relevant to specific management units, they should also be identified and considered by managers.)*

### **Environmental Stakeholders:**

- XXX. – including re. XXX.

### **Social Stakeholders and Community Development Organizations:**

- XXX

### **Indigenous Peoples Organizations:**

- XXX

### **Other Expert Organizations – Environmental:**

- XXX

### **Other Expert Organizations – Social:**

- XXX

### **Government Agencies:**

- XXX

## References

*(Relevant references may include weblinks or full references for BAI listed above, as well as supporting references for HCV Interpretations.)*

Click or tap here to enter text.



## Annex K International Generic Indicators for the use and risk management of highly hazardous pesticides\*



INSTRUCTIONS FOR STANDARD DEVELOPERS: Standard Developers shall follow Annex 4: Procedure to implement policy requirements for *Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\** framework at national level of FSC-POL-30-001 FSC Pesticide Policy V3-0 prior to considering this set of International Generic Indicators. This procedure describes how Standard Developers shall use Annex 2: Minimum list of hazards, elements and variables to consider in the assessment of environmental and social risks of FSC-POL-30-001 FSC Pesticide Policy V3-0 to establish the conditions for the use of highly restricted highly hazardous pesticides\* and restricted highly hazardous pesticides\* at national level.

Indicators for the use and risk management of specific *highly hazardous pesticides\** shall be compiled into a National *Highly Hazardous Pesticides\** Framework annexed to the national standard.

Standard Developers shall consider *workers\** rights in relation to use of *pesticides\** in accordance with the *ILO code of practice on safety in the use of chemicals at work*, or any national interpretation of this document in national standards, including the right to refuse to use *highly hazardous pesticides\**.

Standard developers shall consider the documents in table *Reference Documents* at the end of this Annex when developing national indicators and shall consider whether it is appropriate to list these documents in national standards for the guidance of certificate holders.

Standard Developers shall determine, using *Best Available Information\**, whether *critical population density\** is an appropriate measure to determine *intervention threshold\** for a particular *pest\** (Indicator 10.7.12).

Standard Developers shall consider the need to specify research requirements (Indicator 10.7.13), training requirements (Indicator 10.7.19), monitoring requirements (Indicators 10.7.20, 10.7.21 and 10.7.22) and remediation requirements (Indicators 10.7.24, 10.7.25 and 10.7.26) for a particular *highly hazardous pesticide\**, and shall adapt indicators accordingly.

Standard Developers shall consider the need to specify essential risk mitigation measures for a particular *highly hazardous pesticide\**, and shall adapt Indicator 10.7.14 and/or add indicators accordingly. In specifying measures, Standard Developers shall take into account the role of the management unit level *Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\** and site level operational plans in identifying context-specific measures (Indicator 10.7.14).

Standard Developers shall identify any gaps between the appropriate personal protective equipment specified in national laws and regulations or product labels and the personal protective equipment specified in *FSC-POL-30-001b Personal Protective Equipment*. Standard Developers shall adapt indicator 10.7.15 based on this gap analysis (Indicator 10.7.15).

Standard Developers shall consider the need to specify the characteristics of any *pesticide buffer zone\** or *exclusion zone\** for a particular *highly hazardous pesticide\**, and if so, shall adapt the relevant indicator(s) accordingly with reference to the *chemical pesticides\** label instructions, safety data sheets or regulations as appropriate. When a *pesticide buffer zone\** and/or *exclusion zone\** is not appropriate for a particular *highly hazardous pesticide\**, Standard Developers may drop the relevant indicator(s) (Indicators 10.7.16 and 10.7.17).

Standard Developers shall consider Indicators 10.7.22 and 10.7.26 only for *highly hazardous pesticides\** listed on the basis of their environmental toxicity (hazard criteria 7 and 8).

10.7.11 A trend of replacement, reduction and/or removal of *highly hazardous pesticides\** over time is demonstrated, or continued use is justified.

10.7.12 Control measures are proactively considered and/or implemented based on the likely impacts of the targeted pest, weed or disease and any *intervention threshold\** to avoid unacceptable impacts on economic, environmental or social values.

10.7.13 Programmes are in place that have specific actions, timelines, targets and resources allocated to conduct, or support, research to identify and test less hazardous alternatives to replace FSC *highly restricted highly hazardous pesticides\** and *restricted highly hazardous pesticides\**.

NOTE: Less hazardous alternatives may include changes to management practices, species choice and tree breeding, biological control agents, non-chemical *pesticides\** or other *chemical pesticides\**.

10.7.14 Risk mitigation measures prioritise avoiding *exposure\** of *workers\**, *affected stakeholders\** and/or *environmental values\** to *highly hazardous pesticides\**.

10.7.15 Risk mitigation measures for *workers\** include the use of appropriate personal protective equipment consistent with FSC-POL-30-001b *Personal Protective Equipment*.

10.7.16 A *pesticides buffer zone\** is established where a *highly hazardous pesticide\** and/or application method requires one to ensure the protection of *environmental values\** and social values.

10.7.17 An *exclusion zone\** is established where a *highly hazardous pesticide\** and/or application method requires one, as instructed by the label or other applicable sources, to avoid *workers\** and *affected stakeholders\** from being exposed to harm.

10.7.18 The location and duration of such an *exclusion zone\** is communicated in a *culturally appropriate\** manner.

10.7.19 Training programmes (see Criterion 2.5) for the use of *highly hazardous pesticides\** include informing *workers\** of known *risks\** to human health and *environmental values\**, and mitigation measures identified in the *Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\**.

10.7.20 The implementation of risk mitigation measures is monitored.

10.7.21 The exposure of individual *workers\** to *highly hazardous pesticides\** is monitored.

NOTE: Examples of monitoring approaches can include:

- Records of *highly hazardous pesticide\** applications,
- Checks on correct personal protective equipment use,
- Records of reported or observed health effects,
- *Medical biomonitoring\**.

10.7.22 Environmental impacts of *highly hazardous pesticide\** use and changes in environmental condition are monitored.

NOTE: Examples of monitoring approaches can include:

- Records of *highly hazardous pesticide\** applications,
- Records of reported or observed environmental impacts,
- *Environmental biomonitoring\**, e.g. using *trigger values\** for particular organisms or groups of organisms.

10.7.23 *Environmental and Social Risk Assessment(s)\**, site operational plans, and site-specific risk mitigation and monitoring measures are consistent with safety data sheets (MSDS) and chemical label instructions.

10.7.24 Based on monitoring results, corrective action is taken where mitigation measures are not implemented as appropriate, or are not effective in managing *risks\** to human health and *environmental values\**.

- 10.7.25 Harm caused to *workers\** and *affected stakeholders\** by over-exposure to *highly hazardous pesticide\** is treated. When treatment is not possible, *fair compensation\** is provided.
- 10.7.26 Damage caused to *environmental values\** by *highly hazardous pesticides\** is repaired. When *repairing\** damage is not possible, *fair compensation\** is provided.
- 10.7.27 When *highly hazardous pesticides\** are used in an *emergency\** or by *government order\**, use conforms with the procedure for the exceptional use of prohibited *highly hazardous pesticides\** in Annex 3 of FSC-POL-30-001 *FSC Pesticides Policy*.

NOTE: While Annex 3 of the FSC Pesticides Policy addresses the use of *Prohibited highly hazardous pesticides\** in *emergency\** situations or by *government orders\**, this indicator allows certificate holders to apply the same procedure to *restricted highly hazardous pesticides\** and *highly restricted highly hazardous pesticides\** in these situations, providing a window of thirty (30) days after starting the use of the chemical pesticide in which to complete a site specific *Environmental and Social Risk Assessment\**.

**Table. Reference Documents of HHP:**

| Reference Document                                                                                                                                     | HC 1                                   | HC 2                                | HC 3                                | HC 4                                | HC 5                                | HC 6                                | HC 7  | HC 8  | HC 9           | HC 10        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------|-------|----------------|--------------|
| <b>FSC POL-30-001a FSC Lists of highly hazardous pesticides (FSC)</b>                                                                                  | All                                    | All                                 | All                                 | All                                 | All                                 | All                                 | All   | All   | All            | All          |
| <b>Global Harmonized System of Classification and Labelling of Chemicals (UN)</b>                                                                      | Pt. 3 Ch 3.1, 3.5, 3.9 & Pt. 4 Ch. 4.2 | Pt. 3, Ch. 3.1                      | Pt. 3, Ch. 3.6                      | Pt. 3, Ch. 3.5                      | Pt. 3, Ch. 3.7                      | Pt. 3, Ch. 3.9                      |       |       | Pt. 3, Ch. 3.8 | Pt. 3, Pt. 4 |
| <b>The WHO Recommended Classification of Pesticides by Hazard and Guidelines to Classification (WHO, IPCS &amp; IOMC)</b>                              | Tbl. 1, 6, 7                           | Tbl. 1, 2, 3, 7                     | Tbl. 1, 2, 3, 7                     | Tbl. 1, 2, 3, 7                     | Tbl. 1, 2, 3, 7                     | Tbl. 1, 2, 3, 4, 7                  |       |       |                |              |
| <b>International tools for preventing local pesticide problems: A consolidated guide to chemical codes and conventions (ECSPHR)</b>                    | Sec. 3, Sec. 5.2.1                     |                                     | Ch. 3, Sec. 4.2.5, 4.3.5 & Ch. 6    | Ch. 3, Sec. 4.2.5, 4.3.5 & Ch. 6    |                                     |                                     |       |       |                |              |
| <b>International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management. Guidelines for personal protection when handling and applying pesticides (FAO &amp; WHO)</b> | Pt. 1, Sec. 1.1, 1.3, 1.4 & Annex 6    | Pt. 1, Sec. 1.1, 1.3, 1.4 & Annex 6 | Pt. 1, Sec. 1.1, 1.3, 1.4 & Annex 6 | Pt. 1, Sec. 1.1, 1.3, 1.4 & Annex 6 | Pt. 1, Sec. 1.1, 1.3, 1.4 & Annex 6 | Pt. 1, Sec. 1.1, 1.3, 1.4 & Annex 6 |       |       |                |              |
| <b>International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management. Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides (FAO &amp; WHO)</b>                                |                                        | Ch. 2,3 & 6                         |                                     |                                     | Ch. 2,3 & 6                         | Ch. 2,3 & 6                         |       |       |                |              |
| <b>Considerations of assessing the risks of combined exposure to multiple chemicals. Series on testing and assessment. No 296. 2018 (OECD)</b>         |                                        |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     | Ch. 7 |       |                |              |
| <b>WHO IPCS Integrated Risk Assessment (WHO)</b>                                                                                                       |                                        |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     | All   | Ch. 7 |                |              |
| <b>Metabolites impact on non – target arthropods and pollinators</b>                                                                                   |                                        |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |       | All   |                |              |
| <b>International Code of Practice for use of pesticides (WHO)</b>                                                                                      |                                        |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |       |       | All            | All          |
| <b>Strategic Approach to International Chemicals management (UNEP)</b>                                                                                 |                                        |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |                                     |       |       | All            | All          |

Pt = Part, Ch = Chapter, Tbl = Table, Sec = Section, UN = United Nation, WHO = World Health Organization, IPCS = International Programme on Chemical Safety, IOMC = Inter-organization Programme for the Sound Management of Chemicals, ECSPHR = European Centre on Sustainable Policies for Human and Environmental Rights, FAO = Food and Agriculture Organization, OECD = Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development and UNEP = United Nations Environment Program

## Annex L Glossary of terms

Normative definitions for terms are given in FSC-STD-01-002 *FSC Glossary of Terms*. This glossary includes internationally accepted definitions whenever possible. These sources include, for instance, the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO), the Convention on Biological Diversity (1992), the Millennium Ecosystem Assessment (2005) as well as definitions from online glossaries as provided on the websites of the World Conservation Union (IUCN), the International Labour Organization (ILO) and the Invasive Alien Species Programme of the Convention on Biological Diversity. When other sources have been used they are referenced accordingly.

The term 'based on' means that a definition was adapted from an existing definition as provided in an international source.

Words used in the International Generic Indicators, if not defined in this Glossary of Terms or other normative FSC documents, are used as defined in the Shorter Oxford English Dictionary or the Concise Oxford Dictionary.

**Active ingredient:** Part of the product that provides the pesticidal action (Source: FAO International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management).

**Adaptive management:** A systematic process of continually improving management policies and practices by learning from the outcomes of existing measures (Source: Based on World Conservation Union (IUCN). Glossary definitions as provided on IUCN website).

**Affected Rights Holder:** Persons and groups, including *Indigenous Peoples\**, *traditional peoples\** and *local communities\** with legal or *customary rights\** whose *Free, Prior and Informed Consent\** is required to determine management decisions (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-1).

**Affected stakeholder:** Any person, group of persons or entity that is or is likely to be subject to the effects of the activities of a *Management Unit\**. Examples include, but are not restricted to (for example in the case of downstream landowners), persons, groups of persons or entities located in the neighborhood of the *Management Unit\**. The following are examples of affected stakeholders:

- Local communities\*
- Indigenous Peoples\*
- Workers\*
- Forest\* dwellers
- Neighbors
- Downstream landowners
- Local processors
- Local businesses
- Tenure\* and use rights\* holders, including landowners
- Organizations authorized or known to act on behalf of affected stakeholders\*, for example social and environmental NGOs, labor unions, etc. (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Affected Rights Holder:** Persons and groups, including *Indigenous Peoples\**, *traditional peoples\** and *local communities\** with legal or *customary rights\** whose *Free, Prior and Informed Consent\** is required to determine management decisions (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Alien species:** A species, subspecies or lower taxon, introduced outside its natural past or present distribution; includes any part, gametes, seeds, eggs, or propagules of such species that might survive and subsequently reproduce (Source: Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD), Invasive Alien Species Programme. Glossary of Terms as provided on CBD website).

**Applicable law:** Means applicable to The Organization as a legal person or business enterprise in or for the benefit of the Management Unit and those laws which affect the implementation of the FSC Principles and Criteria. This includes any combination of statutory law (Parliamentary-approved) and case law (court interpretations), subsidiary regulations, associated administrative procedures, and the national constitution (if present) which invariably takes legal precedence over all other legal instruments (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Best Available Information:** Data, facts, documents, expert opinions, and results of field surveys or consultations with stakeholders that are most credible, accurate, complete, and/or pertinent and that can be obtained through reasonable effort and cost, subject to the scale and intensity of the management activities and the Precautionary Approach.

**Binding Agreement:** A deal or pact, written or not, which is compulsory to its signatories and enforceable by law. Parties involved in the agreement do so freely and accept it voluntarily.

**Biological control agents:** Organisms used to eliminate or regulate the population of other organisms (Source: Based on FSC-STD-01-001 V4-0 and World Conservation Union (IUCN). Glossary definitions as provided on IUCN website).

**Biological diversity:** The variability among living organisms from all sources including, inter alia, terrestrial, marine and other aquatic ecosystems and the ecological complexes of which they are a part; this includes diversity within species, between species and of ecosystems (Source: Convention on Biological Diversity 1992, Article 2).

**Child:** any person under the age of 18 (ILO Convention 182, Article 2).

**Collective bargaining:** a voluntary negotiation process between employers or employers' organization and workers' organization, with a view to the regulation of terms and conditions of employment by means of collective agreements (ILO Convention 98, Article 4).

**Confidential information:** Private facts, data and content that, if made publicly available, might put at risk The Organization, its business interests or its relationships with stakeholders, clients and competitors.

**Connectivity:** A measure of how connected or spatially continuous a corridor, network, or matrix is. The fewer gaps, the higher the connectivity. Related to the structural connectivity concept; functional or behavioral connectivity refers to how connected an area is for a process, such as an animal moving through different types of landscape elements. Aquatic connectivity deals with the accessibility and transport of materials and organisms, through groundwater and surface water, between different patches of aquatic ecosystems of all kinds. (Source: Based on R.T.T. Forman. 1995. Land Mosaics. The Ecology of Landscapes and Regions. Cambridge University Press, 632pp).

**Conservation Areas Network:** Those portions of the Management Unit for which conservation is the primary and, in some circumstances, exclusive objective; such areas include representative sample areas, conservation zones, protection areas, connectivity areas and High Conservation Value Areas.

**Conservation/Protection:** These words are used interchangeably when referring to management activities designed to maintain the identified environmental or cultural values in existence long-term. Management activities may range from zero or minimal interventions to a specified range of appropriate interventions and activities designed to maintain, or compatible with maintaining, these identified values (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Conservation zones and protection areas:** Defined areas that are designated and managed primarily to safeguard species, habitats, ecosystems, natural features or other site-specific values because of their natural environmental or cultural values, or for purposes of monitoring, evaluation or research, not



necessarily excluding other management activities. For the purposes of the Principles and Criteria, these terms are used interchangeably, without implying that one always has a higher degree of conservation or protection than the other. The term 'protected area' is not used for these areas, because this term implies legal or official status, covered by national regulations in many countries. In the context of the Principles and Criteria, management of these areas should involve active conservation, not passive protection' (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Conversion Threshold:** The point at which degradation and/or clearing has occurred to an extent where recovery to natural forest conditions and/or High Conservation Value Areas is unlikely to be achieved without direct intervention (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

NOTE: Examples of direct intervention include but are not limited to removal of exotic species, physical protection of existing remnant native vegetation, re-wetting of drained soils, reintroduction of appropriate native species, and reintroduction of High Conservation Value species where suitable habitat remains or is re-established.

**Core area:** The portion of each Intact Forest Landscape designated to contain the most important cultural and ecological values. Core areas are managed to exclude industrial activity. Core Areas meet or exceed the definition of Intact Forest Landscape.

**Criterion** (pl. Criteria): A means of judging whether or not a Principle (of forest stewardship) has been fulfilled (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V4-0).

**Critical:** The concept of criticality or fundamentality in Principle 9 and HCVs relates to irreplaceability and to cases where loss or major damage to this HCV would cause serious prejudice or suffering to affected stakeholders. An ecosystem service is considered to be critical (HCV 4) where a disruption of that service is likely to cause, or poses a threat of, severe negative impacts on the welfare, health or survival of local communities, on the environment, on HCVs, or on the functioning of significant infrastructure (roads, dams, buildings etc.). The notion of criticality here refers to the importance and risk for natural resources and environmental and socio-economic values (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Critical population density:** Maximum acceptable number or density of individuals in a pest population, beyond which the pest threatens the achievement of management objectives. Assessment of the critical population density should take into account historical records from the affected area, the type of pest (insects, weeds, pathogens, etc.), and how the pest population is likely to change in relation to its density, including situations in which small populations show a positive relationship between population density and growth rate (the Allee effect). (Based on: International Code of Conduct on the Distribution and use of Pesticides 2006).

**Culturally appropriate** [mechanisms]: Means/approaches for outreach to target groups that are in harmony with the customs, values, sensitivities, and ways of life of the target audience.

**Customary law:** Interrelated sets of customary rights may be recognized as customary law. In some jurisdictions, customary law is equivalent to statutory law, within its defined area of competence and may replace the statutory law for defined ethnic or other social groups. In some jurisdictions customary law complements statutory law and is applied in specified circumstances (Source: Based on N.L. Peluso and P. Vandergeest. 2001. Genealogies of the political forest and customary rights in Indonesia, Malaysia and Thailand, Journal of Asian Studies 60(3):761–812).

**Customary rights:** Rights which result from a long series of habitual or customary actions, constantly repeated, which have, by such repetition and by uninterrupted acquiescence, acquired the force of a law within a geographical or sociological unit (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Degradation:** Changes within a natural forest or High Conservation Value area that significantly and negatively affect its species composition, structure and/or function, and reduces the ecosystem's

capacity to supply products, support biodiversity and/or deliver ecosystem services (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Direct involvement:** Situations in which the associated organization or individual is first-hand responsible for the unacceptable activities (Source: FSC-POL-01-004 V2-0).

**Discrimination:** includes- a) any distinction, exclusion or preference made on the basis of race, colour, sex, religion, political opinion, national extraction, social origin, sexual orientation, which has the effect of nullifying or impairing equality of opportunity or treatment in employment or occupation; b) such other distinction, exclusion or preference which has the effect of nullifying or impairing equality of opportunity or treatment in employment or occupation as may be determined by the Member concerned after consultation with representative employers' and workers' organization where such exist, and with other appropriate bodies (adapted from ILO Convention 111, Article1). 'Sexual orientation' was added to the definition provided in Convention 111, as it has been identified as an additional type of discrimination which may occur.

**Dispute:** for the purpose of the IGI, this is an expression of dissatisfaction by any person or organization presented as a complaint to The Organization, relating to its management activities or its conformity with the FSC Principles and Criteria, where a response is expected (Source: based on FSC-PRO-01-005 V3-0 Processing Appeals).

**Dispute of substantial duration:** Dispute that continues for more than twice as long as the predefined timelines in the FSC System (this is, for more than 6 months after receiving the complaint, based on FSC-STD-20-001).

**Dispute of substantial magnitude:** For the purpose of the International Generic Indicators, a dispute of substantial magnitude is a dispute that involves one or more of the following:

- Affects the legal or customary rights of Indigenous Peoples and local communities;
- Where the negative impact of management activities is of such a scale that it cannot be reversed or mitigated;
- Physical violence;
- Destruction of property;
- Presence of military bodies;
- Acts of intimidation against forest workers and stakeholders.

This list should be adapted or expanded by Standard Developers.

**Due consideration:** To give such weight or significance to a particular factor as under the circumstances it seems to merit, and this involves discretion (Black's Law Dictionary, 1979).

**Economic viability:** The capability of developing and surviving as a relatively independent social, economic or political unit. Economic viability may require but is not synonymous with profitability (Source: Based on the definition provided on the website of the European Environment Agency).

**Eco-regional:** Large unit of land or water containing a geographically distinct assemblage of species, natural communities, and environmental conditions (Source: WWF Global 200. [http://wwf.panda.org/about\\_our\\_earth/ecoregions/about/what\\_is\\_an\\_ecoregion/](http://wwf.panda.org/about_our_earth/ecoregions/about/what_is_an_ecoregion/)).

**Ecosystem:** A dynamic complex of plant, animal and micro-organism communities and their non-living environment interacting as a functional unit (Source: Convention on Biological Diversity 1992, Article 2).

**Ecosystem function:** An intrinsic ecosystem characteristic related to the set of conditions and processes whereby an ecosystem maintains its integrity (such as primary productivity, food chain, biogeochemical cycles). Ecosystem functions include such processes as decomposition, production,



nutrient cycling, and fluxes of nutrients and energy. For FSC purposes, this definition includes ecological and evolutionary processes such as gene flow and disturbance regimes, regeneration cycles and ecological seral development (succession) stages. (Source: Based on R. Hassan, R. Scholes and N. Ash. 2005. Ecosystems and Human Well-being: Synthesis. The Millennium Ecosystem Assessment Series. Island Press, Washington DC; and R.F. Noss. 1990. Indicators for monitoring biodiversity: a hierarchical approach. Conservation Biology 4(4):355–364).

**Ecosystem services:** The benefits people obtain from ecosystems. These include:

- provisioning services such as food, forest products and water;
- regulating services such as regulation of floods, drought, land degradation, air quality, climate and disease;
- supporting services such as soil formation and nutrient cycling; and
- cultural services and cultural values such as recreational, spiritual, religious and other non-material benefits.

(Source: Based on R. Hassan, R. Scholes and N. Ash. 2005. Ecosystems and Human Well-being: Synthesis. The Millennium Ecosystem Assessment Series. Island Press, Washington DC).

**Emergency:** A situation that requires immediate action to control the sudden invasion or infestation of a pest, which threatens either long-term stability of the ecosystem, human well-being or economic viability.

Events that happen cyclically and scenarios which are predicted through planning, monitoring or the application of an integrated pest management system cannot be considered an emergency.

For the purpose of the FSC Pesticides Policy, emergency situations require immediate action and cannot feasibly be controlled by a less hazardous alternative. (Source: FSC-POL-30-001 V3-0).

**Employment and Occupation:** includes access to vocational training, access to employment and to particular occupations, and terms and conditions of employment (ILO Convention 111, Article 1.3).

**Engaging / engagement:** The process by which The Organization communicates, consults and/or provides for the participation of interested and/or affected stakeholders ensuring that their concerns, desires, expectations, needs, rights and opportunities are considered in the establishment, implementation and updating of the management plan (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Environmental biomonitoring:** Act of observing and assessing the state and ongoing changes in ecosystems, components of biodiversity and landscape, including the types of natural habitats, populations and species. (Source: Encyclopaedia of Toxicology (Third Edition, 2014)).

**Environmental harm:** Any impact on the environment values as a result of human activity that has the effect of degrading the environment, whether temporarily or permanently (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA):** Systematic process used to identify potential environmental and social impacts of proposed projects, to evaluate alternative approaches, and to design and incorporate appropriate prevention, mitigation, management and monitoring measures (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on Environmental impact assessment, guidelines for FAO field projects. Food and agriculture organization of the United Nations (FAO). Rome).

**Environmental values:** The following set of elements of the biophysical and human environment:

- ecosystem functions (including carbon sequestration and storage);
- biological diversity;
- water resources;

- soils;
- atmosphere;
- landscape values (including cultural and spiritual values).

The actual worth attributed to these elements depends on human and societal perceptions (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Equal remuneration for men and women workers for work of equal value:** refers to rates of remuneration established without discrimination based on sex (ILO Convention 100, Article 1b).

**Equivalent:** For ecological equivalence, the same specific type of natural forest or High Conservation Value is restored or conserved as was destroyed.

For social remedy, equivalence shall be based on an independent assessment and agreement on remedy through Free, Prior, Informed Consent (FPIC) with the affected rights holders of the nature, quality, and quantity of all social harms as well as the on-going future benefits these would have provided. Equivalence shall entail provision of the best means possible to ensure future community wellbeing. (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0)

**Exclusion zone:** Area in which chemical pesticides are used, and which people are prevented from entering during and after pesticide application in order to avoid unacceptable risk of exposure. The exclusion zone remains in force until the risk of exposure has reduced to an acceptable level (the period of re-entry).

**Externalities:** The positive and negative impacts of activities on stakeholders that are not directly involved in those activities, or on a natural resource or the environment, which do not usually enter standard cost accounting systems, such that the market prices of the products of those activities do not reflect the full costs or benefits (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Fair compensation:** Remuneration that is proportionate to the magnitude and type of services rendered by another party or of the harm that is attributable to the first party (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Fertilizer:** Mineral or organic substances, most commonly N, P<sub>2</sub>O<sub>5</sub> and K<sub>2</sub>O, which are applied to soil for the purpose of enhancing plant growth (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Fibre Testing:** a suite of wood identification technologies used to identify the family, genus, species and origin of solid wood and fibre based products (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Forced or compulsory labour:** work or service exacted from any person under the menace of any penalty and for which the said person has not offered himself/ herself voluntarily (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Convention 29, Article 2.1).

**Forest:** A tract of land dominated by trees (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-0, derived from FSC Guidelines for Certification Bodies, Scope of Forest Certification, Section 2.1 first published in 1998, and revised as FSC-GUI-20-200 in 2005, and revised again in 2010 as FSC-DIR-20-007 FSC Directive on Forest Management Evaluations, ADVISE-20-007-01).

**Formal and informal workers organization:** association or union of *workers\**, whether recognized by law or by *The Organization\** or neither, which have the aim of promoting *workers\** rights and to represent *workers\** in dealings with *The Organization\** particularly regarding working conditions and compensation (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Fragmentation:** The process of dividing *habitat*\*s into smaller patches, which results in the loss of original *habitat*\*, loss in *connectivity*\*, reduction in patch size, and increasing isolation of patches. *Fragmentation*\* is considered to be one of the single most important factors leading to loss of native species, especially in forested *landscapes*\*, and one of the primary causes of the present extinction crisis. In reference to *Intact Forest Landscapes*\*, the *fragmentation*\* of concern is understood to be that caused by human industrial activities. (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, adapted from Gerald E. Heilman, Jr. James R. Strittholt Nicholas C. Slosser Dominick A. Dellasala, BioScience (2002) 52 (5): 411-422.)

**Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC):** A *legal*\* condition whereby a person or community can be said to have given consent to an action prior to its commencement, based upon a clear appreciation and understanding of the facts, implications and future consequences of that action, and the possession of all relevant facts at the time when consent is given. *Free, prior and Informed Consent*\* includes the right to grant, modify, withhold or withdraw approval (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on the Preliminary working paper on the principle of Free, Prior and Informed Consent of Indigenous Peoples (...) (E/CN.4/Sub.2/AC.4/2004/4 8 July 2004) of the 22<sup>nd</sup> Session of the United Nations Commission on Human Rights, Sub-commission on the Promotion and Protection of Human Rights, Working Group on Indigenous Populations, 19–23 July 2004).

**FSC Transaction:** Purchase or sale of products with FSC claims on sales documents (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Gender equality:** Gender equality or gender equity means that women and men have equal conditions for realizing their full human rights and for contributing to, and benefiting from, economic, social, cultural and political development (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, adapted from FAO, IFAD and ILO workshop on 'Gaps, trends and current research in gender dimensions of agricultural and rural employment: differentiated pathways out of poverty', Rome, 31 March to 2 April 2009.).

**Genetically modified organism:** An organism in which the genetic material has been altered in a way that does not occur naturally by mating and/or natural recombination. (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on FSC-POL-30-602 FSC Interpretation on GMO (Genetically Modified Organisms)).

**Genotype:** The genetic constitution of an organism (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Good faith:** A process of engagement where the parties make every effort to reach an agreement, conduct genuine and constructive negotiations, avoid delays in negotiations, respect agreements concluded and under development, and give sufficient time to discuss and settle *disputes*\* (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, adapted from Motion 40:2017).

**Habitat:** The place or type of site where an organism or population occurs (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD), Article 2).

**Habitat features:** *Forest*\* stand attributes and structures, including but not limited to:

- Old commercial and non-commercial trees whose age noticeably exceeds the average age of the main canopy;
- Trees with special ecological value;
- Vertical and horizontal complexity;
- Standing dead trees;
- Dead fallen wood;
- Forest openings attributable to natural disturbances;
- Nesting sites;

- Small *wetlands\**, bogs, fens;
- Ponds;
- Areas for procreation;
- Areas for feeding and shelter, including seasonal cycles of breeding;
- Areas for migration;
- Areas for hibernation (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Hazardous work (in the context of child labour):** any work which is likely to jeopardize children's physical, mental or moral health, should not be undertaken by anyone under the age of 18 years. Hazardous *child\** labour is work in dangerous, or unhealthy conditions that could result in a *child\** being killed or injured/maimed (often permanently) and/or made ill (often permanently) as a consequence of poor safety and health standards and working arrangements. In determining the type of hazard *child\** labour referred to under (Article 3(d) of the Convention No 182, and in identifying where they exist, consideration should be given, inter alia, to

- Work which exposes children to physical, psychological or sexual abuse;
- Work underground, under water at dangerous heights or in confined spaces;
- Work with dangerous machinery, equipment and tools, or which involves the manual handling or transport of heavy loads;
- Work in unhealthy environment which may, for examples, expose children to hazardous substances, agents or processes, or to temperatures, noise levels, or vibrations damaging to their health;
- Work under particularly difficult conditions such as work for long hours or during the night or work where the *child\** is unreasonably confined to the premises of the employer (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Labour Organization (ILO), 2011: IPEC Mainstreaming Child labour concerns in education sector plans and Programmes, Geneva, 2011& ILO Handbook on Hazardous child labour, 2011).

**Heavy work (in the context of child labour):** refers to work that is likely to be harmful or dangerous to children's health (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on FSC report on generic criteria and indicators based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Core Conventions principles, 2017).

**High Conservation Value (HCV):** Any of the following values:

- **HCV1:** Species Diversity. Concentrations of *biological diversity\** including endemic species, and rare, *threatened or endangered\** species, that are *significant\** at global, regional or national levels.
- **HCV 2:** Landscape-level *ecosystems\** and mosaics. *Intact Forest Landscapes\**, large landscape-level *ecosystems\** and *ecosystem\** mosaics that are *significant\** at global, regional or national levels, and that contain viable populations of the great majority of the naturally occurring species in natural patterns of distribution and abundance.
- **HCV 3:** *Ecosystems\** and *habitats\**. Rare, threatened, or endangered *ecosystems\**, *habitats\** or *refugia\**.
- **HCV 4:** Critical *ecosystem services\**. Basic *ecosystem services\** in critical situations, including *protection\** of water catchments and control of erosion of vulnerable soils and slopes.
- **HCV 5:** Community needs. Sites and resources fundamental for satisfying the basic necessities of local communities or *Indigenous Peoples\** (for example for livelihoods, health, nutrition, water), identified through engagement with these communities or *Indigenous Peoples\**.
- **HCV 6:** Cultural values. Sites, resources, habitats and *landscapes\** of global or national cultural, archaeological or historical significance, and/or of critical cultural, *ecological\**, economic or religious/sacred importance for the traditional cultures of *local communities\** or *Indigenous Peoples\**, identified through engagement with these *local communities\** or *Indigenous Peoples\** (Source: based on FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**High Conservation Value Areas:** Zones and physical spaces which possess and/or are needed for the existence and maintenance of identified *High Conservation Values*\* (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**High grading:** High grading is a tree removal practice in which only the best quality, most valuable timber trees are removed, often without regenerating new tree seedlings or removing the remaining poor quality and suppressed understory trees and, in doing so, degrading the ecological health and commercial value of the forest. High grading stands as a counterpoint to sustainable resource management (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Glossary of Forest Management Terms. North Carolina Division of Forest Resources. March 2009).

**Highly Hazardous Pesticide (HHP):** chemical pesticides that are acknowledged to present particularly high levels of acute or chronic hazards to health and environment according to internationally accepted classification systems or are listed in relevant binding international agreements or conventions, or contain dioxins, or heavy metals. In addition, pesticides that appear to cause severe or irreversible harm to health or the environment under conditions of use in a country may be considered to be and treated as highly hazardous.

FSC distinguishes between FSC prohibited HHPs, FSC highly restricted HHPs and FSC restricted HHPs:

- **FSC prohibited HHPs:** chemical pesticides that: a) are listed or recommended for listing under Annex A (elimination) of the Stockholm Convention on Persistent Organic Pollutants or Annex III of the Rotterdam Convention on the Prior Informed Consent Procedure or listed under the Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer, or b) are acutely toxic and that can induce cancer (carcinogenic and likely to be carcinogenic), or c) contain dioxins or d) contain heavy metals).
- **FSC highly restricted HHPs:** chemical pesticide presenting two or three out of the following hazards: acute toxicity, chronic toxicity and environmental toxicity.
- **FSC restricted HHPs:** chemical pesticide presenting one out of three of the following hazards: acute toxicity, chronic toxicity and environmental toxicity.

(Source: FSC-POL-30-001 V3-0).

**ILO Core (Fundamental) Conventions:** these are labour standards that cover fundamental principles and rights at work: freedom of association and the effective recognition of the right to *collective bargaining*\*; the elimination of all forms of *forced or compulsory labour*\*; the effective abolition of *child*\* labour; and the elimination of *discrimination*\* in respect of *employment and occupation*\*. The eight Fundamental Conventions are:

- Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organise Convention, 1948 (No. 87)
- Right to Organise and Collective Bargaining Convention, 1949 (No. 98)
- Forced Labour Convention, 1930 (No. 29)
- Abolition of Forced Labour Convention, 1957 (No. 105)
- Minimum Age Convention, 1973 (No. 138)
- Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention, 1999 (No. 182)
- Equal Remuneration Convention, 1951 (No. 100)
- *Discrimination*\* (Employment and Occupation) Convention, 1958 (No. 111) (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on FSC report on generic criteria and indicators based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Core Conventions principles, 2017).

**ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work and its Followup, adopted by the International Labour conference at its Eighty-sixth Session, Geneva, 18th June 1998 (Annex revised 15 June 2010):** is a resolute reaffirmation of ILO principles (art 2) which declares that all



Members, even if they have not ratified the Conventions in question, have an obligation, arising from the very fact of membership in the organization, to respect, to promote and to realize, in *good faith*\* and in accordance with the Constitution, the principles concerning the fundamental rights which are the subject of those Conventions, namely:

- Freedom of association and the effective recognition of the right to *collective bargaining*\*;
- The elimination of all forms of *forced or compulsory labour*\*;
- The effective abolition of *child*\* labour; and
- The elimination of *discrimination*\* in respect of *employment and occupation*\* (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on FSC report on generic criteria and indicators based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Core Conventions principles, 2017).

**Indicator:** A quantitative or qualitative variable which can be measured or described, and which provides a means of judging whether a *Management Unit*\* complies with the requirements of an *FSC Criterion*\*. *Indicators*\* and the associated thresholds thereby define the requirements for responsible *forest*\* management at the level of the *Management Unit*\* and are the primary basis of forest evaluation (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Indigenous cultural landscapes:** *Indigenous cultural landscapes*\* are living landscapes to which *Indigenous Peoples*\* attribute environmental, social, cultural and economic value because of their enduring relationship with the land, water, fauna, flora and spirits and their present and future importance to their cultural identity. An *Indigenous cultural landscape*\* is characterized by features that have been maintained through *long-term*\* interactions based on land-care knowledge, and adaptive livelihood practices. They are landscapes over which *Indigenous Peoples*\* exercise responsibility for stewardship (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Indigenous Peoples:** People and groups of people that can be identified or characterized as follows:

- The key characteristic or *Criterion*\* is self-identification as *Indigenous Peoples*\* at the individual level and acceptance by the community as their member;
- Historical continuity with pre-colonial and/or pre-settler societies;
- Strong link to territories and surrounding natural resources;
- Distinct social, economic or political systems;
- Distinct language, culture and beliefs;
- Form non-dominant groups of society;
- Resolve to maintain and reproduce their ancestral environments and systems as distinctive peoples and communities (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, adapted from United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous, Factsheet 'Who are Indigenous Peoples' October 2007; United Nations Development Group, 'Guidelines on Indigenous Peoples' Issues' United Nations 2009, United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples, 13 September 2007).

**Indirect involvement:** Situations in which the associated organization or individual, with a minimum ownership or voting power of 51%, is involved as a parent or sister company, subsidiary, shareholder or Board of Directors to an organization directly involved in unacceptable activities. Indirect involvement also includes activities performed by subcontractors when acting on behalf of the associated organization or individual (Source: FSC-POL-01-004 V2-0).

**Industrial activity:** Industrial forest and resource management activities such as road building, mining, dams, urban development and timber harvesting (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Infrastructure:** In the context of *forest\** management, roads, bridges, culverts, log landings, quarries, impoundments, buildings and other structures required in the course of implementing the *management plan\** (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Intact Forest Landscape:** a territory within today's global extent of *forest\** cover which contains forest and non-forest ecosystems minimally influenced by human economic activity, with an area of at least 500 km<sup>2</sup> (50,000 ha) and a minimal width of 10 km (measured as the diameter of a circle that is entirely inscribed within the boundaries of the territory) (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Intact Forests / Global Forest Watch. Glossary definition as provided on Intact Forest website. 2006-2014).

**Integrated pest management (IPM):** Careful consideration of all available pest control techniques and subsequent integration of appropriate measures that discourage the development of pest populations, encourage beneficial populations and keep pesticides and other interventions to levels that are economically justified and reduce or minimize risks to human and animal health and/or the environment. IPM emphasizes the growth of a healthy forest with the least possible disruption to ecosystems and encourages natural pest control mechanisms (Source: Based on *FAO International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management*).

**Intellectual property:** Practices as well as knowledge, innovations and other creations of the mind (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD), Article 8(j); and World Intellectual Property Organization. What is Intellectual Property? WIPO Publication No. 450(E)).

**Intensity:** A measure of the force, severity or strength of a management activity or other occurrence affecting the nature of the activity's impacts (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Intervention threshold:** Population density level where the controlling measures of the targeted pest should start. It is determined in the IPM system and it is usually lower than the critical population density level.

**Interested stakeholder:** Any person, group of persons, or entity that has shown an interest, or is known to have an interest, in the activities of a *Management Unit\**. The following are examples of interested stakeholders.

- *Conservation\** organizations, for example environmental NGOs;
- Labor (rights) organizations, for example labor unions;
- Human rights organizations, for example social NGOs;
- Local development projects;
- Local governments;
- National government departments functioning in the region;
- FSC National Offices;
- Experts on particular issues, for example *High Conservation Values\** (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Internationally accepted scientific protocol:** A predefined science-based procedure which is either published by an international scientific network or union, or referenced frequently in the international scientific literature (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Invasive species:** Species that are rapidly expanding outside of their native range. Invasive species can alter ecological relationships among native species and can affect ecosystem function and human health (Source: Based on World Conservation Union (IUCN). Glossary definitions as provided on IUCN website).

**Lands and territories:** For the purposes of the Principles and Criteria these are lands or territories that *Indigenous Peoples\** or *local communities\** have traditionally owned, or customarily used or occupied, and where access to natural resources is vital to the sustainability of their cultures and livelihoods (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on World Bank safeguard OP 4.10 *Indigenous Peoples\**, section 16 (a). July 2005.).

**Landscape:** A geographical mosaic composed of interacting *ecosystems\** resulting from the influence of geological, topographical, soil, climatic, biotic and human interactions in a given area (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). Glossary definitions as provided on IUCN website).

**Landscape values:** Landscape values can be visualized as layers of human perceptions overlaid on the physical *landscape\**. Some landscape values, like economic, recreation, subsistence value or visual quality are closely related to physical *landscape\** attributes. Other *landscape\** values such as intrinsic or spiritual value are more symbolic in character and are influenced more by individual perception or social construction than physical *landscape\** attributes (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on website of the Landscape Value Institute).

**Legal:** In accordance with primary legislation (national or local laws) or secondary legislation (subsidiary regulations, decrees, orders, etc.). 'Legal' also includes rule-based decisions made by legally competent agencies where such decisions flow directly and logically from the laws and regulations. Decisions made by legally competent agencies may not be legal if they do not flow directly and logically from the laws and regulations and if they are not rule-based but use administrative discretion (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Legally competent:** Mandated in law to perform a certain function (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Legal registration:** National or local *legal\** license or set of permissions to operate as an enterprise, with rights to buy and sell products and/or services commercially. The license or permissions can apply to an individual, a privately-owned enterprise or a publicly-owned corporate entity. The rights to buy and sell products and/or services do not carry the obligation to do so, so *legal\** registration applies also to Organizations operating a *Management Unit\** without sales of products or services; for example, for unpriced recreation or for conservation of biodiversity or habitat (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Light work:** *national laws\** or regulations may permit the employment or work of persons 13 to 15 years of age on light work which is- a) not likely to be harmful to their health or development; and b) not such as to prejudice their attendance at school, their participation in vocational orientation or training programmes approved by the competent authority or their capacity to benefit from the instruction received (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Convention 138, Article 7).

**Living wage:** The level of wages sufficient to meet the basic living needs of an average-sized family in a particular economy (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Labour Organization (ILO). Bureau of Library and Information Services. ILO Thesaurus as provided on ILO website).

**Local communities:** Communities of any size that are in or adjacent to the *Management Unit\**, and also those that are close enough to have a *significant\** impact on the economy or the environmental values of the *Management Unit\** or to have their economies, rights or environments *significantly\** affected by the management activities or the biophysical aspects of the *Management Unit\** (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).



**Local laws:** The whole suite of primary and secondary laws (acts, ordinances, statutes, decrees) which is limited in application to a particular geographic district within a national territory, as well as secondary regulations, and tertiary administrative procedures (rules / requirements) that derive their authority directly and explicitly from these primary and secondary laws. Laws derive authority ultimately from the Westphalian concept of sovereignty of the Nation State (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Long-term:** The time-scale of the forest owner or manager as manifested by the objectives of the *management plan*\*, the rate of harvesting, and the commitment to maintain permanent forest cover. The length of time involved will vary according to the context and ecological conditions, and will be a function of how long it takes a given *ecosystem*\* to recover its natural structure and composition following harvesting or disturbance, or to produce mature or primary conditions (Source: FSC-STD-01-002 V1-0).

**Management objective:** Specific management goals, practices, outcomes, and approaches established to achieve the requirements of this standard (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Management plan:** The collection of documents, reports, records and maps that describe, justify and regulate the activities carried out by any manager, staff or organization within or in relation to the *Management Unit*\*, including statements of objectives and policies (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Management Unit:** A spatial area or areas submitted for FSC certification with clearly defined boundaries managed to a set of explicit *long-term*\* management objectives which are expressed in a *management plan*\*. This area or areas include(s):

- all facilities and area(s) within or adjacent to this spatial area or areas under *legal*\* title or management control of, or operated by or on behalf of *The Organization*\*, for the purpose of contributing to the management objectives; and
- all facilities and area(s) outside, and not adjacent to this spatial area or areas and operated by or on behalf of *The Organization*\*, solely for the purpose of contributing to the management objectives (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Medical Biomonitoring:** Analysis of a chemical pesticide or one of its metabolites in the human body, using samples of substances such as blood, urine or breastmilk (Source: Based on FAO and WHO (2016). International Code of Conduct on Pesticide Management: Guidelines on Highly Hazardous Pesticides. FAO & WHO, Rome).

**Minimum age (of employment):** is not less than the age of finishing compulsory education, and which in any case, should not be less than 15 years. However, a country, whose economy and educational facilities are insufficiently developed, may initially specify a minimum age of 14 years. National laws may also permit the employment of 13-15 year olds in light work which is neither prejudicial to school attendance, nor harmful to a child's health or development. The ages 12-13 can apply for light work in countries that specify a minimum age of 14 (ILO Convention 138, Article 2).

**National laws:** The whole suite of primary and secondary laws (acts, ordinances, statutes, decrees), which is applicable to a national territory, as well as secondary regulations, and tertiary administrative procedures (rules / requirements) that derive their authority directly and explicitly from these primary and secondary laws (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Native species:** Species, subspecies, or lower taxon, occurring within its natural range (past or present) and dispersal potential (that is, within the range it occupies naturally or could occupy without direct or indirect introduction or care by humans) (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on Convention on

Biological Diversity (CBD). Invasive Alien Species Programme. Glossary of Terms as provided on CBD website).

**Natural conditions/native ecosystem:** For the purposes of the Principles and Criteria and any applications of *restoration\** techniques, terms such as 'more *natural conditions\**', '*native ecosystem\**' provide for managing sites to favor or *restore\** *native species\** and associations of *native species\** that are typical of the locality, and for managing these associations and other *environmental values\** so that they form *ecosystems\** typical of the locality. Further guidelines may be provided in FSC Forest Stewardship Standards (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Natural forest:** A *forest\** area with many of the principal characteristics and key elements of native ecosystems, such as complexity, structure and biological diversity, including soil characteristics, flora and fauna, in which all or almost all the trees are native species, not classified as plantations.

'*Natural forest\**' includes the following categories:

- *Forest\** affected by harvesting or other disturbances, in which trees are being or have been regenerated by a combination of natural and artificial regeneration with species typical of *natural forests\** in that site, and where many of the above-ground and below-ground characteristics of the natural forest are still present. In boreal and north temperate *forests\** which are naturally composed of only one or few tree species, a combination of natural and artificial regeneration to regenerate *forest\** of the same *native species\**, with most of the principal characteristics and key elements of *native ecosystems\** of that site, is not by itself considered as conversion to plantations;
- *Natural forests\** which are maintained by traditional *silvicultural\** practices including natural or assisted natural regeneration;
- Well-developed secondary or colonizing *forest\** of *native species\** which has regenerated in non-*forest\** areas;
- The definition of '*natural forest\**' may include areas described as wooded *ecosystems\**, woodland and savannah.

The description of *natural forests\** and their principal characteristics and key elements may be further defined in FSC Forest Stewardship Standards, with appropriate descriptions or examples.

'*Natural forest\**' does not include land which is not dominated by trees, was previously not forest, and which does not yet contain many of the characteristics and elements of *native ecosystems\**. Young regeneration may be considered as *natural forest\** after some years of ecological progression. FSC Forest Stewardship Standards may indicate when such areas may be excised from the *Management Unit\**, should be *restored\** towards more *natural conditions\**, or may be converted to other land uses.

FSC has not developed quantitative thresholds between different categories of *forests\** in terms of area, density, height, etc. FSC Forest Stewardship Standards may provide such thresholds and other guidelines, with appropriate descriptions or examples. Pending such guidance, areas dominated by trees, mainly of *native species\**, may be considered as *natural forest\**.

Thresholds and guidelines may cover areas such as:

- Other vegetation types and non-*forest\** communities and *ecosystems\** included in the *Management Unit\**, including grassland, bushland, *wetlands\**, and open woodlands;
- Very young pioneer or colonizing regeneration in a primary succession on new open sites or abandoned farmland, which does not yet contain many of the principal characteristics and key elements of *native ecosystems\**. This may be considered as *natural forest\** through ecological progression after the passage of years;

- Young natural regeneration growing in *natural forest\** areas may be considered as *natural forest\**, even after logging, clear-felling or other disturbances, since many of the principal characteristics and key elements of *native ecosystems\** remain, above-ground and below-ground;
- Areas where deforestation and *forest\** degradation have been so severe that they are no longer 'dominated by trees' may be considered as non-*forest\**, when they have very few of the principal above-ground and below-ground characteristics and key elements of *natural forests\**. Such extreme degradation is typically the result of combinations of repeated and excessively heavy logging, grazing, farming, fuelwood collection, hunting, fire, erosion, mining, settlements, *infrastructure\**, etc. FSC Forest Stewardship Standards may help to decide when such areas should be excised from the *Management Unit\**, should be restored towards more *natural conditions\**, or may be converted to other land uses (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Natural Hazards:** disturbances that can present *risks\** to social and *environmental values\** in the *Management Unit\** but that may also comprise important *ecosystem functions\**; examples include drought, flood, fire, landslide, storm, avalanche, etc (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

Non-forest land-use:

**Non-timber forest products (NTFP):** All products other than timber derived from the *Management Unit\** (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Objective:** The basic purpose laid down by *The Organization\** for the *forest\** enterprise, including the decision of policy and the choice of means for attaining the purpose (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on F.C. Osmaston. 1968. The Management of Forests. Hafner, New York; and D.R. Johnston, A.J. Grayson and R.T. Bradley. 1967. Forest Planning. Faber & Faber, London).

**Obligatory code of practice:** A manual or handbook or other source of technical instruction which *The Organization\** must implement by law (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Occupational accident:** An occurrence arising out of, or in the course of, work which results in fatal or non-fatal injury (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on International Labour Organization (ILO). Bureau of Library and Information Services. ILO Thesaurus as provided on ILO website).

**Occupational disease:** Any disease contracted as a result of an exposure to *risk\** factors arising from work activity (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on International Labour Organization (ILO). Bureau of Library and Information Services. ILO Thesaurus as provided on ILO website).

**Occupational injuries:** Any personal injury, disease or death resulting from an occupational accident (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on International Labour Organization (ILO). Bureau of Library and Information Services. ILO Thesaurus as provided on ILO website).

**Organism:** Any biological entity capable of replication or of transferring genetic material (Source: Council Directive 90/220/EEC).

**The Organization:** The person or entity holding or applying for certification and therefore responsible for demonstrating compliance with the requirements upon which FSC certification is based (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Peatland:** Is constituted by flooded and soggy areas, with large accumulations of organic material, covered by a layer of poor vegetation associated with a certain degree of acidity, and which presents a characteristic amber color (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Aguilar, L. 2001. About Fishermen, Fisherwomen, Oceans and tides. IUCN. San Jose (Costa Rica)).

**Pest:** Any species, strain or biotype of plant, animal or pathogenic agent injurious to plants and plant products, materials or environments and includes vectors of parasites or pathogens of human and animal disease and animals causing public health nuisance (Source: FSC-POL-30-001 V3-0).

**Pesticide:** Any substance or preparation prepared or used in protecting plants or wood or other plant products from pests; in controlling pests; or in rendering such pests harmless. This definition includes insecticides, rodenticides, acaricides, molluscicides, larvaecides, fungicides and herbicides (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Pesticide Buffer zone:** Area established around environmental and/or social values to protect them from damage, within which pesticides are not used or are used only with additional risk mitigation measures.

**Plantation:** A *forest\** area established by planting or sowing with using either alien or *native species\**, often with one or few species, regular spacing and even ages, and which lacks most of the principal characteristics and key elements of *natural forests\**. The description of plantations may be further defined in FSC Forest Stewardship Standards, with appropriate descriptions or examples, such as:

- Areas which would initially have complied with this definition of 'plantation' but which, after the passage of years, contain many or most of the principal characteristics and key elements of *native ecosystems\**, may be classified as *natural forests\**.
- Plantations managed to *restore\** and enhance biological and *habitat\** diversity, structural complexity and *ecosystem functionality\** may, after the passage of years, be classified as natural forests.
- Boreal and north temperate *forests\** which are naturally composed of only one or few tree species, in which a combination of natural and artificial regeneration is used to regenerate *forest\** of the same *native species\**, with most of the principal characteristics and key elements of *native ecosystems\** of that site, may be considered as *natural forest\**, and this regeneration is not by itself considered as conversion to *plantations\** (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Precautionary approach:** An approach requiring that when the available information indicates that management activities pose a threat of severe or irreversible damage to the environment or a threat to human welfare, *The Organization\** will take explicit and effective measures to prevent the damage and avoid the *risks\** to welfare, even when the scientific information is incomplete or inconclusive, and when the vulnerability and sensitivity of *environmental values\** are uncertain (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on Principle 15 of Rio Declaration on Environment and Development, 1992, and Wingspread Statement on the Precautionary Principle of the Wingspread Conference, 23–25 January 1998).

**Pre-harvest [condition]:** The diversity, composition, and structure of the *forest\** or plantation prior to felling timber and appurtenant activities such as road building (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Principle:** An essential rule or element; in FSC's case, of forest stewardship (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Priority social harms:** see the definition for social harm (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Protection:** See definition of *Conservation\** (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Protection Area:** See definition of Conservation Zone (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Proportionate:** A 1:1 ratio: The area to be restored or conserved is the same as the area of natural forest and/or High Conservation Value destroyed (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Publicly available:** In a manner accessible to or observable by people generally (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Collins English Dictionary, 2003 Edition).

**Rare species:** Species that are uncommon or scarce, but not classified as threatened. These species are located in geographically restricted areas or specific *habitats*\*, or are scantily scattered on a large scale. They are approximately equivalent to the IUCN (2001) category of Near Threatened (NT), including species that are close to qualifying for, or are likely to qualify for, a threatened category in the near future. They are also approximately equivalent to imperiled species (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). 2001. IUCN Red List Categories and Criteria: Version 3.1. IUCN Species Survival Commission. IUCN. Gland, Switzerland and Cambridge, UK).

**Ratified:** The process by which an international law, convention or agreement (including multilateral environmental agreement) is legally approved by a national legislature or equivalent *legal*\* mechanism, such that the international law, convention or agreement becomes automatically part of national law or sets in motion the development of national law to give the same *legal*\* effect (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Reasonable:** Judged to be fair or appropriate to the circumstances or purposes, based on general experience (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Shorter Oxford English Dictionary).

**Refugia:** An isolated area where extensive changes, typically due to changing climate or by disturbances such as those caused by humans, have not occurred and where plants and animals typical of a region may survive (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Glen Canyon Dam, Adaptive Management Program Glossary as provided on website of Glen Canyon Dam website).

**Remedy:** To correct or return something as near as possible to its original state or condition (Source: Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights. UN. 2011).

- For environmental harms this includes actions taken to remedy deforestation, conversion degradation, or other harms to natural forest and High Conservation Value areas. Environmental remedy actions may include but are not limited to: conservation of standing forests, habitats, ecosystems and species; restoration and protection of degraded ecosystems.
- For social harms this includes providing redress for identified social harms through agreements made during an FPIC-based process with the affected rights holders, and facilitating a transition to the position before such harms occurred; or developing alternative measures to ameliorate harms by providing gains recognized by the affected stakeholders as equivalent to the harms, through consultation and agreement. Remedy may be achieved through a combination of apologies, restitution, rehabilitation, financial or non-financial compensation, satisfaction, punitive sanctions, injunctions, and guarantees of non-repetition (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Repair:** Process of assisting the recovery of environmental values and human health (Source: FSC-POL-30-001).

**Representative Sample Areas:** Portions of the Management Unit delineated for the purpose of conserving or restoring viable examples of an ecosystem that would naturally occur in that geographical region.

**Resilience:** The ability of a system to maintain key functions and processes in the face of stresses or pressures by either resisting or adapting to change. Resilience can be applied to both ecological systems and social systems (Source: IUCN World Commission on Protected Areas (IUCN-WCPA). 2008. Establishing Marine Protected Area Networks – Making it Happen. Washington D.C.: IUCN-WCPA National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration and The Nature Conservancy.).



**Restitution:** Measures agreed with affected stakeholders to restore lands, properties or damaged natural resources to their original owners in their original condition. Where such lands, properties or natural resources cannot be returned or restored, measures are agreed on to provide alternatives of equivalent quality and extent. Restitution to affected rights holders is agreed on through an FPIC-based process (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Restoration /Ecological Restoration:** Process of assisting the recovery of an ecosystem, and its associated conservation values, that have been degraded, damaged, or destroyed (Source: adapted from 'International principles and standards for the practice of ecological restoration'. Gann et al 2019. Second edition. Society for Ecological Restoration) (shortened version – refer to the FSC Remedy Framework for full definition).

Note: The Organization is not necessarily obliged to restore those environmental values that have been affected by factors beyond the control of The Organization, for example by natural disasters, by climate change, or by the legally authorized activities of third parties, such as public infrastructure, mining, hunting or settlement. FSC-POL-20-003 The Excision of Areas from the Scope of Certification describes the processes by which such areas may be excised from the area certified, when appropriate.

The Organization is also not obliged to restore environmental values that may have existed at some time in the historic or pre-historic past, or that have been negatively affected by previous owners or organizations – with the exception of those values negatively affected through instances of conversion and whose restoration form part of a Remedy Plan which The Organization is required to follow. In all instances, however, The Organization is expected to take reasonable measures to mitigate, control and prevent environmental degradation which is continuing in the Management Unit as a result of such previous impacts.

**Riparian zone:** Interface between land and a *water body*\*, and the vegetation associated with it (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Risk:** The probability of an unacceptable negative impact arising from any activity in the *Management Unit*\* combined with its seriousness in terms of consequences (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Scale:** A measure of the extent to which a management activity or event affects an *environmental value*\* or a *Management Unit*\*, in time or space. An activity with a small or low spatial scale affects only a small proportion of the *forest*\* each year, an activity with a small or low temporal scale occurs only at long intervals (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Scale, intensity and risk:** See individual definitions of the terms 'scale', 'intensity', and 'risk' (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Significant:** For the purposes of Principle 9, HCVs 1, 2 and 6 there are three main forms of recognizing significance.

- A designation, classification or recognized *conservation*\* status, assigned by an international agency such as IUCN or Birdlife International;
- A designation by national or regional authorities, or by a responsible national *conservation*\* organization, on the basis of its concentration of biodiversity;
- A voluntary recognition by the manager, owner or *The Organization*\*, on the basis of available information, or of the known or suspected presence of a significant biodiversity concentration, even when not officially designated by other agencies.

Any one of these forms will justify designation as HCVs 1, 2 and 6. Many regions of the world have received recognition for their biodiversity importance, measured in many different ways. Existing maps and

classifications of priority areas for biodiversity *conservation*\* play an essential role in identifying the potential presence of HCVs 1, 2 and 6 (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Silviculture:** The art and science of controlling the establishment, growth, composition, health and quality of *forests*\* and woodlands to meet the targeted diverse needs and values of landowners and society on a sustainable basis (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on Nieuwenhuis, M. 2000. Terminology of Forest Management. IUFRO World Series Vol. 9. IUFRO 4.04.07 SilvaPlan and SilvaVoc).

**Small-scale smallholder:** Any person that is depending on the land for most of their livelihood; and/or employs labor mostly from family or neighboring communities and has land-use rights on a Management Unit of less than 50 hectares. Standard developers may define this to less than 50 hectares (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Social harms:** Negative impacts on persons or communities, perpetrated by individuals, corporations or states, which include, but may go beyond, criminal acts by legal persons. Such harms include negative impacts on persons' or groups' rights, livelihoods and well-being, such as property (including forests, lands, waters), health, food security, healthy environment, cultural repertoire and happiness, as well as physical injury, detention, dispossession and expulsion (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

- **Ongoing social harms:** social harms which have not been remedied.
- **Priority social harms:** social harms prioritized by an FPIC-based process with affected rights-holders or identified in consultation with affected stakeholders (Source: FSC-PRO-01-007 V1-0. Shortened version - refer to the FSC Remedy Framework for full definition).

**Stakeholder:** See definitions for 'affected stakeholder' and 'interested stakeholder' (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Statutory law or statute law:** The body of law contained in Acts of Parliament (national legislature) (Source: Oxford Dictionary of Law).

**Tenure:** Socially defined agreements held by individuals or groups, recognized by *legal*\* statutes or customary practice, regarding the 'bundle of rights and duties' of ownership, holding, access and/or usage of a particular land unit or the associated resources there within (such as individual trees, plant species, water, minerals, etc.) (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2, based on International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). Glossary definitions provided on IUCN website).

**Threat:** An indication or warning of impending or likely damage or negative impacts (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Oxford English Dictionary).

**Threatened species:** Species that meet the IUCN (2001) criteria for Vulnerable (VU), Endangered (EN) or Critically Endangered (CR), and are facing a high, very high or extremely high *risk*\* of extinction in the wild. These categories may be re-interpreted for FSC purposes according to official national classifications (which have *legal*\* significance) and to local conditions and population densities (which should affect decisions about appropriate conservation measures) (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). 2001. IUCN Red List Categories and Criteria: Version 3.1. IUCN Species Survival Commission. IUCN. Gland, Switzerland and Cambridge, UK).

**Timber harvesting level:** The actual harvest quantity executed on *the Management Unit*\*, tracked by either volume (e.g. cubic meters or board feet) or area (e.g. hectares or acres) metrics for the purpose of comparison with calculated (maximum) allowable harvest levels (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Timely manner:** As promptly as circumstances reasonably allow; not intentionally postponed by *The Organization\**; in compliance with *applicable laws\**, contracts, licenses or invoices (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Traditional Knowledge:** Information, know-how, skills and practices that are developed, sustained and passed on from generation to generation within a community, often forming part of its cultural or spiritual identity (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on the definition by the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO). Glossary definition as provided under Policy / Traditional Knowledge on the WIPO website).

**Traditional peoples:** Traditional peoples are social groups or peoples who do not self-identify as indigenous and who affirm rights to their lands, *forests\** and other resources based on long established custom or traditional occupation and use (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, Forest Peoples Programme (Marcus Colchester, 7 October 2009).

**Transaction verification:** Verification by certification bodies and/or Accreditation Services International (ASI) that FSC output claims made by certificate holders are accurate and match with the FSC input claims of their trading partners (Source: FSC-STD-40-004 V3-0).

**Trigger Value:** Trigger values are expressed as the value of toxicity exposure ratio (TER) above which exposure is considered to be an unacceptable risk. The TER is calculated based on the acute toxicity value and exposure for each pesticide. Its value will be local and will be based on exposure parameters.

**Uphold:** To acknowledge, respect, sustain and support (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Use rights:** Rights for the use of resources of the Management Unit that can be defined by local custom, mutual agreements, or prescribed by other entities holding access rights. These rights may restrict the use of particular resources to specific levels of consumption or particular harvesting techniques (Source: FSC-STD-01-001 V5-2).

**Vast majority:** 80% of the total area of *Intact Forest Landscapes\** within the *Management Unit\** as of January 1, 2017. The *vast majority\** also meets or exceeds the minimum definition of *Intact Forest Landscape\** (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Verifiable targets:** Specific goals, such as desired future *forest\** conditions, established to measure progress towards the achievement of each of the *management objectives\**. These goals are expressed as clear outcomes, such that their attainment can be verified and it is possible to determine whether they have been accomplished or not (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Very limited portion:** The affected area shall not exceed 5% of the Management Unit, irrespective of whether the conversion activities have taken place prior to or after The Organization is awarded with FSC Forest Management certification (Source: FSC-POL-01-007 V1-0).

**Very limited portion of the core area:** The area affected *shall\** not exceed 0.5% of the area of the *core area\** in any one year, nor affect a total of more than 5% of the area of the *core area\**.

**Waste materials:** unusable or unwanted substances or by-products, such as:

- Hazardous waste, including chemical waste and batteries;
- Containers;
- Motor and other fuels and oils;
- Rubbish including metals, plastics and paper; and



- Abandoned buildings, machinery and equipment (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Water bodies** (including water courses): Seasonal, temporary, and permanent brooks, creeks, streams, rivers, ponds, and lakes. Water bodies include riparian or wetland systems, lakes, swamps, bogs and springs (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0).

**Wetlands:** Transitional areas between terrestrial and aquatic systems in which the water table is usually at or near the surface or the land is covered by shallow water (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on Cowardin, L.M., Carter, V., Golet, F.C., Laroe, E.T. 1979. Classification of Wetlands and Deepwater Habitats of the United States. DC US Department: Washington).

Under the Ramsar Convention, wetlands can include tidal mudflats, natural ponds, marshes, potholes, wet meadows, bogs, *peatlands\**, freshwater swamps, mangroves, lakes, rivers and even some coral reefs (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), No Date, IUCN Definitions – English).

**Workers:** All employed persons including public employees as well as ‘self-employed’ persons. This includes part-time and seasonal employees, of all ranks and categories, including laborers, administrators, supervisors, executives, contractor employees as well as self-employed contractors and sub-contractors (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Labor Organization (ILO) Convention 155, Occupational Safety and Health Convention, 1981).

**Workers’ organization:** any organization of *workers\** \_for furthering and defending the interest of *workers\**\_ (adapted from ILO Convention 87, Article 10). It is important to note that rules and guidance on composition of workers’ organization vary from country to country, especially in relation to those who are considered as rank and file members, as well those who are deemed to have power to “hire and fire”. Workers’ organizations tend to separate association between those who can “hire and fire” and those who cannot (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on report on generic criteria and indicators based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Core Conventions principles, 2017).

**Worst forms of *child\** labour:** comprises a) all forms of slavery or practices similar to slavery, such as the sale and trafficking of children, debt bondage and serfdom and forced labour, including forced or compulsory recruitment of children for use in armed conflict; b) the use, procuring or offering of a *child\** for prostitution, for the production of pornography or for pornographic performance; c) the use, procuring or offering of a *child\** for illicit activities, in particular for production and trafficking of drugs as defined in the relevant international treaties; d) work which, by its nature or the circumstances in which it is carried out, is likely to harm the health, safety or morals of children (Source: FSC-STD-60-004 V2-0, based on International Labour Organization (ILO) Convention 182, Article 3).



**FSC International Center gGmbH – Performance and Standards Unit**

Adenauerallee 134

53113 Bonn

Germany

**Phone:** +49 -(0)228 -36766 -0

**Fax:** +49 -(0)228 -36766 -65

**Email :** [psu@fsc.org](mailto:psu@fsc.org)